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ISBN: 9798189630521

First edition published September 9, 2025
Second edition published August 1, 2026

Eternal Word Publishing Co.

https://www.eternalwordpublishing.org/



Printed in the United States of America

All Scripture quotations are taken from the **King James Version (KJV)** of the Bible, which is in the public domain.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Luke Johnston has given years of study to the subject of Bible versions and the history of the Bible. He holds a Doctor of Educational Ministry degree and a PhD in Biblical Studies and is completing his final project for the Doctor of Ministry degree at Luther Rice College and Seminary. Most importantly, he received his Bible training under the God-ordained authority of the local church. His mindset, training, and, above all, his faith in the Word of God were formed through the instruction he received within his church. From that foundation, he went on to pursue advanced degrees from accredited institutions. He has found, however, that while these institutions are not ordained of God and often fall into apostasy, they also have a tendency to take the Word of God out of the hands of men, whereas the local church has always done the exact opposite. The church instilled in him a steadfast faith in Scripture and gave him both the training and the desire to defend its authority and preservation. It is out of that conviction, and with a burden to strengthen the faith of others, that he has written this book, to contend for the King James Bible as the preserved and perfect Word of God.

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GLOSSARY OF TERMS

Alexandrian Text (Alexandrian line) — A divergent text-type associated with Alexandria and figures like Origen; championed in codices such as Vaticanus (B) and Sinaiticus (א). It survives in far fewer manuscripts than the Byzantine tradition (Minority Text), and in many disputed passages, modern critical editors—and, by extension, modern Bible versions—give substantial weight to its readings.

Apocrypha (Old Testament apocryphal content) — Jewish religious writings not recognized as inspired Scripture; in later Greek codices, they are intermingled with canonical books, which is one reason those codices are viewed critically in these materials.

Byzantine Text-type (Antiochian/Syrian line) — The form of the Greek New Testament found in the great majority of surviving later Greek manuscripts and widely transmitted throughout the Byzantine Greek-speaking church (Majority Text). It is a broad manuscript tradition, not one manuscript or one printed edition.

Canon / Canonical — The recognized collection of books received as inspired Scripture. "Canonical" means belonging to that collection; "noncanonical" describes writings outside it.

Codex — An ancient manuscript made in book form, with leaves joined along one side, as distinguished from a scroll. Vaticanus and Sinaiticus are codices.

Codex Alexandrinus (A) — A fifth-century manuscript from Alexandria; mixed in character—Byzantine in the Gospels and Alexandrian elsewhere.

Codex Sinaiticus (א / Aleph) — A fourth-century uncial manuscript discovered at St. Catherine's, extensively corrected and often at variance with Vaticanus; it also includes noncanonical works.

Codex Vaticanus (B) — A fourth-century uncial manuscript prioritized by modern editors; notable for significant omissions and for containing apocryphal material alongside Scripture. Its New Testament portion is physically lost after Hebrews 9:14. Its Greek Old Testament also contains the Apocrypha.

Critical Text (Nestle–Aland / UBS) — The modern eclectic Greek editions of the New Testament (e.g., NA/UBS) that rely heavily on Alexandrian witnesses such as Vaticanus and Sinaiticus and function as the base for modern translations.

Dead Sea Scrolls (including 1QIsa^{a} and 1QIsa^{b} / Isaiah B) — Pre-Christian Hebrew manuscripts from Qumran that substantially align with the Masoretic tradition. The Great Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa^{a}) and the "Isaiah B" scroll (1QIsa^{b}) closely match the Masoretic Text of the KJV. They are considered to be some of the oldest biblical manuscripts in existence.

Dynamic (Functional) Equivalence — A meaning-for-meaning (thought-for-thought) approach that prioritizes conveying the thought of the text being translated rather than mirroring each original word; contrasted with formal equivalence.

Eclectic Text — A text produced by selecting readings from different manuscripts and text traditions rather than following one manuscript or textual tradition throughout. Modern Nestle–Aland and UBS editions are eclectic texts.

Edition — A particular published form of a text prepared by one or more editors. Erasmus's, Stephanus's, Beza's, and the

Elzevirs' Greek texts are printed editions, not individual manuscripts.

Formal (Verbal) Equivalence — A translation method aiming for a close, word-for-word rendering from the source language, preserving the original structure and words as much as possible.

Inerrant / Inerrancy — That the Scriptures are without error.

Infallible / Infallibility — That Scripture, as the product of the God who cannot lie, cannot fail or mislead; it is wholly trustworthy in all it teaches.

Inspiration (including "given by inspiration of God") — God's direct, supernatural action by which the biblical writers received and accurately wrote down His revelation; as God's own "breath," this act is inseparable from His ongoing preservation of those words.

INTF (Institut für Neutestamentliche Textforschung) manuscript counts — The Institute for New Testament Textual Research in Münster maintains the official register of catalogued Greek New Testament witnesses. Its published count lists approximately 5,700 entries, including papyri, majuscules, minuscules, and lectionaries. Most contain only part of the New Testament, and the count changes as manuscripts are discovered, reclassified, combined, or removed.

"Jot and tittle" — Hebrew's smallest letter and smallest stroke of the pen; Jesus used these terms to show that even the minutest marks of the Law stand under God's guarantee.

Lectionaries — Books arranged for the public reading of selected Scripture passages in churches.

Majority Text — A Greek New Testament text produced by following readings supported by the majority or consensus of

surviving Greek manuscripts. Majority Text editions represent the Byzantine tradition, but they are not absolutely identical to every Byzantine manuscript, to one another, or to the Textus Receptus, though they are closely connected.

Manuscript — A handwritten copy of all or part of a biblical book. A manuscript may be a complete codex, several leaves, or only a small fragment.

Marginal note / Alternative reading — Information printed beside the biblical text giving another possible translation, a more literal rendering, a cross-reference, or a textual observation. They tend to cast doubt in the mind of the reader about what it says/is supposed to say.

Masoretic Text (MT) — The traditional Hebrew text preserved by Jewish scribes (Masoretes) using rigorous copying controls; it represents the conservatively guarded Old Testament used among the Jews, and used to translate the Old Testament for the KJV.

Old Latin / Vulgate — "Old Latin" describes the diverse Latin translations that circulated before the Vulgate. The Vulgate is the later standardized Latin Bible associated with Jerome. Jerome revised the Latin Gospels using Greek manuscripts and translated or revised much of the Old Testament with reference to Hebrew; the history of the remaining New Testament books is more complicated.

Original autographs — The first manuscripts penned by the biblical authors or their authorized scribes; the initial physical writings from which copies were made.

Original languages / Source text — The languages in which Scripture was first written: Hebrew for most of the Old Testament, Aramaic for small portions of the Old Testament, and

Greek for the New Testament. "Hebrew text" or "Greek text" refers to wording in those languages, whether found in manuscripts or presented in a printed edition.

Patristic quotations / Church Fathers — Citations of Scripture found in early Christian writers, used as external witnesses in establishing the text.

Perfect — From the Latin perficere, meaning "complete." The biblical definition follows the same meaning: complete, entire, and lacking nothing needed (e.g., Job 1:1, 8; 2:3; 2 Tim. 3:17).

Peshitta (Syriac) — The standard Syriac translation of the Bible used by several Eastern churches. The New Testament Peshitta probably reached its standard form in the late fourth or early fifth century, but could be as early as the second century. It often supports readings preserved in the Byzantine or Textus Receptus tradition.

Plenary (Plenary Inspiration) — The view that inspiration extends to the entire Bible, not just parts of it; Scripture is wholly inspired in its totality.

Preservation (of Scripture) — God's providential safeguarding of His words through history so that His people continue to possess His Word, in every marking and individual word; tied to His unchangeable nature and promises.

Purification (of God's Word) — The refining of God's words (Ps. 12:6), applied to the historical process by which God's Word is kept pure and recognized among His people.

Reading / Textual variant — A particular wording found in a textual witness. A textual variant is a difference between witnesses, such as spelling, word order, omission, addition, or substitution. Most variants are minor, though some affect larger words or passages.

Revision — A translation produced by reviewing and editing an earlier translation rather than beginning entirely anew. The KJV translators revised earlier English Bibles while comparing them with the Hebrew and Greek.

Septuagint (LXX) — A collective label for ancient Greek renderings of the Old Testament; the earliest complete forms appear centuries after the alleged third-century B.C. origin story and include the Apocrypha, reflecting Alexandrian influence rather than a single, unified pre-Christian edition.

Supplied words / Italics — Words needed to express the meaning clearly in English even though they do not correspond to a separate Hebrew or Greek word. Later KJV editions commonly identify these words with italic type.

Text — The actual wording transmitted by a manuscript, translation, or printed edition. A manuscript is the physical object; the text is the wording it contains. Many manuscripts can transmit the same general text while differing in individual readings.

Textual criticism — The scientific, man-made philosophy used to identify the text of Scripture from surviving witnesses; it seeks to answer the question, "What did the original authors write?"

Textual witness — Any source that preserves evidence about the wording of Scripture, including Greek or Hebrew manuscripts, ancient translations, lectionaries, and quotations by early Christian writers.

Text-type / Textual tradition — A broad group of manuscripts that share characteristic readings. A text-type is not one manuscript, nor does it mean that every manuscript in the group is identical.

Textus Receptus (TR) / Received Text — The name given to a succession of closely related printed Greek New Testaments beginning with Erasmus in 1516 and continued through editions by Stephanus, Beza, and the Elzevirs. The Elzevir edition of 1633 supplied the expression from which "Textus Receptus" was derived. These editions are predominantly Byzantine in character, but they differ from one another slightly and are not absolutely identical to modern Byzantine or Majority Text editions, though they are closely connected.

Traditional Text — A term used by some writers for the Greek New Testament text historically received and used by the church. Because the term is used in different ways, this book uses it broadly for the Byzantine and Received Text tradition while distinguishing the manuscript tradition from the later printed Textus Receptus editions.

Translation / Version — A rendering of Scripture from one language into another. "Translation" may describe either the process or the resulting work; "version" ordinarily identifies a particular translation, such as the Geneva Bible or King James Bible.

Uncials / Minuscules (Greek manuscript categories) — Uncials use large, continuous capital letters; minuscules are later manuscripts written in smaller, cursive-style script.

For Full Sizes of the Charts in This Book, Scan This QR Code:



WHY THIS BOOK, THOUGH OTHERS EXIST

Some may ask why another book on this subject is needed when shelves already hold volumes that argue for the same conclusion. The answer lies in both method and aim.

1. **Concise yet thorough.** Many books that defend the King James Bible stretch on for hundreds more pages than necessary. Their arguments are often weighed down by commentary, tangents, or extended narrative. While such material may have value in its own place, this book is designed to be "straight over the plate." It says what needs to be said, no less, no more. The goal is to be concise and yet thorough. There are plenty of "weeds" to get into in this subject that are well worth exploring. For these areas, I have provided a recommended reading list at the end.

2. **Documented carefully.** Another weakness found in similar works is the lack of clear documentation. Some provide little to no citation for key claims; others reference sources in ways that are vague or confusing. In contrast, this book points you directly to the evidence. Every crucial statement is accompanied by traceable documentation so that you can verify the key information on this subject. Also, it uses original sourcing wherever possible. Another common trait found in other writings on this subject is the use of "biased" source lists. In this book I tried to avoid this wherever possible.

3. **Up to date.** Some of the best-known works on this topic were written fifty years ago or more. In the time since, hundreds of manuscripts have been catalogued, new archaeological finds have come to light, and much has changed in the field. This book accounts for the most recent

data without discarding the proven testimony of earlier witnesses.

4. **Built on faith, not just evidence.** Many defenders of the King James Bible present strong factual cases but build their argument on the wrong foundation. They start with human reasoning and work their way toward faith. This book takes the opposite path: it begins with the promises of God's Word and lets the evidence follow in its proper place. The structure is deliberately Scripture first, history second. Without that order, even good conclusions will falter under the right challenge.

5. **Not a "pseudo-King James" position.** A final distinction must be made here. Some of the most respected voices in this debate ultimately rest their authority in the Greek Textus Receptus rather than in the King James Bible itself. This opens the door to problems, since there are multiple printed TR editions with notable differences amongst themselves. That position leaves the believer without a final authority. This book does not take that path. It contends unapologetically that the King James Bible itself is the purified, preserved Word of God in English.

6. **Charts and visual aids**. These are used to assist in grasping concepts that might otherwise be difficult to understand.

7. **Balanced tone.** Some books on this topic come across as harsh, attacking anyone who disagrees. Others are so soft that they never make a clear stand. This book tries to avoid both extremes wherever possible by speaking plainly and dealing in the facts of the matter.

INTRODUCTION

The pastor's voice rang out as he lifted his Bible high above the pulpit. "This is the Word of God! Infallible, inerrant, inspired! Trust it with your life, trust it with your eternity!" The congregation erupted with "Amens." Pens underlined words. Children were nudged to listen closely.

A young man sat three rows back, his own Bible open on his lap. He heard the pastor preaching about trusting every word. He believed him, but weeks later, in a membership class, he was handed the church's doctrinal statement. He scanned it until one line stopped him cold:

"We believe the Scriptures are inspired, inerrant, and infallible, **in the original autographs**."

His stomach dropped. He read it again. The originals? Manuscripts written thousands of years ago and long since turned to dust? He looked down at the book in his lap—the same book the pastor had lifted and called "the Word of God." Suddenly, his mind began to race. *If this Bible is not really inerrant, what am I holding?*

He thought of the **safety instructions at the steel mill** where his father worked. If those manuals were "mostly right," men lost fingers. If even one warning line was missing, the furnace could claim a life. He thought of the **prescription label** on his mother's medicine. If it was "accurate in the original notes from the lab," but the copy in the bottle was flawed, what good was it? *One wrong word and the dose could kill.* He thought of his younger brother learning to read from a **phonics chart**. If some of the words were off, just one letter dropped or changed, the whole foundation would be warped. How could he ever learn the language if he couldn't trust the chart?

And now here he was, being told to trust his eternity, not his body, not his job, not even his brother's reading, but his *soul*, to a book his own church admitted was not truly infallible. The young man stared at his Bible and asked the question that would not leave him:

If the Word of God is only perfect in manuscripts that vanished thousands of years ago, what am I really holding in my hands today?

The Real Issue at Stake

When people debate Bible translations, the talk usually slides into preferences: Which reads easier? Which sounds smoother? Which sells better? Those are side issues. The first questions we have to face are these:

Has God preserved His words, or not? Does a perfect Word of God exist today? And if it does, where can I find it?

Wesley Huff, a well-known voice on manuscripts and textual criticism (M.A. in Theological Studies; Ph.D. candidate in Theological Studies and Sacred and Canonical Texts, NT concentration), was asked in 2025 whether a perfect Bible exists. His reply:

> "I don't know if I'd use the word 'perfect' because that's kind of a tricky word. The word perfect implies flawless…"[1]

If inspiration is true but perfect preservation of every word is false, then what makes the Bible unique from other books? If God gave His words and then lost them in the sands of Egypt or the vaults of Rome, then His promises ring hollow. But if He

---

[1] "Part 1: Answering King James Only w/ Wes Huff," Cultish (YouTube video), January 8, 2025, 56:00, posted by Cultish TV, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yLGTS6Q82kE.

both inspired *and preserved* His words, then we can know with certainty that we can have access to the very words of God.

This book is not written for mere academic sparring over manuscripts, methods, lineages, etc., but to instill faith back in the Word of God. For *"faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God"* (**Rom. 10:17**). If the Word is unstable, faith is unstable. If the Word is sure, faith is sure.

Why This Book

This book is not written to score points in debates, nor to stir division among believers. It is written to strengthen faith. It is written for the plowboy Tyndale dreamed of when he said,

> "I defy the pope and all his laws … if God spare my life ere many years, I will cause a boy that driveth the plough, shall know more of the scripture then thou dost."[2]

It is for the ordinary Christian who wants to hold in his hands the very words of God, without doubt. Tyndale again spoke against the "scholarship" of his day and its tendency to take the Word of God out of the hands of common men when he said,

> "In the universities they have ordained that no man shall look on the Scripture until he be nuzzled in heathen learning eight or nine years, and armed with false principles with which he is clean shut out of the understanding of the Scripture."[3]

---

[2] John Foxe, *Actes and Monuments* (London: John Day, 1563), 570.

[3] William Tyndale, The Practice of Prelates, in *Expositions and Notes on Sundry Portions of the Holy Scriptures, Together with The Practice of Prelates*, ed. Henry Walter, Parker Society (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1849), 291.

This book is written to show that preservation and purification are not theories; they are promises kept by God Himself.

The Word Must Be Believed and Obeyed

The issue addressed in this book matters. The Bible a man holds can affect his faith, his doctrine, his preaching, and his understanding of the Lord. Words matter because God chose to reveal Himself through words. A missing word, a changed word, or a weakened statement can affect what a passage teaches.

However, the importance of this issue must never become an excuse for neglecting the rest of what the Bible commands. The Lord Jesus rebuked the Pharisees because they were careful about certain matters while neglecting the weightier matters of the law:

Matthew 23:23

"Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye pay tithe of mint and anise and cummin, and have omitted the weightier matters of the law, judgment, mercy, and faith: these ought ye to have done, and not to leave the other undone."

Notice that Christ did not tell them to abandon their obedience. He said, "these ought ye to have done." Their problem was that they emphasized one part while neglecting judgment, mercy, and faith.

The same warning applies to the subject of the Bible. A man may hold the King James Bible, understand the manuscript evidence, explain the differences between Antioch and Alexandria, and still be proud, harsh, uncharitable, disobedient, and spiritually barren. Possessing the right Bible does not excuse a wrong spirit.

Paul wrote:

1 Corinthians 8:1

"…Knowledge puffeth up, but charity edifieth."

Knowledge is good when it brings us into greater submission to God. Knowledge becomes dangerous when it becomes a source of pride. The purpose of understanding the preservation of Scripture is not to make us feel superior to others. It is to make us more certain of what God has said and therefore more emboldened to believe and obey it.

James 1:22 says:

"But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves."

The Bible was not preserved merely so that it could be studied, analyzed, defended, and placed back upon a shelf. It was preserved so that it could be believed, preached, obeyed, memorized, taught to our children, and carried to the lost.

There are sincere believers who use modern versions because they have never studied the textual or translational issues involved. Some of them love Christ, faithfully serve their churches, witness to the lost, give sacrificially, demonstrate humility, and seek to obey the truth they have. Their sincerity does not make every reading in their Bible correct, but neither should their lack of knowledge cause us to judge their heart, their salvation, or their entire Christian life.

We must distinguish between evaluating a Bible and judging the person holding it. A faulty reading does not become true because a sincere believer reads it. At the same time, a sincere believer does not become our enemy merely because he has not yet learned what we have learned.

The servant of the Lord is commanded:

2 Timothy 2:24–25

"And the servant of the Lord must not strive; but be gentle unto all men, apt to teach, patient, In meekness instructing those that oppose themselves; if God peradventure will give them repentance to the acknowledging of the truth;"

Truth is not weakened by meekness. Charity does not require compromise. We are to speak the truth, but we are to speak it "in love" (Eph. 4:15).

The highest position is not merely to say, "I have the right Bible." The highest position is to possess the pure Word of God, understand why it is pure, believe every word of it, obey what it commands, and faithfully give it to others.

We must not become like the servant who buried what his lord had entrusted to him (Matt. 25:18–25). The King James Bible is not a private treasure to be hidden in anger or guarded as a badge of superiority. It is the light that must be carried into a dark world.

Therefore, this book is not merely an argument for possessing the King James Bible. It is a call to believe it, obey it, preach it, defend it with charity, and place it into the hands of others.

To keep the argument clear, here is the whole path before we begin:

1. God inspired His words and markings, not merely His ideas.
2. God promised that those words would be preserved.
3. The Bible itself calls faithful copies Scripture.
4. God committed the Old Testament oracles to the Jews and preserved them in the Hebrew tradition.

5. God placed the New Testament in the life of believing churches, where it was read, copied, preached, and carried.

6. Those words passed from manuscripts into printed Hebrew and Greek texts and then into English translations.

7. Earlier English Bibles prepared the language, and the King James translators brought the preserved text and English Bible tradition together.

8. The result, from the faith-based position of this book, is the King James Bible as the preserved and purified Word of God in English.

The historical process may be pictured simply:

Original writings → handwritten copies → textual traditions → printed Hebrew and Greek texts → English translations

As you will see throughout this book, English Bibles may differ for two main reasons: first, because they follow different Hebrew or Greek readings, and second, because they translate the same reading differently. In many cases, both factors are involved.

The Bible is not just a book; it is the Book. It is the foundation for all doctrine, the sword in all spiritual warfare, the seed of all revival; it is everything we need for life and godliness (**2 Pet. 1:3**). The central question before us is not whether man has been faithful in guarding it; he has not. The question is whether God has been faithful in keeping His promise to preserve it. This book contends He has. And that preserved Word, for the English-speaking world, is the King James Bible.

PART I: FAITH-BASED

INSPIRATION: WHAT GOD DID ONCE

For nearly all of church history, Christians have been in broad agreement concerning the **inspiration** of Scripture. Inspiration literally means "**God-breathed**." It refers to the **original writing** of Scripture as the Holy Ghost moved men to record the very words of God.

We see this in such verses as **2 Peter 1:21**, which says:

> *"For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man: but holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost."*

Another familiar passage concerning inspiration is **2 Timothy 3:15–17**:

> *"And that from a child thou hast known the holy scriptures, which are able to make thee wise unto salvation through faith which is in Christ Jesus. All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness: That the man of God may be perfect, throughly furnished unto all good works."*

David testified of this process in **2 Samuel 23:2:**

> *"The Spirit of the LORD spake by me, and his word was in my tongue."*

Notice the precision of David's statement. He did not say that God merely gave him the general idea of what to say. He declared that the **Spirit Himself spoke through him** and placed the **very words** upon his tongue.

The prophet Jeremiah spoke the same truth in **Jeremiah 1:9**:

> *"Then the LORD put forth his hand, and touched my mouth. And the LORD said unto me, Behold, I have put my words in thy mouth."*

These men understood that what flowed from their lips was not their invention, but God's words.

The Lord Jesus Christ Himself confirmed this view of inspiration. In **Matthew 22:43–44**, when debating the Pharisees, He rooted His argument on a single word from **Psalm 110**:

> *"How then doth David in spirit call him Lord…?"*

Christ based the entire doctrine of His Lordship on the Spirit's exact wording through David. He did not treat Scripture as a general thought but as though every word mattered.

In **Hebrews 3:7** we read,

> *"Wherefore (as the Holy Ghost saith, To day if ye will hear his voice, Harden not your hearts…)."*

Yet the quotation that follows comes from **Psalm 95**. David wrote it, but Hebrews says the Holy Ghost is the one speaking. When God moved in David to write those words, they were not the words of David; they were the words of God; this is inspiration.

That is why Jesus declared in **Matthew 4:4**,

> *"Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God."*

Our Lord did not say "every thought," but "every word." Inspiration reaches to the level of words, even to the smallest strokes of letters, as He also said in **Matthew 5:18**:

> *"Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled."*

God breathes out words, not simply concepts.

Christ Promised the New Testament Before It Was Written

The writing of the New Testament was not an unexpected development that arose years after Christ returned to heaven. Before His crucifixion, the Lord Jesus promised that the Holy Ghost would guide the apostles in remembering, recording, explaining, and completing His revelation.

> **John 14:25–26**
>
> *"These things have I spoken unto you, being yet present with you. But the Comforter, which is the Holy Ghost, whom the Father will send in my name, he shall teach you all things, and bring all things to your remembrance, whatsoever I have said unto you."*

The Gospels were not produced merely by the memories of aging men. Christ promised that the Holy Ghost would bring His words to their remembrance. The disciples would not be forced to depend upon imperfect recollection. The same Spirit who originally gave the words would supervise their faithful recording.

Christ continued:

> **John 15:26–27**
>
> *"But when the Comforter is come, whom I will send unto you from the Father, even the Spirit of truth, which proceedeth*

from the Father, he shall testify of me: And ye also shall bear witness, because ye have been with me from the beginning."

This promise reaches beyond the recording of Christ's spoken words. The apostles would bear an inspired witness concerning His life, death, resurrection, ascension, and the work He continued through the early church. The book of Acts records that Spirit-led witness.

Jesus then said:

John 16:12–13

"I have yet many things to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now. Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth: for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will shew you things to come."

The apostles had not yet received everything Christ intended to reveal. The Holy Ghost would guide them into all truth and would show them things to come. This promise provides the foundation for the doctrinal teaching of the Epistles and the prophetic revelation that reaches its completion in the book of Revelation.

These passages should not be divided into rigid compartments as though one verse referred only to the Gospels and another only to Acts. Together they establish the complete promise:

- The Holy Ghost would bring Christ's words to remembrance.
- The Holy Ghost would testify of Christ through the apostles.
- The Holy Ghost would guide them into all truth.

- The Holy Ghost would show them things to come.

Christ is the divine source of the New Testament. The Holy Ghost is the divine superintendent of its writing. The apostles and prophets are the human instruments through whom those words were written.

The New Testament is therefore not a collection of uncertain memories, developing traditions, or later theological reflections. It is the promised written witness of Jesus Christ, given through the Holy Ghost exactly as He said it would be.

If the Bible were only partially inspired, or only in its "ideas," then we could never be sure which parts were trustworthy and which parts were human opinion. But because inspiration extends to every word, we can open our Bibles with the confidence that we are hearing God's own voice.

However, a serious problem arises when modern scholarship affirms inspiration but limits the inerrancy of every word to the original writings alone. Many churches and seminaries describe the Bible as inspired, inerrant, infallible, and plenary, yet qualify those claims with three tragic words: "in the originals." When asked where the perfect Word of God exists today, they generally give one of two answers.

1. Perfection Existed Only in the Originals

According to this view, only the individual books first written by the biblical authors were completely pure and without error. Later copies and translations are considered reliable only to the extent that they reproduce those originals. Those original writings, however, disappeared long ago and have not existed for thousands of years. Furthermore, because they were written by different men in different places over many centuries, the complete set of original writings was never gathered into one

Bible that anyone could see, read, and hold. Under this view, no complete and perfectly preserved Bible has ever existed as a single book.

2. Perfection Exists Collectively among the Evidence

Others argue that God's words have been preserved collectively among the thousands of surviving manuscripts, ancient versions, and modern translations. The perfect text is said to exist somewhere within all this evidence. Yet no single manuscript, Greek or Hebrew text, or translation is identified as containing every word perfectly. The perfect Word therefore exists only in a scattered form that no believer can see, read, or hold.

These views differ in where they place the pure Word of God, but they reach the same practical conclusion. The first places perfection in original writings that no longer exist; the second places it collectively among manuscripts and translations without identifying a single perfect form. Neither view points the believer to a presently available Bible and says without qualification, "This is the perfect, preserved Word of God, as promised by God Himself."

Thus, the prophecy of Amos is fulfilled:

> **Amos 8:11–12**
>
> *"Behold, the days come, saith the Lord GOD, that I will send a famine in the land, not a famine of bread, nor a thirst for water, but of hearing the words of the LORD: And they shall wander from sea to sea, and from the north even to the east, they shall run to and fro to seek the word of the LORD, and shall not find it."*

In the world we live in today, according to that line of thinking, nobody can find the Word of God, because in order to find it you

would have to build a time machine and travel back thousands of years to the original inspired copy of Scripture. As soon as that copy was destroyed, within 20, 30, 40, 50, or even 100 years, the Word of God ceased to exist in that perfect form that was described.

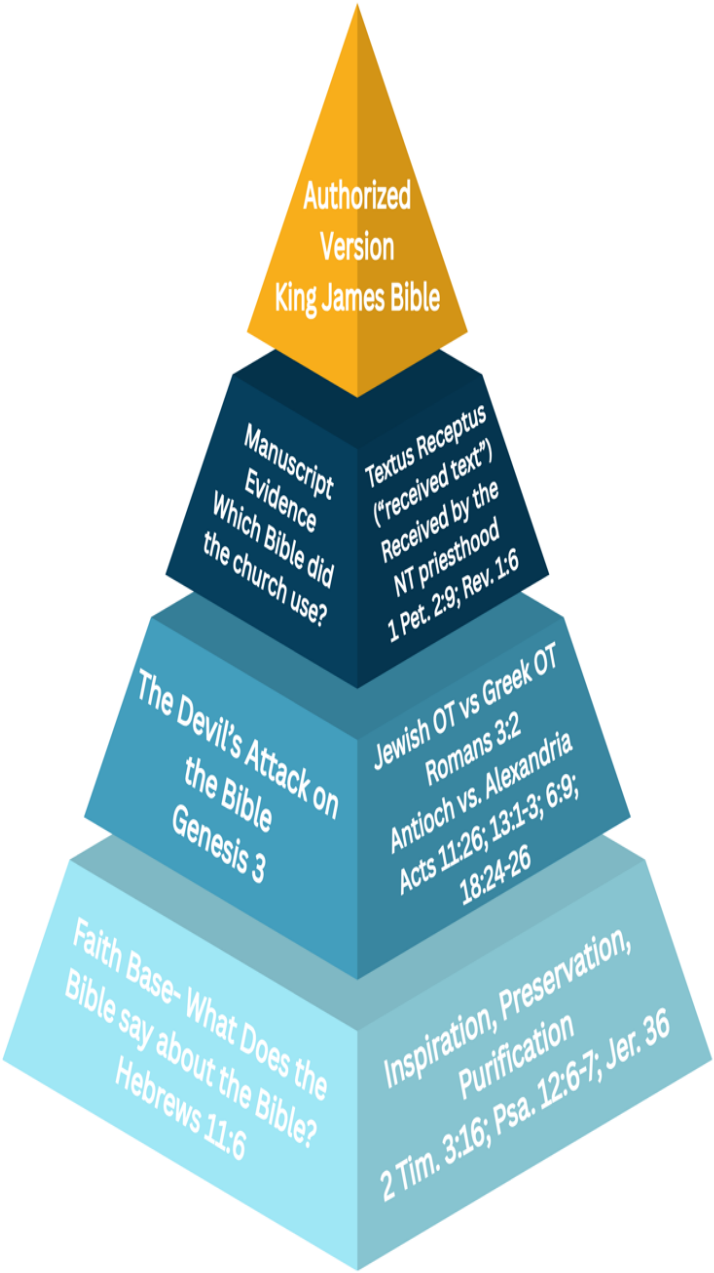
And so the question arises: What good, then, would inspiration be if it only existed in that form for those few years that the original copy lasted?

Wesley Huff, the New Testament manuscript scholar, once again said,

> "Here's the question that modern translators want to get down to, and this is the question when I do textual research that I want to get down to: What did the original author say?"[4]

However, the question we must answer throughout this book is: Is that a biblical view of the Word of God or is there more to the Bible than simply the inspiration and the original copy that lasted for only a few short years?

[4] "Part 1: Answering King James Only w/ Wes Huff," 56:00.


Authorized Version King James Bible
Manuscript Evidence Which Bible did the church use?
Textus Receptus ("received text") Received by the NT priesthood 1 Pet. 2:9; Rev. 1:6
The Devil's Attack on the Bible Genesis 3
Jewish OT vs Greek OT Romans 3:2 Antioch vs. Alexandria Acts 11:26; 13:1-3; 6:9; 18:24-26
Faith Base- What Does the Bible say about the Bible? Hebrews 11:6
Inspiration, Preservation, Purification 2 Tim. 3:16; Psa. 12:6-7; Jer. 36

Faith-Based?

My position, to put it simply, is this: I believe that the perfect, inerrant, infallible, plenary Word of God exists in the world today, and you can find it in a book. You can find it, every jot and every tittle, exactly as God preserved it, as He promised to. And I arrived at this position from a faith-based view of the Word of God.

The position begins with the promises of the Word of God and the principles taught in the Word of God, and then moves into the evidence from history. With a position that is founded in faith through the principles in the Bible, we can interpret this issue in history from God's perspective, not mankind's.

In Colossians we are told that as we received Christ Jesus the Lord, so we should walk in Him, rooted and established in the faith.

> **Colossians 2:6–7**
>
> *"As ye have therefore received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk ye in him: Rooted and built up in him, and stablished in the faith, as ye have been taught, abounding therein with thanksgiving."*

In Hebrews we are told that without faith it is impossible to please God.

> **Hebrews 11:6**
>
> *"But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him."*

From the very beginning of our Christian existence, from the very moment of regeneration, we were called to walk in faith and by faith.

So then, where does that faith come from? The Bible tells us:

> **Romans 10:17**
>
> *"So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God."*

Everything that we do ought to come from a faith-based relationship with God that is established in the Word of God.

Most Christians would admit to believing that. However, when it comes to where can I go and read, in a book, that plenary, perfect, infallible, inspired, inerrant Word of God that has been promised through Scripture?—there is much hesitation.

Think about it: I am placing my eternity in the hands of the contents of this book. This book is supposed to be a reflection of God Himself. We see in John chapter 1 that the Word is God:

> **John 1:1, 14**
>
> *"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God… And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth."*

Also, in John's first epistle, we see:

> **1 John 5:7**
>
> *"For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one."*

And in **Psalm 138:2** we are told:

> *"…for thou hast magnified thy word above all thy name."*

How could God do this? Why would He do this, making His Word equal to Himself and even establishing His Word above His name? The answer is actually very simple: because our God

is a perfect God, and when He speaks, He speaks perfectly. He does not take anything back, and there would be no reason He would separate Himself from what He says. He cannot say things that contradict Himself, and so He is inseparable from His Word, as established in the Word of God.

The Incarnate Word and the Inscripturated Word

The Bible uses the expression "the Word" in more than one closely related way. Jesus Christ is the Incarnate Word. The Bible is the inscripturated Word.

The word incarnate means "made flesh." **As John 1:1** and **John 1:14** have already shown, the eternal Word did not begin to exist in Bethlehem; He took upon Himself human nature while remaining fully God.

Revelation 19:13 gives Christ the same title at His return:

> *"And he was clothed with a vesture dipped in blood: and his name is called The Word of God."*

Jesus Christ is therefore the Incarnate Word, the eternal Word personally revealed in human flesh.

The Bible may properly be called the inscripturated Word because God caused His words to be committed to writing. The term does not mean that paper, ink, leather, or a printed volume became divine. It means that the revelation and words of God were placed into written form through the prophets and apostles under the inspiration of the Holy Ghost.

The Incarnate Word and the inscripturated Word must be distinguished, *but they must never be separated*.

Jesus Christ is a divine Person. The Bible is not a fourth person of the Godhead. Christ is not merely a book, and a printed Bible

is not Jesus Christ in physical form. We must not confuse the Person of Jesus with the written revelation He has given.

Yet the two are inseparably joined in source, truth, authority, testimony, and purpose.

The Incarnate Word gave the inscripturated Word.

Jesus said to the Father:

> **John 17:8**
>
> *"For I have given unto them the words which thou gavest me; and they have received them…"*

Again, He said:

> **John 17:14**
>
> *"I have given them thy word…"*

And in **John 17:17**:

> *"Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth."*

The words of Scripture come from the same God who was manifested in the flesh. Christ cannot lie, and the Scriptures through which He speaks cannot lie. Christ is "*the truth*" (**John 14:6**), and He declared of the Father, "*thy word is truth*" (**John 17:17**).

The Scriptures reveal Christ.

Jesus told the Jews:

> **John 5:39–40**
>
> *"Search the scriptures; for in them ye think ye have eternal life: and they are they which testify of me. And ye will not come to me, that ye might have life."*

The Scriptures are not an end separated from Christ. They testify of Him. Moses wrote of Him. The prophets foretold Him. The sacrifices pictured Him. The Psalms spoke of His sufferings and glory. The Gospels reveal His earthly ministry. The Epistles explain His work. Revelation unveils His return and kingdom.

After His resurrection, Christ demonstrated this relationship:

> **Luke 24:27**
>
> *"And beginning at Moses and all the prophets, he expounded unto them in all the scriptures the things concerning himself."*

Later in the chapter He said:

> **Luke 24:44**
>
> *"…all things must be fulfilled, which were written in the law of Moses, and in the prophets, and in the psalms, concerning me."*

The written Word bears witness to the Incarnate Word, and the Incarnate Word confirms, fulfills, explains, and authenticates the written Word.

Christ also attached final judgment to His spoken words:

> **John 12:48**
>
> *"He that rejecteth me, and receiveth not my words, hath one that judgeth him: the word that I have spoken, the same shall judge him in the last day."*

A man cannot honestly claim to receive Christ while knowingly rejecting the words by which Christ speaks. To reject His words is to reject His authority. To correct His words is to place human judgment above His. To disobey His words is to disobey Him.

At the same time, a man may possess the Scriptures, search the Scriptures, argue about the Scriptures, and still refuse the Christ of whom they testify. That was the error of the unbelieving Jews in **John 5**. They possessed the written word while rejecting the One revealed by it.

Therefore, two errors must be avoided:

Claiming to honor Christ while doubting, correcting, or disobeying His written Word.

Claiming to honor the written Word while refusing to come to Christ, obey Christ, and demonstrate the character of Christ.

The Incarnate Word and the inscripturated Word are not identical in their manner of existence. One is the eternal Son of God; the other is His written revelation. Yet they cannot be separated in authority or testimony. The same God who revealed Himself in Christ has revealed Himself through Scripture.

Edward Hills expressed this principle by arguing that God reveals not merely information about Himself through Scripture, but Himself.[5] That does not make the Bible a member of the Godhead. It means that Scripture is the God-appointed means by which the living Christ is truthfully revealed.

This connection also strengthens the doctrine of preservation. If God gave the Scriptures so that sinners could know Christ, believe the gospel, and receive eternal life, then He would not allow that written witness to disappear or become corrupted. A

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[5] Edward F. Hills, *The King James Version Defended: A Christian View of the New Testament Manuscripts*, 5th ed. (Des Moines, IA: Christian Research Press, 2006), introduction, "Two Methods of New Testament Textual Criticism," and chap. 4, "The Chain-Reaction of the Neutral Approach."

lost or permanently uncertain Bible would leave the testimony of Christ uncertain.

The same Christ who is perfect gave a perfect Word. The same Christ who cannot lie speaks through Scriptures that cannot lie. The same Christ who lives forever declared that His words would not pass away.

The perfect character of the Incarnate Word guarantees the perfect character of the inscripturated Word.

And so today, so that we can please our God by living in faith, and so that we can walk as He called us to in Colossians, "as ye have therefore received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk ye in him," and so that we can reverence the Word of God as we would God Himself, we must hold the same opinion of the Word of God that we hold of God: that it is perfect as He is perfect, that it is eternal as He is eternal, and so on.

Therefore, we will seek to establish a foundation from the Bible itself as to where we can find the Word of God today. Any man-made or scientific system of trying to establish where the Word of God is today will inevitably fall short, because it is not grounded in faith. Any view of the Word of God that is not grounded in faith is not spiritually understood and therefore will always fall short.

What we will find is that the Bible has much to say about itself, where we can find it, promises about the Word of God, and God's attachment of Himself to it through preservation and purification, so that we are not left guessing about where the Word of God is, or whether it exists today.

Shared Attributes	Written Word — Scripture (KJV)	Living Word — Jesus Christ (KJV)
Called "the Word of God"	1 Thes 2:13; Mk 7:13; Lk 8:21	Rev 19:13; Jn 1:1,14
Creator / Agent of creation	Ps 33:6,9; Heb 11:3	Jn 1:3; Col 1:16; Heb 1:2
Sustains / Upholds	Ps 119:89–91,116; Ps 147:15–18	Heb 1:3; Col 1:17
Living & powerful	Heb 4:12	Lk 4:32; Jn 6:63
Truth	Jn 17:17; Ps 119:160	Jn 14:6; Rev 3:14
Enduring	1 Pet 1:23,25; Ps 119:89	Mt 24:35; Heb 13:8
Light	Ps 119:105; Prov 6:23	Jn 8:12; Jn 12:46
Life-giving	Deut 8:3; 1 Pet 2:2; Jer 15:16	Jn 6:35,63; Jn 10:10
Saves / Brings new birth	Jas 1:18; 1 Pet 1:23; Rom 1:16	Mt 1:21; Jn 3:16–17; Acts 4:12
Judges / Standard of judgment	Heb 4:12; Jn 12:48	Jn 5:22,27; 2 Cor 5:10
Sanctifies / Cleanses	Jn 17:17; Eph 5:26	Eph 5:25–27; Heb 13:12
Pure / Without flaw	Ps 12:6; Prov 30:5; Ps 18:30	1 Pet 1:19; Heb 7:26
Heals	Ps 107:20	Mt 8:16–17; Lk 7:7; Jn 4:50
Sword	Eph 6:17; Heb 4:12	Rev 1:16; Rev 2:12; Rev 19:15
Produces faith / Faith's object	Rom 10:17; 1 Thes 2:13	Jn 20:31; Jn 3:16; Acts 20:21; Heb 12:2
Peace & Joy	Ps 119:165; Jer 15:16	Jn 14:27; Jn 15:11
Freedom / Liberty	Ps 119:45; Jas 1:25	Jn 8:31–32,36
Cleansing by the word	Ps 119:9; Eph 5:26	Jn 15:3
Central to "revelation"	2 Tim 3:16–17; Rom 15:4	Heb 1:1–2; Jn 1:18
Searches and Discerns hearts	Heb 4:12	Rev 2:23
Abides in believers	1 Jn 2:14; Col 3:16	Jn 15:4–5; Gal 2:20 (Christ living in me)
Gives hope/comfort	Rom 15:4; Ps 119:49–50	1 Tim 1:1; Col 1:27; Jn 14:18
Honored / Magnified	Ps 138:2	Jn 5:23
Tried / Proven	Ps 18:30; Prov 30:5	Isa 28:16; 1 Pet 2:6; Heb 4:15
Commands obedience	Jas 1:22; Ps 119:4	Jn 14:15; Lk 6:46
Blessing to doers	Jas 1:25; Ps 1:1–3	Lk 11:28; Mt 7:24–25
Spirit-empowered / Spirit-given	2 Pet 1:21; Eph 6:17	Lk 4:18; Acts 10:38; Jn 3:34
Fire	Jer 23:29	Lk 12:49; Rev 1:14; Rev 19:15

PRESERVATION: WHAT GOD PROMISED TO CONTINUE

At this point, most of modern scholarship ceases to understand the promises concerning the Word of God from the Bible itself. On almost any website you would find (whether from a Christian church, a non-denominational group, or any denomination really) that they believe in the inspiration of the Word of God as taught in the Scriptures, but they do not go so far as to believe in the preservation promises of the Word of God as the Bible discusses them.

Again, what a shame this is. The inspiration of the Bible, to put it simply, is of no use if it was only going to promise us a generation or less of the perfect, infallible, inerrant Word of God.

But good news for us: the Bible does promise us more than just the inspiration of the words of God.

The Promises of Preservation

Psalm 12:6–7

"The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever."

Psalm 119:89

"For ever, O LORD, thy word is settled in heaven."

Psalm 119:152

"Concerning thy testimonies, I have known of old that thou hast founded them for ever."

Psalm 119:160

"Thy word is true from the beginning: and every one of thy righteous judgments endureth for ever."

Isaiah 40:8

"The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: but the word of our God shall stand for ever."

Isaiah 59:21

"As for me, this is my covenant with them, saith the LORD; My spirit that is upon thee, and my words which I have put in thy mouth, shall not depart out of thy mouth, nor out of the mouth of thy seed, nor out of the mouth of thy seed's seed, saith the LORD, from henceforth and for ever."

Matthew 5:18

"For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled."

Luke 16:17

"And it is easier for heaven and earth to pass, than one tittle of the law to fail."

Matthew 24:35 (cf. Mark 13:31; Luke 21:33)

"Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away."

John 10:35

"…the scripture cannot be broken;"

1 Peter 1:23–25

"Being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which liveth and abideth for ever. For all flesh is as grass, and all the glory of man as the flower of grass. The grass withereth, and the flower thereof falleth away: But the word of the Lord endureth for ever. And this is the word which by the gospel is preached unto you."

A Historic Baptist Confession of Preservation

This doctrine did not begin with the modern King James Bible debate. In 1689, the Second London Baptist Confession declared that the Hebrew Old Testament and Greek New Testament were "by his singular care and providence kept pure in all ages,"[6] and were therefore authoritative for the church. The confession joined inspiration and preservation together: the same God who originally gave His words continued to preserve them.

It also stated that the Scriptures should be translated into the common language of every nation so that all God's people could read and understand them. The confession did not identify one particular English edition, but it clearly shows that historic Baptists believed both in the providential preservation of Scripture and in its faithful translation for ordinary believers. Preservation was not a later doctrine invented to defend the King James Bible; it was already part of the historic doctrine of Scripture.

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[6] *The Second London Baptist Confession of Faith* (1689), chap. 1, para. 8, "Of the Holy Scriptures," accessed January 8, 2026.

God Preserved His Words, Not the Material

God's promise of preservation is attached to His words, not to the continued existence of every sheet, scroll, or manuscript upon which those words were written. **Isaiah 40:8** declares,

> *"The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: but the word of our God shall stand for ever."*

Peter repeats this idea in **1 Pet. 1:24–25**:

> *"The grass withereth, and the flower thereof falleth away: But the word of the Lord endureth for ever."*

The material things of this world perish, but the words God gave do not.

This provides a fitting illustration of how Scripture was transmitted. Many ancient manuscripts were written on papyrus, a writing material manufactured from a marsh plant; others were written on parchment.[7] In these passages, God is telling us that the very things that are used to transmit His words will perish, but His words will not. Both materials could wear out, decay, burn, or be destroyed. God never promised that every original page or every individual copy would survive. He promised that His words would. A manuscript could disappear while its words continued in faithful copies and in the Bibles read, preached, and received by God's people.

Therefore, the age of a surviving manuscript cannot by itself determine whether its readings are true. Older is not automatically better, just as later is not automatically worse. The central question is not merely, "Which piece of material is

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[7] Rebecca Capua, "Papyrus-Making in Egypt," Heilbrunn Timeline of Art History, Metropolitan Museum of Art, March 2015, https://www.metmuseum.org/essays/papyrus-making-in-egypt.

oldest?" but, "Which words did God preserve through the believing people who copied, received, read, and preached them?" The material may wither like grass, but the Word of God endureth forever.

All of these promises are clear: the Word of God, even down to the very jot and tittle, the smallest of strokes in Hebrew letters, would not pass away, but would be completely kept, perfect and sure, every single letter, every single word, forever.

Now, the hard part about these promises is not understanding them but believing them. The Bible is very clear in its teaching on the keeping of the Word of God. Again, it tells us not only that the ideas would be kept, or the teachings would be kept and preserved, but that the very words, down to the very letters and strokes of the pen, would be kept.

By faith, this is to be believed. If you are not somebody who is interested in grounding your beliefs about the Bible in faith, and you are only interested in the science of textual criticism and understanding things from man's perspective and in man's wisdom, then this book may not be of interest to you.

This book seeks to understand this subject from one foundation only, from faith in the promises about the Word of God, from the Word of God itself. Not science, not the wisdom of man, not textual criticism, not anything other than the foundation of the Bible. That will be the foundation of this argument.

We will, however, get into the details of the manuscripts and the facts of history later on. But for now we must establish this: if we cannot, by faith, believe God's promises about preserving His Word and purifying His Word, just as we do about inspiring His Word, then understanding those more technical issues is of no benefit.

Copies as Scripture

We find many different Scripture passages that testify to the fact that both the originals and copies of the originals are seen as Scripture in the Bible. This goes directly against the idea that the originals are to be emphasized, and that the originals are the only things that are inspired or the very Word of God.

Copies of Scripture are all over the Bible, elevated to the place of Scripture, nothing less.

> **Deuteronomy 17:18–19**
>
> *"And it shall be, when he sitteth upon the throne of his kingdom, that he shall write him a copy of this law in a book out of that which is before the priests the Levites: And it shall be with him, and he shall read therein all the days of his life: that he may learn to fear the LORD his God, to keep all the words of this law and these statutes, to do them:"*
>
> **2 Kings 22:8, 11, 13**
>
> *(v. 8) "And Hilkiah the high priest said unto Shaphan the scribe, I have found the book of the law in the house of the LORD. And Hilkiah gave the book to Shaphan, and he read it."*
>
> *(v. 11) "And it came to pass, when the king had heard the words of the book of the law, that he rent his clothes."*
>
> *(v. 13) "Go ye, enquire of the LORD for me, and for the people, and for all Judah, concerning the words of this book that is found: for great is the wrath of the LORD that is kindled against us, because our fathers have not hearkened unto the words of this book, to do according unto all that which is written concerning us."*

Ezra 7:14

"…according to the law of thy God which is in thine hand;"

Nehemiah 8:8

"So they read in the book in the law of God distinctly, and gave the sense, and caused them to understand the reading."

Luke 4:17–21

"And there was delivered unto him the book of the prophet Esaias. And when he had opened the book, he found the place where it was written… And he began to say unto them, This day is this scripture fulfilled in your ears."

Acts 8:28–35

"…and sitting in his chariot read Esaias the prophet. Then the Spirit said unto Philip, Go near, and join thyself to this chariot… The place of the scripture which he read was this, He was led as a sheep to the slaughter… Then Philip opened his mouth, and began at the same scripture, and preached unto him Jesus."

Acts 17:11

"These were more noble than those in Thessalonica, in that they received the word with all readiness of mind, and searched the scriptures daily, whether those things were so."

2 Timothy 3:15–16

"And that from a child thou hast known the holy scriptures, which are able to make thee wise unto salvation through faith which is in Christ Jesus. All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness:"

The testimony is undeniable: the Bible calls *copies "Scripture."* It never restricts inspiration and authority to the vanished *"original autographs."* God promised to preserve His Word forever, and He did so in the copies His people held, read, preached, and believed.

Translations Can Still Be Scripture

The Bible not only calls copies Scripture but also demonstrates that the words of Scripture may pass from one language into another without ceasing to be the words of God.

Translation is often viewed as an obstacle to preserving the exact words of God. Yet God's power and promises are greater than the limitations of human translation. If God promised to preserve every word of Scripture, then we can trust that those words have been faithfully and perfectly preserved, even through translation. Just as God gave His Word in the common language of the people at the time, such as Greek, we can expect His preserved Word to be available in the common language of people today, including English. God's promise of preservation is not limited by language but extends through translation by His great power.

Pentecost Demonstrates God's Concern for Every Language

At Babel, God divided human languages. At Pentecost, He demonstrated that the gospel would cross those divisions.

> **Acts 2:6**
>
> *"Every man heard them speak in his own language."*
>
> **Acts 2:8**
>
> *"How hear we every man in our own tongue, wherein we were born?"*

Acts 2:11

"We do hear them speak in our tongues the wonderful works of God."

God was not defeated by the existence of multiple languages. The Holy Ghost enabled the wonderful works of God to be understood in the languages of the hearers.

The Great Commission itself requires translation. Christ commanded the church to teach all nations. Most nations do not speak biblical Hebrew or Greek. If the Word of God could not be faithfully carried into other languages, obedience to the Great Commission would be impossible.

A Biblical Picture of Translation

The English words *translate*, *translated*, and *translation* form an instructive pattern in the King James Bible.

2 Samuel 3:10

"To translate the kingdom from the house of Saul, and to set up the throne of David…"

The kingdom was transferred from the failing house of Saul to the throne of David, the man God had chosen.

Colossians 1:13

"Who hath delivered us from the power of darkness, and hath translated us into the kingdom of his dear Son."

The believer is translated from the power of darkness into the kingdom of God's dear Son.

Hebrews 11:5

"By faith Enoch was translated that he should not see death."

Enoch was translated so that he would not experience death.

This study of translation in the Bible gives us insight into how God views and uses the concept of translation. Scripture does not present translation as a process of decline, corruption, or deterioration. Instead, these passages describe a God-ordained movement from one state or place into another, consistently in a positive sense: from Saul's house to David's throne, from the power of darkness into Christ's kingdom, and from earthly life directly into God's presence without experiencing death.

Translation, under the hand of God, does not mean degradation. It describes faithful transfer, deliverance, advancement, and entrance into a better condition.

It is therefore not surprising that God could use faithful translation as part of the preservation and purification of His Word. The words do not become weaker merely because they cross into another language. Under God's providence, they are carried faithfully and clearly into the language of the people who need them.

This does not mean that every translation is pure. It means that a pure translation is possible.

PURIFICATION: HOW GOD ACTIVELY REFINES THE BIBLE

Now, in this subject of the Word of God and what the Bible says about the keeping of the Word of God and our grounding faith on the subject, we take a turn that most others never dare. The majority of Christianity today does not take the promises about the Bible past the point of inspiration into preservation. Even fewer take it past the promises of preservation into purification.

The irony of this is that the Bible speaks explicitly about the purification of the Word of God, just as it does about the preceding promises of inspiration and preservation.

Again, we look at **Psalm 12:6–7**:

> *"The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever."*

God explicitly promises in these verses that He is going to **purify** His Word, not just keep it, not just write it in an original form and then let it go to the wayside in a short amount of time and be gone forever, but He tells us that He is going to preserve it and, in fact, even purify it "seven times."

If you do a study of the number seven in the Bible, you will find that it represents perfection or completeness. Therefore, God is going to purify His Word until it reaches its final form—perfect, complete, and needing no further purification.

Keeping the Three Terms Separate

Inspiration is God's initial giving of His words through the prophets and apostles. **Preservation** is God's keeping of those words through history so that they do not pass away.

Purification is God's providential work of bringing the preserved words through copying, printing, translation, comparison, and reception until they stand in a settled form for His people. Purification does not mean that later translators became prophets, received new revelation, or produced a second inspired Bible.

> ➢ **NOTE**
>
> This process of purification can also be traced in the history of the English Bible. God did not give us the King James Bible all at once; rather, He refined His Word step by step through earlier English translations until it reached its final, purified form in 1611. Many have noticed how this storyline echoes the "seven times" purification in **Psalm 12**. Looking back, you can see seven big steps that led up to the King James:

1. **Wycliffe (1382) — first complete English Bible, translated from the Old Latin.**[8]
2. **Tyndale (1525) —** first English from Hebrew and Greek; laid the groundwork.
3. **Coverdale (1535) —** first complete printed English Bible, building on Tyndale.

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[8] Gail Riplinger, *In Awe of Thy Word* (Ararat, VA: AV Publications, 2003), 788–96. Riplinger explains that the myth of Wycliffe's Bible being taken from Jerome's Latin Vulgate arose from the 1850 Forshall–Madden edition, which placed the misleading phrase "made from the Latin Vulgate" on its title page. She contrasts this with a 1380 Bible title page, preserved in Foxe's *Acts and Monuments*, which reads: "translated into English from the vulgar Latin, by John Wycliffe, D.D. Rector of Lutterworth 1380" (Foxe, vol. 3, p. 64 n. 2), showing it was from the Old Latin (vulgar Latin), not Jerome's Vulgate.

4. **Matthew's (1537) —** a blend of Tyndale and Coverdale (John Rogers).
5. **Great Bible (1539) —** first "authorized" English Bible, placed in churches.
6. **Geneva (1560) —** the people's Bible, loved by the Puritans, loaded with notes.
7. **Bishops' (1568) —** a Church of England revision.

For more on this process of purification, see the chapter FROM THE RECEIVED TEXT TO THE KING JAMES BIBLE.

We see in **Proverbs 30:5–6**:

> *"Every word of God is pure: he is a shield unto them that put their trust in him. Add thou not unto his words, lest he reprove thee, and thou be found a liar."*

He is commanding that we not add to His words, but He is telling us that His Word is pure (it has been purified).

We also see in **Psalm 18:30**:

> *"As for God, his way is perfect: the word of the LORD is tried: he is a buckler to all those that trust in him."*

The Word of the LORD is tried. There are different ways you could take this, but again, in the context of seeing it as a purified, tried Book, we can see the same premise being taught here.

Dr. Edward Hills also discussed an example of this process in his book *The King James Version Defended*:

> "Through the influence of the Latin-speaking Church Erasmus and his successors were providentially guided to follow the Latin Vulgate here and there in those few

> places in which the Latin Church usage rather than the Greek Church usage had preserved the genuine reading. Hence the Textus Receptus was a further step in the providential preservation of the New Testament. In it the few errors of any consequence occurring in the Traditional Greek Text were corrected by the providence of God operating through the usage of the Latin speaking Church of Western Europe."[9]

We will look into the specific examples of where this took place in history later in this book.

Case Study: Showing Purification in Action

> **Jeremiah 36:27–28, 32**
>
> *"Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah, after that the king had burned the roll, and the words which Baruch wrote at the mouth of Jeremiah, saying, Take thee again another roll, and write in it all the former words that were in the first roll, which Jehoiakim the king of Judah hath burned. Then took Jeremiah another roll, and gave it to Baruch the scribe, the son of Neriah; who wrote therein from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the book which Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire:* ***and there were added besides unto them many like words.****"*

Lessons from Jeremiah

In this peculiar story in the book of Jeremiah, we learn many things.

We learn that those who emphasize the originals over everything else, and those who say the only goal is to recover the

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[9] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 139.

original words of the original author written down thousands of years ago are not standing on a biblical premise but a man-made construct.

When you put this story together with the other verses in the Bible promising the purification of the Word of God, you find that God is not in the business of emphasizing the "originals."

In fact, you could draw a correlation between man's obsession with the originals and the Israelites' obsession with artifacts: the sword that David killed Goliath with, the armor of Goliath, or the brazen serpent that Moses erected in the wilderness. We tend to cling to artifacts, but God does not emphasize the originals.

In this story, God did something very peculiar. He gave Jeremiah His Word and had Baruch write it down. Then He allowed that original roll to be cut up and burned, completely destroyed. So now the original copy was gone. That original manuscript, containing the verbally and plenarily inspired, inerrant words God had given Jeremiah, had been completely destroyed.

But God had promised to preserve His Word. And so He told Jeremiah to write another roll with all the former words in it. This is one of the Bible's greatest examples of preservation and purification in action.

Yet something very interesting also happened. God added to that second copy *"many like words."*

What This Shows

This means that if modern scholars had their wish, and they had the "original copy" of Jeremiah, they would in fact be missing out on the complete revelation of God, because it was the second, purified copy that had the fullness of His words.

Ask yourself: Why would God allow this to happen? Could He not have prevented the destruction of the coveted "original" copy? Could He not have just had it rewritten exactly as it was in the "original"? Why did He not include the "added" words in the original copy? God is all-knowing, all-powerful, perfect, etc. Why would He add to what He said the first time?

The answer is that God was showing us something important: that the original copy is not to be exalted or worshipped. Instead, He demonstrates His promises of preservation and purification. His Word would be preserved, and even purified through time under His guiding hand.

He gave us a case study of inspiration, preservation, and purification.

To Review:

1. The coveted "Original" Written

"Then Jeremiah called Baruch the son of Neriah: and Baruch wrote from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the LORD, which he had spoken unto him, upon a roll of a book." (**Jer. 36:4**)

2. The coveted "Original" Destroyed

"And it came to pass, that when Jehudi had read three or four leaves, he cut it with the penknife, and cast it into the fire… until all the roll was consumed in the fire that was on the hearth." (**Jer. 36:23**)

3. The Second Roll Written (preserved copy)

"Take thee again another roll, and write in it all the former words that were in the first roll, which Jehoiakim the king of Judah hath burned." (**Jer. 36:28**)

4. Additional Words Added (purified/preserved copy)

"Then took Jeremiah another roll… who wrote therein from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the book which Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire: ***and there were added besides unto them many like words." (Jer. 36:32)***

This shows God's work of ***purification.*** *The second roll was not less than the first, but greater; it contained the complete revelation God wanted preserved.*

"Double Inspiration"?

Those who poke fun at the idea of the King James Bible often say its defenders believe in "double inspiration." Nothing could be further from the truth.

Inspiration is, by definition, the initial act of God breathing out His Word. That happened once, in the originals.

But what many critics miss are the principles of **preservation** and especially **purification** as they are taught in the Bible.

God can and does providentially purify His Word, just as He did here in Jeremiah, and just as He did through history in the pure line of manuscripts and Bibles, as opposed to the corrupt line of manuscripts and Bibles.

This is not "double inspiration." It is purification. It is biblical. And it is faith-based.

Purification and Providence in the King James Bible

The same pattern we saw in Jeremiah's rolls—inspiration, destruction, preservation, and purification—can be traced throughout the history of God's dealings with His Word. Just as God added "many like words" to Jeremiah's second roll, He has,

in His providence, brought His Word through a refining process in history until it reached its purified form in the English tongue.

Over the centuries, copies of the biblical text were multiplied, copied, and sometimes corrupted through human error or neglect. Yet at every turn, God intervened to **preserve and purify** His Word through faithful believers, translators, and churches who refused to let the Scriptures be lost. This culminated in what we now recognize as the **King James Bible of 1611**, not as a new inspiration, but as the *purified* and *preserved* text God promised.

Just as the first roll in Jeremiah's day was destroyed but replaced and expanded by the hand of God, so too did many original manuscripts of the New Testament perish in time. Yet the words they contained were never lost. God preserved them through faithful copies, translations, and even through unexpected means such as the **Latin Church's transmission of key readings**. Dr. Edward Hills explained this very principle:

> "Through the influence of the Latin-speaking Church Erasmus and his successors were providentially guided to follow the Latin Vulgate here and there in those few places in which the Latin Church usage rather than the Greek Church usage had preserved the genuine reading."[10]

One of the clearest examples of this is found in **1 John 5:7**, the famous Trinitarian passage known as the *Comma Johanneum*:

> *"For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one."*

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[10] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 139.

Although the verse had fallen out of many Greek copies by the Middle Ages, it continued to be preserved in the **Old Latin** and **Vulgate traditions**. When Erasmus compiled his first edition of the *Textus Receptus* in 1516, this verse was absent because it was missing in the limited Greek manuscripts available to him. Yet believers across Europe raised a strong objection, pointing to its presence in Latin manuscripts and its quotation by early church fathers such as Cyprian (A.D. 250). When later shown Greek evidence that contained the verse (now known as Codex 61, *Montfortianus*), Erasmus included it in his third edition of 1522, thereby restoring what had been preserved outside the Alexandrian stream.

This is a vivid demonstration of God's purifying hand: **what appeared lost was brought back**. As Hills noted, the providence of God was operating through both the Greek and Latin lines to restore the full, genuine reading of Scripture. Through that process of weighing, refining, and reuniting the witness of the faithful manuscripts, God purified His Word for the English-speaking world.

When the King James translators began their monumental work in 1604, they built upon this purified text, the *Textus Receptus* of Erasmus, Stephanus, and Beza, and upon the purified stream of English Bibles that preceded it (Wycliffe through Geneva). In this we see not mere human scholarship, but God still at work in the process. God's promise in **Psalm 12:6–7** was once again proven true:

> *"The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever."*

The King James Bible stands as the fruit of that sevenfold purification, both linguistically and textually. It is not the result

of "double inspiration," but rather of **purification**, a perfect reflection of God's own nature and His faithfulness to preserve His words in every generation.

The Choice: Purification or Degradation

The process was filled with textual, translational, and manuscript decisions, each of which required faith. Whether it was Erasmus in his handling of **1 John 5:7**, the KJV translators weighing variant readings, or generations of believers discerning which line of manuscripts to follow, the question always comes down to this:

Do you believe God is still in the process?

If you believe that He is, then you must also believe that God has fulfilled His promise to preserve and purify His Word. That means there is, today, a perfect Book in English you can trust 100 percent—pure, infallible, inerrant, and complete in every word/marking (jot/tittle), ***not just in the message, ideas, or main teachings*** **(this is not what the Bible teaches)**. God's hand did not stop moving in the first century; His promise did not expire when the last apostle died. The same God who inspired His Word has also preserved and purified it through time, language, and translation.

If, however, you believe that God is no longer in the process, then you are left with the unavoidable conclusion that **no perfect Bible exists today—that what we hold** is, at best, a fallible approximation of the lost originals. That view makes the Bible a product of man's imperfection rather than God's preservation.

There are only two mindsets when it comes to the Word of God:

Preservation and Purification	**Reconstruction and Degradation**
Begins with God's promises	Begins with human critical judgment
Believes God preserved His words	Believes the original wording must be reconstructed
Evidence is understood through Scripture	Scripture is treated like other ancient literature
Follows the Traditional/Byzantine stream	Follows the modern eclectic Critical Text
Associated with Antioch	Associated with Egypt
Receives the text copied and used by the churches	Takes readings from manuscripts that disagree and that were rejected by the church
Sees the received text as settled	Keeps the text open to continuing revision
Emphasizes formal, word-for-word translation	Emphasizes thought-for-thought translation
Produces confidence in a Bible that can be trusted as perfect	Produces doubt and uncertainty about what the Bible really should say
Points to the KJV as the preserved English Bible	Does not identify one perfect and settled English Bible

Either God has kept His promise, or He has not. Either His Word today is pure and preserved, or it is partial and polluted.

FAITH BASED VIEW OF SCRIPTURE

By Faith we Believe God's Promise that He Inspired his word

2 Timothy 3:16- All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness:
2 Peter 1:21- For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man: but holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost.
Acts 1:16- Men and brethren, this scripture must needs have been fulfilled, which the Holy Ghost by the mouth of David spake before concerning Judas, which was guide to them that took Jesus.
Acts 28:25- And when they agreed not among themselves, they departed, after that Paul had spoken one word, Well spake the Holy Ghost by Esaias the prophet unto our fathers,
Acts 3:18- But those things, which God before had shewed by the mouth of all his prophets, that Christ should suffer, he hath so fulfilled.
Mark 12:36- For David himself said by the Holy Ghost, The LORD said to my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand, till I make thine enemies thy footstool.

By Faith we Believe God's Promise to Preserve His inspired word

Matthew 24:35- Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away.
1 Peter 1:23- Being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which liveth and abideth for ever.
Psalm 12:6-7- The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.
Psalm 111:7-8- The works of his hands are verity and judgment; all his commandments are sure. They stand fast for ever and ever, and are done in truth and uprightness.
Psalm 117:2- For his merciful kindness is great toward us: and the truth of the LORD endureth for ever. Praise ye the LORD.
Psalm 119:152, 160- Concerning thy testimonies, I have known of old that thou hast founded them for ever. Thy word is true from the beginning: and every one of thy righteous judgments endureth for ever.

By Faith we Believe God's Promise to Purify His word

Psalm 12:6-7- The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.
Jeremiah 36- ..... "Then took Jeremiah another roll, and gave it to Baruch the scribe, the son of Neriah; who wrote therein from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the book which Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire: and there were added besides unto them many like words."
Psalm 66:10- For thou, O God, hast proved us: thou hast tried us, as silver is tried.
Psalm 18:30- As for God, his way is perfect: the word of the LORD is tried: he is a buckler to all those that trust in him.
2 Samuel 22:31- As for God, his way is perfect; the word of the LORD is tried: he is a buckler to all them that trust in him.
Proverbs 30:5- Every word of God is pure: he is a shield unto them that put their trust in him.

By Faith we Believe God is Inseparable from His word

Psalm 138:2- I will worship toward thy holy temple, and praise thy name for thy lovingkindness and for thy truth: for thou hast magnified thy word above all thy name.
Titus 1:2- In hope of eternal life, which God, that cannot lie, promised before the world began;
Numbers 23:19- God is not a man, that he should lie; neither the son of man, that he should repent: hath he said, and shall he not do it? or hath he spoken, and shall he not make it good?
1 Samuel 15:29- And also the Strength of Israel will not lie nor repent: for he is not a man, that he should repent.
John 1:1,14- In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.

All different versions of the Bible say different things. They all can't be 100% correct because they say different things, and in many places opposite things; that would be impossible. Would you be confident placing your eternity in the hands of a book you can only trust 90% of the time, or even 99% of the time? You don't have to settle for less than 100% certainty. Because of the promises of God we have concerning his word, you can know which one to trust 100% of the time!

WAR ON WORDS

While God is committed to purifying His words, the devil is committed to corrupting them. This has been true from Genesis onward.

I put this section underneath the faith-based view of the Word of God because I believe that not understanding this issue in the Bible will ultimately be a detriment to anybody who endeavors to study the Word of God in its transmission through time, and where it exists today. To not understand the spiritual warfare on the Word of God from the Bible itself will leave you lacking in your ability to discern what the Word of God is, where it is, where the work of God is throughout history, and where the work of the devil is.

In the same 2025 interview, Wesley Huff said:

> "There aren't people behind the scenes who are mischievously trying to take out verses of our Bible to hide things or create contradictions. If that were true, then if you look at the so-called missing verses, they're doing a really bad job of it. They're basically taking out inconsequential verses while leaving in some pretty big verses that have major doctrinal effects. So if this is a nefarious conspiracy to remove doctrines or ideas from Scripture, whoever is taking these verses out is doing a pretty bad job of it."[11]

This statement again lacks a biblical, spiritual, faith-based understanding on this subject. Scholars who seek to understand this issue only from the carnal viewpoint of man, science,

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[11] "Part 1: Answering King James Only w/ Wes Huff," 56:00.

philosophy, and textual criticism and not through the lens of the Word of God will be left in the dark.

By faith, we believe that the Bible teaches that there is a pointed and concerted effort from the forces of spiritual wickedness to corrupt the Word of God.

God's Repeated Warnings

God, from the very beginning of His Word, warns mankind not to add to His Word or take away from His Word. In the very middle of His Word, in the book of Proverbs, He gives the same warning (**Prov. 30:5–6**). At the very end, in the book of Revelation, He gives it again (**Rev. 22:18–19**). All throughout the Bible, God places warnings against adding to or taking away from His words.

False Letters in the Early Church

Even in the days of the apostles, the integrity of God's Word was under attack. Paul had to warn believers about false letters that were being circulated in his name. In **2 Thessalonians 2:2**, he cautions the church not to be *"shaken in mind"* or deceived by *"spirit, nor by word, nor by* ***letter as from us****."* Later, in **2 Thessalonians 3:17**, he made it a point to identify his own hand in writing, so that the churches could recognize the true Word from counterfeit documents. These warnings show that even while the New Testament was being penned and circulated, Satan was already working to undermine its authority by slipping in corrupted *"copies."*

The Devil's First Appearance

The very first time that the devil shows up in the Bible is in **Genesis 3**, and right from the start, he is attacking the foundation of our faith: the Word of God.

1. He Questions the Word of God

"Yea, hath God said…?" (Gen. 3:1)

I've spent a significant amount of time in colleges and seminaries and listening to various opinions on the Bible itself, manuscript evidence, and textual criticism. And I found that this is the core question of textual criticism: *"Yea, hath God said?"*

There's just enough doubt inserted as to what was originally said, whether it exists today, and where it is found in the manuscripts, that it creates confusion in the mind of the reader. It causes them to doubt the authenticity of the Bible, or at least specific passages. This is exactly what it did in the mind of Eve.

2. He Contradicts the Word of God

"…Yea, hath God said, Ye shall not eat of every tree of the garden?" (**Genesis 3:1**)

That twist was the point. God had not said they were forbidden to eat of every tree. Eve initially corrected the claim, saying that only one tree was off-limits. But the seed of doubt and contradiction had already been planted.

3. He Changes the Word of God

"Ye shall not surely die." (**Genesis 3:4**)

God had been perfectly clear that in the day they ate of the tree, they would die. Satan contradicted this directly, convincing Eve that God was withholding something from her.

Eve's Addition

Notice also that Eve, in her response, added to God's Word:

"…neither shall ye touch it, lest ye die." (**Genesis 3:3**)

God never said they could not *touch* it. But with the devil questioning, contradicting, and changing God's Word, Eve herself misquoted Him, adding something He never commanded.

The Pattern

So in just a few verses we see the entire satanic strategy:

- Question the Word of God.
- Contradict the Word of God.
- Change the Word of God.

This pattern has never stopped. It is the same today as it was then.

The devil convinced Eve that God was holding out on her, hiding knowledge from her, by questioning His Word, contradicting it, and then changing it. Through this, the human race fell from perfection and intimate fellowship with Christ in the garden into the chaos, sin, and death we now see. And all it took was an attack on the Word of God.

The Continuing Attack

I submit to you that the devil has not stopped his attack on the Word of God from that very day. From the very beginning of Scripture's writing, there have been attacks on the Word of God. To deny this is to miss one of the central themes of the Bible: the devil is in the business of corrupting what God has spoken. Scholars may say, "There is nobody out there trying to corrupt your Bible or your manuscripts." But the Bible itself tells us otherwise. To not believe that the devil is trying to change what God said, contradict what God said, or question what God said in order to cause us to sin or to waver from the faith, is to reject the testimony of Scripture. By faith, we believe that there is a

pointed attack on the Word of God today by the devil and his angels.

Note:

Many claim that this issue of Bible versions is overblown and that the versions all tend to say the same things, teach the same things, and have no major differences. The irony of this is that we find not "small changes" but outright opposite teachings within the ***same chapter*** where God shows us Satan's method of attacking the Word of God.

Example: Genesis 3:16

In the King James Bible, God's judgment upon the woman is clear:

> *"Unto the woman he said, I will greatly multiply thy sorrow and thy conception; in sorrow thou shalt bring forth children;* ***and thy desire shall be to thy husband, and he shall rule over thee."*** (**Gen. 3:16**)

The KJV renders this as the wife's desire being *toward* her husband, fitting the natural, God-ordained order of marriage. The consequence of the Fall is pain in childbearing and a struggle of submission, but the structure is consistent: her desire is *to her husband,* and he shall rule over her.

Now compare the English Standard Version (ESV):

> *"To the woman he said, 'I will surely multiply your pain in childbearing; in pain you shall bring forth children.* ***Your desire shall be contrary to your husband, but he shall rule over you.'" (Gen. 3:16, ESV)***

Notice the difference: instead of being *to her husband,* the woman's desire is rendered as *contrary to her husband.* That is not a minor adjustment of language; it is the exact opposite. In one,

the wife's desire is directed *toward* her husband. In the other, her desire is set *against* him.

TEXTUAL TRANSMISSION AND THE TWO TEXTUAL STREAMS: ANTIOCH AND ALEXANDRIA

How Scripture Reached Us

Before examining the two lines of manuscripts, we must understand how the words of Scripture moved from the original writings to an English Bible.

The **original documents** written by the prophets and apostles are commonly called the **autographs**. ***Those physical documents are no longer known to exist***, but their words were copied and circulated in manuscripts.

A **manuscript** is a handwritten copy containing all or part of a biblical book. Because manuscripts were copied by hand, variations, called **textual variants**, occurred in some of them. A variant may involve a single letter, the order of words, a missing or duplicated word, or something as long as a sentence. The existence of a variant does not mean that the entire Bible was lost; it means that the surviving copies must be compared.

As manuscripts were copied and passed on, manuscripts that repeatedly **shared similar readings** formed recognizable textual traditions, also called text forms or **text types**. Two principal traditions considered in this book are the **Byzantine text** and the **Alexandrian text**. The Byzantine text is the form of the Greek New Testament found in the majority of surviving Greek manuscripts. The Alexandrian text represents a different group of readings associated especially with manuscripts preserved in Egypt. These names describe general patterns of readings; they do not mean that every manuscript within a group is identical.

From Manuscripts to Printed Greek Texts

The invention of movable-type printing revolutionized the way the biblical text was circulated. Instead of producing one

handwritten manuscript at a time, printers could publish many identical copies of a complete Greek New Testament.

The first published Greek New Testament was issued in 1516 by Desiderius Erasmus, who released revised editions in 1519, 1522, 1527, and 1535. Robert Estienne, or Stephanus, then published four editions in 1546, 1549, 1550, and 1551. Theodore Beza followed with a series of Greek New Testament editions. His 1588–89 and 1598 editions were particularly influential and were used extensively by the King James translators.[12] [13]

These editions were closely related, although they did not agree in every reading. Collectively, this family of printed Greek editions later became known as the **Textus Receptus**, or "Received Text." The name derives from the Latin wording in the preface to the Elzevir edition of 1633: "Therefore you have the text now received by all" (*Textum ergo habes, nunc ab omnibus receptum*).[14]

The Textus Receptus is therefore not one ancient manuscript or one completely uniform printed edition. It is a family of closely related printed Greek New Testaments produced during and after the Reformation. Because the manuscripts and earlier editions used by its editors predominantly represented the

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[12] Bruce M. Metzger and Bart D. Ehrman, *The Text of the New Testament: Its Transmission, Corruption, and Restoration*, 4th ed. (New York: Oxford University Press, 2005), 142–52.

[13] Lincoln H. Blumell, "The Greek New Testament Text of the King James Version," in *New Testament History, Culture, and Society: A Background to the Texts of the New Testament*, ed. Lincoln H. Blumell (Provo, UT: Religious Studies Center, Brigham Young University; Salt Lake City: Deseret Book, 2019), 691–92.

[14] J. K. Elliott, "'Novum Testamentum editum est': The Five-Hundredth Anniversary of Erasmus's New Testament," *The Bible Translator* 67, no. 1 (2016): 24, https://doi.org/10.1177/2051677016628242.

Byzantine tradition, the Textus Receptus is predominantly Byzantine rather than Alexandrian in character.

The terms Byzantine Text, Majority Text, and Textus Receptus are closely related, but they are not completely interchangeable. The Byzantine Text is a textual tradition represented by a large body of manuscripts. The Majority Text refers to the readings found in the majority of surviving manuscripts and, by extension, to modern printed Greek editions constructed from those readings. The Textus Receptus refers to the family of printed Greek editions associated particularly with Erasmus, Stephanus, Beza, and the Elzevirs.

F. H. A. Scrivener's Greek New Testament came later than the King James Bible. Scrivener did not provide the Greek text used by the KJV translators. He compared the New Testament of the KJV with the earlier printed Greek editions and reconstructed what he believed to be the Greek text underlying the KJV's readings.[15]

Modern critical editions follow a different editorial approach. The Nestle–Aland 28th edition and the United Bible Societies' 5th edition—commonly called NA28 and UBS5—present essentially the same edited Greek text. They compare evidence from several manuscript traditions but give greater weight to manuscripts commonly associated with the Alexandrian text type. Many modern English New Testaments are translated from this Critical Text.

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[15] F. H. A. Scrivener, ed., The New Testament in the Original Greek according to the Text Followed in the Authorised Version, Together with the Variations Adopted in the Revised Version (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1881), vii–xii, 648–56.

From Printed Texts to English Translations

Translation is the next step. Translators take a printed Hebrew or Greek text and render its words into another language. Therefore, a difference between two English Bibles may arise for either of two reasons: the translators may be using different underlying Hebrew or Greek readings, or they may translate the same reading differently.

The process may be summarized as follows:

> ***Original writings → handwritten manuscripts → textual variants → textual traditions → printed Hebrew and Greek texts → English translations***

This order matters. Manuscripts are the handwritten witnesses. A text type identifies a recognizable pattern of readings shared among manuscripts. A printed Greek text presents the readings selected by its editors. An English Bible then translates that printed text into English.

With this process established, we can now examine the two principal textual traditions at issue in this book.

Two Starting Points: Preservation or Reconstruction

Before examining Antioch and Alexandria, we must understand that the difference between the two textual streams is not merely geographical. Behind them stand two different ways of approaching the Word of God.

The Naturalistic Method

The naturalistic method treats the text of the New Testament according to the same basic rules used for other ancient literature. It may acknowledge that the Bible is religiously important, but it does not permit the doctrines of inspiration and

preservation to determine the method by which the text is established.

Under this approach, the textual critic begins with the surviving manuscripts and reconstructs what he believes the original authors most likely wrote. No presently received text is treated as final. Every reading remains open to reconsideration when new evidence, theories, or methods arise.

This method may be followed by men who personally profess belief in inspiration. The issue is not merely the private profession of the scholar. The issue is whether his method consciously submits to what the Bible teaches concerning its own inspiration and preservation.

When inspiration and preservation are removed from the method of textual criticism, the Bible is treated as though its textual history were essentially no different from that of Homer, Plato, or any other ancient work. The result is a text reconstructed according to scholarly probability rather than a received text approached in light of God's promises concerning His Word.

But the Bible is not an ordinary book. Its prophetic, historical, doctrinal, and even scientific claims bear a character that cannot adequately be explained as being a human construct. Because Scripture is self-authenticating, we therefore allow what the Bible says about itself to shape the way we approach its textual history. This is not a circular argument; it begins with the self-evidencing character of Scripture and then takes seriously its own teachings concerning inspiration, preservation, the priesthood of believers, and the significance of places such as Antioch and Alexandria. If these biblical doctrines and historical patterns are meaningful, then they should not be excluded when considering manuscripts, textual criticism, and Bible versions.

The Faith-Based Method

Edward Hills called the alternatives "the consistently Christian method and the naturalistic method."

The consistently Christian method begins with what God has revealed concerning His Word:

- God inspired His words.
- God promised to preserve those words.
- Christ declared that His words would not pass away.
- Scripture cannot be broken.
- God placed the Old Testament in the custody of the Jews.
- God placed the New Testament in the life and usage of believing churches.

This method does not reject manuscript evidence, ancient versions, church fathers, grammar, history, or careful scholarship. It rejects the idea that these things may be interpreted independently of Scripture.

The evidence must be understood through the truth God has already revealed.

Why the Starting Point Determines the Result

If a man begins by assuming that the Bible was transmitted like any other book, he will naturally search for the oldest surviving materials and attempt to reconstruct the original wording from them.

If a man begins by believing that God preserved His Word publicly for His people, he will naturally ask which text was

continuously read, copied, preached, translated, and received by the churches.

The two men may examine the same manuscript and reach different conclusions because they are asking different questions.

One asks:

> "Which reading appears most probable according to the principles of textual criticism?"

The other asks:

> "Which reading fits the promises of preservation and the historical usage of God's people?"

This is the deeper issue behind the two textual streams.

With these two starting points established, we can now examine the cities, manuscripts, men, and historical fruit associated with each stream.

Byzantine (Antiochian) vs. Alexandrian Text Types

When you trace the history of the Bible, it becomes clear that there has always been a battle over the text. This battle is not new. From the Garden of Eden, the very first recorded words of the serpent were: *"Yea, hath God said?"* (**Gen. 3:1**). Satan's strategy has not changed in six thousand years. The question before us is not whether there are different manuscripts, languages, or translations. The real question is: **Why are there conflicting lines of manuscripts? Why do some say one thing and other lines from other areas say other things? Can we ground our understanding of which lines we should trust in the Word of God (faith-based)? If we can, then we can see where God is purifying His Word versus where Satan is corrupting His Word.**

The evidence of Scripture and history says yes. When you study the story of the transmission of the Bible, it comes down to a tale of two cities: **Antioch** and **Alexandria**. One city represents missions, evangelism, and doctrinal purity. The other represents philosophy, corruption, and compromise. This is not just a matter of geography; it is a matter of spiritual lineage and biblical principles (faith-based). The manuscripts that come from these places bear the fruit of the soil in which they grew.

Antioch: The Line of Preservation

The Bible itself highlights Antioch as a city of great spiritual importance.

- **Acts 11:26** tells us, "*the disciples were called Christians first in Antioch.*" The very name "*Christian*" was born there, not in Jerusalem, Rome, or Alexandria.
- In **Acts 13:1–3**, Antioch becomes the **missions hub** of the New Testament. It was from Antioch that Paul and Barnabas were sent out by the Holy Ghost on the first missionary journey. This city was the launching pad of gospel expansion. The light of world evangelism began to blaze from Antioch.

It is no coincidence that the **text of Scripture preserved and used by the churches** came from this same region. Antioch represents the spirit of obedience to the Word of God. It represents evangelism, church planting, doctrinal faithfulness, and biblical literalism. Historically, the manuscripts associated with Antioch became the **Byzantine Text**, later known as the **Textus Receptus**.

Over 5,000 Greek manuscripts (80–95 percent of the evidence) agree with this line of text.[16] [17]

These were the Scriptures preached in the Greek-speaking churches. They were the basis of the Old Latin Bible (Itala, second century) and the Syriac Peshitta (second century). Early church fathers quoted them thousands of times. Polycarp, a direct disciple of the apostle John, quoted readings found in the Textus Receptus. His disciple, Irenaeus (A.D. 130–200), did the same. Irenaeus and Cyprian quoted controversial passages such as 1 John 5:7 and Mark 16:9–20, which modern critical texts leave out. This proves that these verses are not "*later additions,*" but part of the Bible known and received in the earliest centuries.

Dean John Burgon, who collated these manuscripts in the nineteenth century, wrote in *The Revision Revised*:[18]

> "Lectionaries abound, which establish the Text which has been publicly read in the churches of the East, from at least A.D. 400 until the time of the invention of printing."

In the same work, Burgon wrote:[19]

> "…the Text which, by the good Providence of GOD, was universally employed throughout Europe for the first 300 years after the invention of printing… being

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[16] Wilbur N. Pickering, *The Identity of the New Testament Text IV* (Brasília: Wilbur N. Pickering, 2014), 114.

[17] Zane C. Hodges and Arthur L. Farstad, eds., *The Greek New Testament According to the Majority Text*, 2nd ed. (Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1985), v–vi.

[18] John William Burgon, *The Revision Revised* (London: John Murray, 1883), 11.

[19] Burgon, *Revision Revised*, 386.

> practically identical with the Text which … was in popular use at the end of three centuries from the date of the sacred autographs themselves: in other words, being more than 1500 years old."

The Textus Receptus is the text that the body of Christ used, copied, and believed through the centuries. It is called the "Received Text" because the churches received it as the Word of God.

What About Heresy in Antioch?

Some critics answer this contrast by pointing to Paul of Samosata and to later Arian or semi-Arian figures associated with Antioch and Syria. Their argument is that Antioch also experienced heresy and therefore should not be contrasted with Alexandria as the standard. However, the argument in this section is faith-based: it concerns the pattern established by Scripture, not the claim that every person who ever lived in Antioch was doctrinally sound. The Bible never presents Antioch as a source or symbol of corruption. Instead, it consistently presents the church at Antioch as an example of early Christian faithfulness, teaching, missions, and service.

Antioch was where the disciples were first called Christians, where Barnabas and Paul taught many people, and where believers provided relief for suffering brethren in Judaea (**Acts 11:26–30**). It was also from Antioch that the Holy Ghost sent Paul and Barnabas on their missionary work, and it was there that they returned and reported what God had done (**Acts 13:1–3**; 14:26–28). The church later received the decision of the Jerusalem council and rejoiced in its confirmation of the truth (**Acts 15:22–35**). Later heresies associated with that region do not erase the consistently positive biblical testimony concerning Antioch or invalidate the faith-based contrast being made.

Alexandria: The Line of Corruption

The Law of First Mention: Egypt as Bondage and Compromise

The law of first mention is a Bible study principle: the first time a subject shows up in Scripture, it often sets the tone for how it's treated later. Egypt's first appearance is **Genesis 12:10**. Abraham "*went down into Egypt*" during a famine, and there he slipped into fear and lies about Sarah. That opening scene isn't an accident; it frames Egypt as a place where God's people are tempted to compromise.

The thread keeps running through the Bible:

- **Exodus 12–14 —** Israel's greatest rescue is *out of* Egypt: out of slavery, idolatry, and paganism.
- **Exodus 12:12 —** The plagues are God's judgment on Egypt's gods.
- **Isaiah 31:1; Jeremiah 42:19 —** The prophets warn, again and again: don't go back to Egypt for help.

Put simply, the Bible does not paint Egypt in a positive light. Throughout the Bible, Egypt is repeatedly connected with bondage, idolatry, compromise, and trusting in something other than God.

- God says in **Exodus 20:2**: "*I am the LORD thy God, which have brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage.*" Egypt is bondage.
- **Isaiah 30:1–2** warns God's people not to go down to Egypt for help, because it represents dependence on the world instead of on God.

- **Revelation 11:8** calls Jerusalem, in its apostasy, "*spiritually… Egypt.*" Egypt is a symbol of corruption, apostasy, and worldliness.

So, it is no surprise that when we study the history of Bible manuscripts, those that come out of Alexandria are marked by doctrinal corruption.

The book of Acts gives us hints of this:

- **Acts 6:9** records that some of the false witnesses who disputed with Stephen came from the "*synagogue of the Libertines, and Cyrenians, and Alexandrians.*" The opposition to God's preacher came out of Alexandria.

- **Acts 18:24–26** tells us of Apollos, an eloquent preacher from Alexandria, who knew the Scriptures but had doctrinal deficiencies. He needed Aquila and Priscilla to "*expound unto him the way of God more perfectly.*" Again, the Bible subtly points out that Alexandria, Egypt, produced men eloquent in speech but tied to false doctrine.

But Egypt Is Not Always Bad, Right?

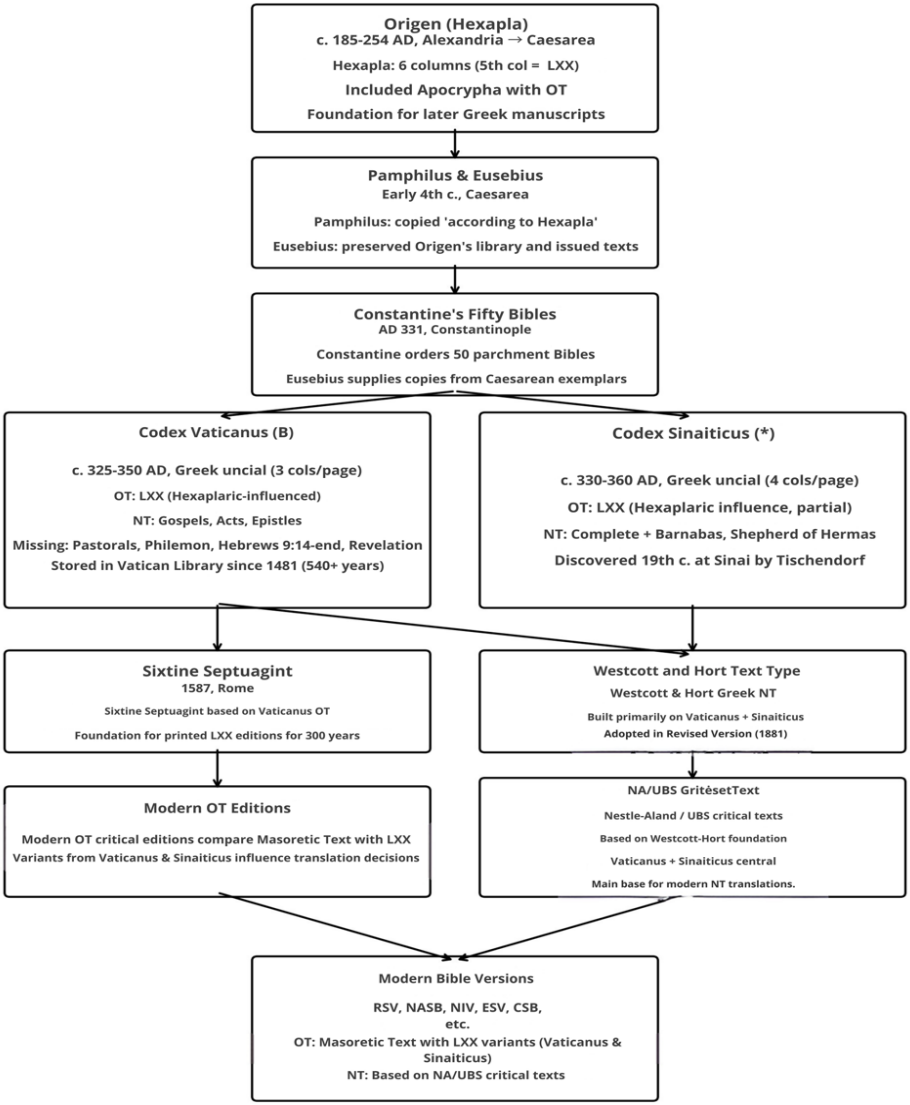
Some critics point out that Egypt is not presented negatively in every passage. Under Joseph, Egypt became God's means of preserving Jacob's family during the famine (**Gen. 45:5–8**; 46:3–4). It later provided temporary shelter for the young Lord Jesus from Herod (**Matt. 2:13–15**), and Isaiah records the future blessing, "*Blessed be Egypt my people*" (**Isa. 19:25**).

These exceptions, however, do not erase the dominant biblical pattern concerning Egypt. A biblical pattern is established by the consistent testimony of Scripture, not overturned by a few exceptional circumstances in which God providentially used a place for good. In keeping with the law of first mention, Egypt's first explicit appearance in **Genesis 12:10–20** connects

Abraham's descent into Egypt with fear and compromise. Later, Egypt becomes the "house of bondage," the object of God's judgment, and the place to which Israel was repeatedly warned not to return or look for help. **Revelation 11:8** even uses Egypt spiritually as a picture of apostasy. Therefore, although God occasionally used Egypt for protection or preservation, its dominant biblical identity remains one of bondage, worldly dependence, compromise, and corruption.

The most famous name tied to Alexandria is **Origen (A.D. 184–254)**.

Origen → Codex Vaticanus & Sinaiticus → Modern Versions



Flowchart shows Origen's Hexapla → Constantine's Fifty Bibles → Codex Vaticanus & Sinaiticus → Sixtine LXX (OT) & Westcott-Hort (NT) → NA/UBS → Modern Versions.

Codex Vaticanus stored in Vatican Library since 1481 (540+ years).

KEY: The main manuscripts and texts that are used in producing modern Bibles can be directly traced back to Alexandria, Egypt and the work of Origen.[20] [21] [22] [23] [24]

Origen was heretical. He denied the literal interpretation of Scripture[25], taught the pre-existence of souls[26], flirted with universal salvation[27], and mutilated the text of Scripture.[28]

Philip Schaff (professor of church history at Mercersburg and Union Seminary) said this of Origen:[29]

> "The predilection of Origen for Plato misled him into many grand and fascinating errors."

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[20] Anneli Aejmelaeus, "New Perspectives on the Textual Character of Codex Vaticanus," *Svensk Exegetisk Årsbok* 85 (2020): 3–17.

[21] Eusebius of Caesarea, *Life of Constantine*, trans. Averil Cameron and Stuart G. Hall (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1999), 166–69 (IV.36–37).

[22] T. C. Skeat, "The Codex Sinaiticus, the Codex Vaticanus and Constantine," *Journal of Theological Studies*, n.s., 50, no. 2 (1999): 583–625.

[23] Kristin De Troyer, "The Septuagint," in *The New Cambridge History of the Bible*, vol. 1, *From the Beginnings to 600*, ed. James Carleton Paget and Joachim Schaper (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2013), 267–88.

[24] Metzger and Ehrman, *Text of the New Testament*, 174–82, 305–13 (Westcott–Hort's privileging of B/א and the downstream influence on NA/UBS).

[25] Origen, *De Principiis*, in *Ante-Nicene Fathers*, vol. 4, ed. Alexander Roberts and James Donaldson (Grand Rapids: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 2006), 230.

[26] Origen, *De Principiis*, II.3.3, 273.

[27] Origen, *De Principiis*, I.6.1–3, 259–61.

[28] Origen, *De Principiis*, 230–31.

[29] Philip Schaff, History of the Christian Church, vol. 2, *Ante-Nicene Christianity*, A.D. 100–325 (New York: Charles Scribner's Sons, 1910), 791.

He was more of a philosopher and heretic than he was a Bible believer.

Benjamin Wilkinson summed up the beliefs of Origen well:[30]

> "He taught that the soul existed from eternity before it inhabited the body, and that after death, it migrated to a higher or a lower form of life according to the deeds done in the body; and finally all would return to the state of pure intelligence, only to begin again the same cycle as before. He believed that the devils would be saved, and that the stars and planets had souls, and were, like men, on trial to learn perfection. In fact, he turned the whole law and Gospel into an allegory."

His "great" work, the **Hexapla**, placed the Apocrypha alongside the inspired books and mingled together Greek translations in a way that caused great confusion. From this poisoned spring came much of what later influenced Jerome's Vulgate[31], the Vatican manuscript tradition, and ultimately the modern critical text.

The Alexandrian manuscripts themselves bear this corruption:

- **Codex Vaticanus (B) lacks entire books** (Revelation, the Pastoral Epistles, etc.).
- **Codex Sinaiticus (א)**, discovered in a wastebasket at St. Catherine's monastery, contains thousands of corrections by multiple hands.

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[30] Benjamin G. Wilkinson, Our Authorized Bible Vindicated (Washington, DC: n.p., 1930), 14.

[31] Henry Barclay Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 69–72.

- **Codex Alexandrinus (A)**, a later manuscript, mixes text types and is riddled with inconsistencies.

These manuscripts form less than 2 percent of the evidence, yet they are exalted by modern critics as "older and better." The truth is that most are not in fact older; and the few that are older are only so because they were rejected and unused by the churches. Like an unused tool left to rust in a closet, they survived because they were never trusted or worn out in preaching, copying, and evangelism.

In discussing the corruption of Egypt and its manuscripts, Dr. Edward Hills stated,[32]

> "Thus we see that it is unwise in present-day translators to base the texts of their modern versions on recent papyrus discoveries or on B and Aleph. For all these documents come from Egypt, and Egypt during the early Christian centuries was a land in which heresies were rampant. So much was this so that, as Bauer (1934) and van Unnik (1958) have pointed out, later Egyptian Christians seem to have been ashamed of the heretical past of their country and to have drawn a veil of silence across it. This seems to be why so little is known of the history of early Egyptian Christianity. In view, therefore, of the heretical character of the early Egyptian Church, it is not surprising that the papyri, B, Aleph, and other manuscripts which hail from Egypt are liberally sprinkled with heretical readings."

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[32] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 173.

Tale of Two Cities

When you put the pieces together, the contrast could not be clearer:

- Antioch is where believers were first called Christians. Alexandria is where false doctrine thrived.
- Antioch was the hub of missions. Alexandria was the center of philosophy.
- Antioch gave us the Textus Receptus and the Bibles of the Reformation. Alexandria gave us Vaticanus, Sinaiticus, and the critical text that underlies modern versions.
- Antioch's line has borne the fruit of revival, missions, and doctrinal clarity. Alexandria's line has borne the fruit of skepticism, confusion, and doctrinal erosion.

Jesus said: "*Ye shall know them by their fruits*" (**Matt. 7:16**). Look at the fruits. The Reformation, the Great Awakenings, the missionary movements, all came from the Antiochian line of Bibles. In contrast, the line of Alexandria produced a stream of corrupted manuscripts, the rationalism of the Enlightenment, the skepticism of higher criticism, and a flood of modern versions that contradict one another and erode doctrines such as the deity of Christ, the virgin birth, the blood atonement, and the Trinity.

This is why the issue of "two lines of Bibles" is not about academic trivialities. It is a spiritual battlefield. The Word of God has always had enemies. But praise God, He has always preserved His Word for His people.

"Reasoned Eclecticism" and Why the Issue Still Matters

Some readers today argue that the discussion over *Alexandrian* versus *Byzantine* manuscripts is outdated because modern editors of the Greek New Testament supposedly no longer rely

on an "Alexandrian text," but on a method called reasoned eclecticism. On the surface, this seems to represent a break from the nineteenth-century theories of Westcott and Hort. In reality, however, it is largely a continuation of the same critical approach under a new name.

Reasoned eclecticism is the method employed in the Nestle–Aland (NA28/NA29) and United Bible Societies (UBS5) texts. It claims to "weigh" each variant reading on both *external* evidence (the age and quality of the manuscripts) and *internal* evidence (which reading best fits the author's style or the immediate context). In theory, this method allows any reading, from any text type, to be adopted if it seems to have the best combined support. Yet in practice, the same pattern seen since 1881 continues: the editors almost always prefer readings found in Vaticanus (B), Sinaiticus (א), and their Alexandrian allies.

Dr. Bruce Metzger, who served on the UBS Editorial Committee, repeatedly describes these favored witnesses as "the *earliest and best*," and commends readings "absent from the earliest and best authorities."[33] This phrase appears throughout the UBS textual commentary, showing that *reasoned eclecticism* still operates from the same presupposition: that the Alexandrian manuscripts are superior by virtue of their age and Egyptian provenance.

Likewise, Kurt and Barbara Aland, architects of the modern Nestle–Aland text, formally classify nearly all Byzantine manuscripts as Category V, defining them as "purely or predominantly Byzantine" and therefore "irrelevant for

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[33] Bruce M. Metzger, *A Textual Commentary on the Greek New Testament*, 2nd ed. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1994), 50 (Matt. 23:14), 79–80 (John 5:3b–4), passim.

establishing the original form of the text."[34] Their system ensures that, even under an "eclectic" model, Byzantine readings are almost always excluded before the process of weighing begins.

The result is that the Nestle–Aland/UBS text of today *is 98–99 percent identical to the Westcott and Hort text of 1881*.[35] As Gregory Lanier demonstrates in his comparative study, "the modern critical text is remarkably stable since the late nineteenth century," differing only minimally in the Catholic Epistles and Acts, where newer computer-assisted methods such as the Coherence-Based Genealogical Method (CBGM) have been introduced.[36]

Even these new tools such as the CBGM, however, have not shifted the overall Alexandrian base of the text. Although the Coherence-Based Genealogical Method represents a major change in textual-critical method, its results have not produced a radically different Greek New Testament. Gregory Lanier compared the NA28 text, together with the CBGM-assisted ECM text of Acts, against Westcott and Hort's 1881 text. In randomly selected passages covering approximately 5.5 percent of the New Testament, he found an overall agreement of 98.5 percent. Agreement was 97.2 percent in Acts and 98.1 percent in the Catholic Epistles, the two portions most directly affected by the

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[34] Kurt Aland and Barbara Aland, *The Text of the New Testament: An Introduction to the Critical Editions and to the Theory and Practice of Modern Textual Criticism*, 2nd ed., trans. Erroll F. Rhodes (Grand Rapids: Eerdmans; Leiden: Brill, 1989), section introducing the Categories and survey of minuscules/uncials (esp. Table 7).

[35] Gregory R. Lanier, "NA28/ECM and the Stability of the Greek New Testament Text," *Tyndale Bulletin* 71, no. 1 (2020): 43–63.

[36] Lanier, "NA28/ECM and the Stability," 49–52.

CBGM at the time of his study.[37] The new method therefore creates a text that remains overwhelmingly similar to Westcott and Hort's original text.

In other words, "reasoned eclecticism" has not produced a new or balanced text; it has simply refined the same Alexandrian-dominated critical text first championed by Westcott and Hort. The terminology has changed, but the foundation remains the same. The overwhelming majority of readings in the NA/UBS editions still descend from the same Egyptian manuscripts once favored by those earlier editors.

For that reason, the core argument of this book still stands. Whether it is called the *Alexandrian text*, the *critical text*, or the *eclectic text*, the underlying issue has never changed: Has God preserved His Word through the manuscripts received and used by the believing Church, or must His Word be reconstructed by modern scholarship from manuscripts the Church historically rejected? The method may sound scientific, but it is built on the same rationalistic assumptions.

Theories Used to Dismiss the Byzantine Text

Several theories have been used to argue that the Byzantine Text is late and was not the original wording, but was added to and "conflated" through the years.[38]

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[37] Gregory R. Lanier, "The Critical Editions of the Greek NT and OT: Stability, Change, and Implications," *Tyndale Bulletin* 71, no. 1 (2020): 43–63, esp. 49–54, https://doi.org/10.53751/001c.27734.

[38] Brooke Foss Westcott and Fenton John Anthony Hort, *The New Testament in the Original Greek: Introduction and Appendix* (Cambridge: Macmillan, 1882), 93–107, 132–35.

Prefer the Shorter Reading

A commonly repeated rule says that the shorter reading should be preferred because scribes were more likely to add words than remove them. However, scribes could also omit words, phrases, or entire lines accidentally or purposefully.

James Royse examined six important early papyri and found that every one of their scribes omitted material more often than he added it. Other studies have reached similar conclusions. Therefore, the shorter reading may sometimes be correct, but its shortness alone does not prove that it is original. The same caution applies to the so-called "harder reading," since a copying error can make a reading more difficult without making it more ancient.[39]

Supposed Conflated Readings

A conflation is a longer reading supposedly made by combining parts of two shorter readings. Westcott and Hort used several alleged Byzantine conflations to argue that the Byzantine Text was produced by later editors.

Harry Sturz showed why this argument is incorrect. Conflated readings are not limited to Byzantine manuscripts, and some readings that appear to be conflations are supported by early papyri. In **John 10:19** and **John 10:31**, for example, Papyrus 66, commonly dated around A.D. 200, supports the fuller reading later preserved in the Byzantine tradition. A longer reading may

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[39] James R. Royse, *Scribal Habits in Early Greek New Testament Papyri*, New Testament Tools, Studies and Documents 36 (Leiden: Brill, 2008), 705–36, especially 734; Andrew Wilson, "Scribal Habits in Greek New Testament Manuscripts," *Filología Neotestamentaria* 24 (2011): 95–126, especially 117.

be the result of conflation, but its length cannot by itself prove that it is late.[40]

The Supposed Lucian Recension

Another theory claims that *Lucian of Antioch*, or scholars associated with him, created the Byzantine Text through a planned revision around A.D. 300. Such a planned revision is called a recension.

However, no surviving historical account describes Lucian revising the Greek New Testament, identifies the manuscripts he supposedly used, or explains the rules he followed. Sturz emphasized this lack of historical evidence. The Lucian recension therefore should not be presented as an established historical fact.[41]

Early Byzantine Readings

Sturz catalogued approximately 150 readings that he classified as distinctively Byzantine and that receive support from early papyri. He was not claiming that these papyri were complete Byzantine manuscripts. His narrower point was that readings later preserved by the Byzantine tradition existed long before the proposed fourth-century revision.[42]

The evidence therefore establishes an important principle: the later date of a manuscript does not prove that its readings are late. The shorter reading is not automatically original; a fuller reading is not automatically a conflation; and the Lucian recension is not a documented event. The Byzantine tradition

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[40] Harry A. Sturz, *The Byzantine Text-Type and New Testament Textual Criticism* (Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1984), 79–96.

[41] Sturz, *Byzantine Text-Type*, 122–30.

[42] Sturz, Byzantine Text-Type, 55–69, 145–59.

must be judged by the evidence rather than dismissed by theories imposed upon it.

These theories have undoubtedly weakened confidence in the antiquity and originality of Byzantine readings. By portraying the Byzantine Text as late, conflated, and artificially constructed, they provided a basis for dismissing it as late and not original. Yet the historical record and manuscript evidence do not support such a conclusion. Westcott and Hort and, later, Kurt and Barbara Aland repeatedly treated the Byzantine tradition as inferior and assigned its witnesses little weight. However, the evidence says otherwise. The Byzantine Text therefore should not be dismissed on the basis of theories that assume its inferiority before its evidence is fairly examined.

Simply put, the discovery of Byzantine readings in early manuscripts—especially the papyri—decisively overturned theories that they arose through later expansion, conflation, or a Lucianic recension. Their early presence shows that these readings existed before the period in which they were supposedly created.

CHART KEY	
GREEN- KING JAMES BIBLE MANUSCRIPTS	RED- ALL MODERN BIBLE MANUSCRIPTS

Age Chart for Manuscripts

Old Testament Manuscripts		
Masoretic Text	Isaiah Scroll B (1QIsab)	175-100 BC
	The Great Isaiah Scroll (1QIsaa)	175-100 BC
W&H Text Type (Septuagint or LXX)	Septuagint	Claims to be dated 200-250 BC
	Ryland Manuscript (fragment of Deuteronomy)	150 BC
	Origen's Hexapla	200 AD
New Testament Manuscripts		
Textus Receptus (Byzantian/Antiochan Text)	Peshitta Syriac	100-150 AD
	P66	100-200 AD
	P45	150-200 AD
	Church Father Quotes (2,630x)	69-400 AD
W&H Text Type (Alexandrian Texts)	Codex Vaticanus (B)	350-375 AD
	Codex Sinaiticus (א (Aleph))	300-400 AD
	Codex Alexandrinus (A)	400-500 AD

OLD TESTAMENT MANUSCRIPTS

Septuagint (Origens Hexapla)

☆Also known as the Greek LXX

250-300 AD

Septuagint (Origens Hexapla)



☆The actual existence of this MSS (manuscript) is highly debated. The only historical record of it ever existing comes from a "Letter from Aristeas" where Aristeas writes to his brother Philocrates about how the Pharaoh of Egypt at the time, Ptolomy Philadelphia, was trying to get a Greek translation of the OT Hebrew scriptures for there library. The story states that 72 Jewish elders (six from each of the twelve tribes) were hired for the job to go to Alexandria, Egypt to translate this great work. They supposedly translated it all in 72 days and gave it to the Pharaoh. It became known as the Septuagint because of the 72 translators who created the translation (inaccurately so, since Septuagint means "70" and there were 72 translators who took 72 days).

☆ The OT of new versions of the Bible are actually translated from a document known as Origen's Hexapla in his 5th column (Hexpla=5 columns). He poorly tried to translate the Hebrew OT all on his own! He was from the philosophical, bible rejecting, heretical college at Alexandria, Egypt. All modern bible versions OT are based on his translation of the OT into Greek

☆ Who was Origen?
Believed Genesis 1-3 was not literal
Believed in the allegorical interpretation method
Believed Jesus was a created sub-god, not God
Believed the Holy Spirit was a created being
Believed in Salvation by works, not grace
Believed in baptismal regeneration and sprinkling of babies
Believed that Jesus' death was a ransom paid to Satan
Believed in "purgatory" and not in a literal Hell
Believed in universal salvation for all mankind
Believed that Satan would be saved one day
Believed that there is no bodily resurrection, but spiritual only
Believed that there is no millennial kingdom of Jesus Christ

☆ These manuscripts contained the Apocrypha mixed in amongst the canonical books (inspired/preserved books) (Luke 24:27,44)

☆ Ultimately used by Westcott & Hort, two Bible rejecting, spiritualistic, heretics,to create the first Bible revision in 1885(274 years after the KJV) the English Revised Version

☆ Subsequently used to translate all new versions of the

Massoretic Text

☆ The entirely Hebrew OT kept by the conservative Jewish group, the Masoretes

☆ The keeping of the scriptures, specifically as it pertains to the OT, was committed to the Jews: specifically to the Levites, priests, scribes, and the Jews as whole (Rom 3:2; Deut. 17:18; 31:24-26; Neh. 8:7-8; Deut. 4:1-2)

175 BC
Isaiah A (Dead Sea Scrolls)



100 BC
Isaiah B (Dead Sea Scrolls)



☆ Some rules they followed when copying the OT

A roll must be written on the skins of a clean animal
It must be prepared for use by a Jew
It must be fastened together with strings from a clean animal
Every skin must contain ascertain number of columns and they must be equal throughout the entire codex (MSS document)
The length of every column must be 48 and 60 lines long
The length of each line must be exactly 30 letters
The whole copy must be lined
The ink must be black prepared according to a particular recipe (non metallic)
An authorized copy must be the exemplar (one being copied from)
No word, not even a letter, can be written from memory
Between every letter there must be the space of a hair or thread
Between every new section there must be the space of 9 letters
Between every book there must be 3 lines
The 5th book of Moses (Deuteronomy) must end exactly with a line
The copyist must sit in full Jewish dress
The copyist must have just washed his whole entire body
The copyist must write the name of God with a pen newly dipped in ink. He must again wash his whole body before writing the name of the Lord. And should a king address him while he is writing that name, he must ignore the king

☆ Used to translate the KJV in 1611

NEW TESTAMENT MANUSCRIPTS

Alexandrian Texts

- Also known as "Western Texts"
- The 3 Main MSS in use by scholars for translating new versions of the Bible are: Vaticanus, **Sinaiticus** , and Alexandrinus. Vaticanus is the most heavily relied on MSS

300-375 AD
Vaticanus



-Leaves out over 1,000 sentences
-Adds over 500 words
-Changed approximately 2,000 words
-In 17,000 places it differs from Sinaiticus
-It leaves out books of the NT and adds in books that are not found in the Bible

300-400 AD
Sinaiticus



-Found at the base of Mt. Sanai in Egypt in a kindling bin in a monastery
-Leaves out 4,000 words from the gospels alone
-Adds over 1,000 words
-Changes the reading of the text in 1,500 other places

400-500 AD
Alexandrinus



-Created in Alexandria Egypt at the school there
-Created in an environment of textual criticism and heresy
-Does not differ greatly from the other two main MSS and for that reason is used less for translating than the other two

- All are traced back to Alexandria, Egypt. This was a place of heresy and all bad things in the Bible. Also a picture of the world in the Bible. (Gen. 12:10; 13:10; Rev. 11:8)
- They are also a part of what is called the "Minority Text". This is because they account for only 45/5,255 extant (in existence) MSS
- Ultimately used by Westcott & Hort, two Bible rejecting, spiritualistic, heretics,to create the first Bible revision in 1885(274 years after the KJV) the English Revised Version
- Subsequently used to translate all new versions of the Bible since 1885

Antiochan Texts

- Also known as Byzantinian, Eastern, and Syrian texts
- Come from Antioch, Syria where they were first called Christians (Acts 11:26)
- MSS from this line date back as far as 100 AD

100-150 AD
Peshitta Syriac



100-200 AD
Papyrus #66



68-500 AD
2,680 Quotes from church fathers



- These texts are known as the Textus Receptus "Received Text". They got their name due to the fact that Christians as a whole, through the aid of the Holy Ghost, accepted these MSS as scripture. The NT scripture is determined by the NT priesthood just as the OT was through OT priesthood (Rev.1:6; 20:6; 1Pet. 2:9)
- They are also a part of what is called the "Majority Text". This is because they account for a staggering 5,210/5,255 extant MSS
- Antioch was also the center for missions work in the early church (Acts 13:1-3)
- Used to translate the KJV in 1611
- REFER TO MSS COPYING CHART FOR MORE DETAILS ON HOW THE TWO MSS FAMILIES WERE PASSED/COPIED

PART II: THE OLD TESTAMENT

TO THE JEW WERE COMMITTED THE ORACLES

The starting point for any honest study of the Old Testament text must be God's own testimony concerning those to whom its custody was given. We are not left to guesswork or merely to the shifting opinions of textual critics. Scripture itself tells us plainly:

"What advantage then hath the Jew? or what profit is there of circumcision? Much every way: chiefly, because that unto them were committed the oracles of God." (**Romans 3:1–2**)

The apostle Paul states that Israel's greatest privilege was not their land, their kings, or even their temple, but that the very Word of God had been entrusted to them. The Old Testament was not scattered carelessly among the nations, nor was its keeping given to pagan philosophers. God committed it to the Jews, especially to the priests and Levites.

The phrase "were committed" speaks of custody. God gave the Old Testament through Jewish prophets and placed its keeping in the hands of the Jewish people. The priests, Levites, scribes, and teachers of the law were responsible to preserve, read, copy, and teach it.

The Hebrew text later known as the **Masoretic Text** stands in that same line of Jewish transmission. The Masoretes received the traditional consonantal Hebrew text that had been carefully passed down before them.

Custody Given by God Himself

From the beginning, God tied the keeping of His words to His covenant people.

- **Deut. 31:24–26 —** When Moses finished the law, he gave it to the Levites to keep beside the ark.
- **Mal. 2:7 —** The priest's lips "should keep knowledge," and people should seek the law from him.
- **Deut. 17:18–19 —** Even kings were required to copy the law from the text kept "before the priests the Levites."

The pattern is consistent: Moses delivered the written law to the Levites; kings copied from the text kept before them; Ezra served as a ready scribe in the law of Moses; the law was read publicly to the people; and Paul later said that the oracles were committed to the Jews. God placed the Hebrew Scriptures in Jewish custody and expected them to be preserved and taught.

Jewish scribes did not treat copying as ordinary bookwork. They counted lines, words, and letters; followed careful rules for columns and spacing; recorded textual notes; and rejected defective scrolls rather than pass them on. The Masoretes continued this conservative work by adding vowels and accents to protect the public reading of the text. Their methods show deliberate, careful stewardship of the Hebrew Scriptures.[43]

The Contrast with Greek Handling of the Text

Modern critics often give the **Septuagint** great authority. Yet Scripture never says that Gentile kings or Alexandrian scholars were entrusted with preserving the Old Testament. God chose the Jews to guard His oracles.

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[43] This meticulous process is described in detail by scholars of the Hebrew Bible's transmission. The rules governing the production of sacred scrolls were recorded in the Talmudic tractate Soferim. See Emanuel Tov, *Textual Criticism of the Hebrew Bible*, 3rd ed. (Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 2012), 31–39.

The question of authority therefore does not begin with the *Letter of Aristeas* or with fourth-century Greek codices. It begins with Scripture's own statement that the oracles of God were committed to the Jews.

The Character of Jewish Transmission

The Jewish scribes, including the later Masoretes, copied the Hebrew text with meticulous care. They counted letters, checked columns, and rejected defective scrolls. Millar Burrows, writing in 1948 about the Great Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa[a]), stated that "the whole book is here, and it is substantially the book preserved in the Masoretic text." He noted differences in spelling and some forms, but the wording remained remarkably close. The Second Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa[b]) agreed even more closely with the Masoretic Text.[44] [45] [46]

This evidence shows that the Hebrew text later known as the Masoretic Text had been carefully transmitted within the Jewish community long before the medieval Masoretic codices. The Qumran scrolls contain more than one textual form, but they also preserve a clearly recognizable Masoretic line centuries before Christ.

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[44] Babylonian Talmud, Kiddushin 30a, in *The Talmud of Babylonia: A Translation and Commentary*, ed. Jacob Neusner (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 2011).

[45] Millar Burrows, "Variant Readings in the Isaiah Manuscript," *Bulletin of the American Schools of Oriental Research*, no. 111 (October 1948): 16.

[46] W. F. Albright, "New Light on Early Recensions of the Hebrew Bible," *Bulletin of the American Schools of Oriental Research* 140 (December 1955): 30.

A Faith-Based Conclusion

The Bible is not silent about who had custody of the Old Testament. The oracles were committed to the Jews, who read, copied, taught, and preserved the Hebrew Scriptures through the centuries.

The line of transmission is clear: God committed the Hebrew Scriptures to the Jews; Jewish scribes carefully copied and guarded them; the Masoretes continued that conservative work; printed Hebrew editions carried the same received text into the Reformation; **and the King James translators used that Hebrew text for the Old Testament**.

This is why the King James Bible rests on the Masoretic Text. Its Old Testament comes from the Hebrew text preserved in the line of custody God gave to the Jewish people.

MASORETIC TEXT AND THE DEAD SEA SCROLLS

The Old Testament of the King James Bible is based on the Masoretic Text, the traditional Hebrew text carefully copied and preserved by Jewish scribes. The Masoretic manuscripts include vowel points, accents, and marginal notes that help preserve the reading of the ancient consonantal text. The Dead Sea Scrolls provide an earlier witness to that same Hebrew tradition.

The Dead Sea Scrolls Confirm the Masoretic Text

When the Dead Sea Scrolls were discovered between 1947 and 1956, they gave scholars Hebrew biblical manuscripts more than a thousand years older than the great medieval Masoretic codices. Rather than overturning the Masoretic Text, they showed how carefully much of the Hebrew Bible had been transmitted.[47]

- The Great Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa[a]), dated to about 125 B.C., contains all sixty-six chapters of Isaiah in their traditional order. Its text generally agrees with the Masoretic version, while also containing spelling differences, scribal corrections, and some variant readings. Gleason Archer estimated that the two Isaiah manuscripts from Qumran Cave 1 were word-for-word identical with the standard Hebrew Bible in more than 95 percent of their text, with most remaining differences involving spelling or obvious scribal slips.[48]

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[47] Emanuel Tov, *Textual Criticism of the Hebrew Bible*, 3rd ed., rev. and exp. (Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 2012), 29–32, 107–10.

[48] Gleason L. Archer Jr., *A Survey of Old Testament Introduction*, updated and rev. ed. (Chicago: Moody Press, 1994), 29.

- The Second Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa^{b}) agrees even more closely with the Masoretic Text. Jacobs counted 157 variants among 4,627 preserved words, a variation rate of about 3.4 percent. Peter Flint and Eugene Ulrich classify the scroll as proto-Masoretic because of its general agreement with the received Masoretic Text. This is direct evidence of the careful transmission of the Hebrew text before Christ.[49] [50]

- Studies of the biblical scrolls commonly classify about 60 percent as proto-Masoretic, while only a much smaller number, about 5 percent, align closely with distinctive Septuagint readings.[51] [52] [53]

More than a century before Christ, Jewish communities were therefore using a Hebrew text that closely agrees with the Masoretic tradition.

Not every Dead Sea Scroll agrees with the Masoretic Text in every detail, but that does not weaken the central point. The scrolls show that the Hebrew text later preserved in the

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[49] Jarod T. Jacobs, "The Balance of Probability: A Statistically Based Analysis of the Linguistic Character of the 'Biblical' Dead Sea Scrolls" (PhD diss., University of Manchester, 2015), 91–96.

[50] Peter W. Flint and Eugene Ulrich, "The Variant Textual Readings in the Hebrew University Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa^{b})," *Journal of Jewish Studies* 60, no. 1 (2009): 60–79, esp. 60.

[51] Emanuel Tov, *Textual Criticism of the Hebrew Bible* (Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 1992), 115.

[52] Bruce K. Waltke, "How We Got the Hebrew Bible: The Text and Canon of the Old Testament," in *The Bible at Qumran: Text, Shape, and Interpretation*, ed. Peter W. Flint, with the assistance of Tae Hun Kim (Grand Rapids: Eerdmans, 2001), 38.

[53] Lawrence H. Schiffman, *Reclaiming the Dead Sea Scrolls* (Philadelphia: Jewish Publication Society, 1994), 138. (On the textual character of the scrolls: ≈60% proto-Masoretic, ≈5% proto-Samaritan, ≈5% Septuagintal, remainder non-aligned/Qumran practice.)

Masoretic manuscripts had already been passed down within the Jewish community for centuries.

Archaeological Support

Other archaeological evidence also shows the conservative character of this Hebrew tradition:

- The Tel Dan Stele, an inscription from the ninth century B.C., spells David's name as "DWD" (דוד). The Great Isaiah Scroll, from about 125 B.C., sometimes uses the fuller spelling "DWYD" (דויד), while the Masoretic Text preserves the older spelling "DWD." This is one example of a later manuscript preserving an older Hebrew form. The date of a surviving copy does not by itself determine the age of the text it preserves.
- In 2021, additional fragments of Zechariah and Nahum were recovered from the "Cave of Horror" near the Dead Sea. Although they are Greek fragments, the Hebrew text behind them reflects an early Jewish scribal tradition closely related to the Masoretic base.[54] [55]

Together, these discoveries show a Hebrew text handled conservatively within Jewish custody. The Masoretic Text represents that carefully transmitted tradition, the same line of

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[54] Israel Antiquities Authority, "New Fragments of Biblical Scroll Discovered in the Judean Desert," March 16, 2021, https://www.antiquities.org.il.

[55] This refers to the 2021 discovery of new fragments from the Bar Kokhba Revolt period. The findings were announced in an official press release. Israel Antiquities Authority, "For the First Time in 60 Years, Archaeological Excavations Have Uncovered Scrolls," news release, March 16, 2021.

Hebrew Scripture entrusted to the priests, Levites, and Jewish scribes.

Jesus and the Hebrew Text Preserved by the Jews

Jesus and the apostles treated the Hebrew Scriptures preserved among the Jews as the authoritative Old Testament.

- ***Matthew 5:18*** *– "Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled." Christ's reference to jots and tittles points to the Hebrew form of the law.*

- ***Luke 24:44*** *– Jesus described the Old Testament by its three Hebrew divisions: "the law of Moses, and the prophets, and the psalms." This is the traditional Hebrew arrangement, without the Apocrypha being placed within the canon.*

The Masoretic Text therefore represents the Hebrew Bible carefully passed down by the Jewish people. Its agreement with the Dead Sea Scrolls, its conservative scribal features, and its continuity with the Hebrew Scriptures recognized by Christ all support its use as the Old Testament foundation of the King James Bible.

WHAT THE SEPTUAGINT IS (AND ISN'T)

The **Septuagint** (LXX) is often presented as one complete **Greek Old Testament** translated in Alexandria around 250 B.C. and later used by Jesus, the apostles, and the early church. Greek translations of parts of the Old Testament certainly existed before Christ, but the surviving evidence does not support so simple a picture.

The question is not whether Jewish people translated any Scripture into Greek. They did. The question is whether one complete and fixed Greek Old Testament existed before Christ, matched the later codices, and carried greater authority than the Hebrew text kept by the Jews. The evidence does not establish those claims.

The Modern Claim

If you read a seminary textbook, you will often see statements like:

- "The Septuagint was translated around 250 B.C. in Alexandria by seventy-two Jewish scholars."
- "Jesus and the apostles quoted from the Septuagint."
- "The Septuagint was the Bible of the early church."

These statements bring together three different things: the early Greek translation of the Law, later Greek translations of other books, and the fourth- and fifth-century codices commonly used to reconstruct the Septuagint today. Evidence for one should not automatically be treated as evidence for all three.

What the Historical Evidence Shows

The *Letter of Aristeas*

The traditional account comes from the *Letter of Aristeas*. It says that Ptolemy II Philadelphus brought seventy-two Jewish elders to Alexandria to translate the Hebrew Law into Greek for his library. Even in the letter, the work described is the Law, the first five books of Moses, not the complete Old Testament.

The letter was written after the event it describes and is generally regarded as pseudepigraphical. It may preserve an older tradition, but it cannot by itself establish whether or not a complete Greek translation of the Old Testament was circulating before Jesus' day.[56]

At most, the account supports the existence of an early Greek Pentateuch. It does not tell us what Greek text was used for Isaiah, Psalms, the Prophets, or the later codices. It also does not change the biblical fact that **God committed the Hebrew Scriptures to the Jews**.

Later Accounts and the Extent of the Translation

Philo and Josephus repeat the translation story, and Eusebius records it much later. Their testimony shows that the tradition was well known. It still does not prove that the entire Old

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[56] Karen H. Jobes and Moisés Silva, *Invitation to the Septuagint*, 2nd ed. (Grand Rapids: Baker Academic, 2015), 37–41. Modern scholars nearly unanimously regard the Letter of Aristeas as pseudepigraphical, likely composed in the second century B.C. to lend authority to the Greek translation.

Testament had been translated at one time or existed in one fixed form before Christ.[57] [58] [59]

Hebrew scholar Dr. Paul Kahle argued against the idea of one original, complete, fixed Septuagint that was in existence in Jesus' day.[60] [61]

The term "Septuagint" therefore needs to be used carefully. It may refer to the early Greek Pentateuch, to Greek translations of other Old Testament books made at different times, or to a modern printed text reconstructed largely from later Christian codices.

The Earliest Surviving Greek Fragments

No complete Greek Old Testament manuscript survives from before the Christian era.

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[57] Josephus, *Jewish Antiquities*, in *Josephus VII: Jewish Antiquities, Books XII–XIV* (Loeb Classical Library 365), trans. Ralph Marcus (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press; London: William Heinemann, 1943), 12.11–118, 9–58.

[58] Philo of Alexandria, *On the Life of Moses*, in *Philo VI* (Loeb Classical Library 289), trans. F. H. Colson (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press; London: William Heinemann, 1935), 2.25–44, 460–72.

[59] Eusebius, *Ecclesiastical History* 6.16–17, in *Eusebius, Volume II: Books 6–10*, trans. J. E. L. Oulton, Loeb Classical Library 265 (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press; London: William Heinemann, 1932).

[60] Paul E. Kahle, "Die Septuaginta: Prinzipielle Erwägungen," in *Festschrift Otto Eissfeldt zum 60. Geburtstag*, ed. J. Fück (Halle an der Saale: Max Niemeyer, 1947), 161–80.

[61] Paul E. Kahle, *The Cairo Geniza*, 2nd ed. (Oxford: Basil Blackwell, 1959), 223–26.

- The Rylands Greek Papyrus 458, usually dated to the second century B.C., preserves only small portions of Deuteronomy.[62]

- Other pre-Christian fragments show that portions of Scripture circulated in Greek. They do not show that a complete and uniform Greek Old Testament existed.

- The first nearly complete Greek Old Testament witnesses are the corrupt fourth- and fifth-century Christian codices, **Vaticanus and Sinaiticus**, dated several centuries after the date traditionally assigned to the translation in Alexandria.

For that reason, the wording of Vaticanus or Sinaiticus cannot simply be projected backward to 250 B.C. as though every reading came from one original translation.

Origen's Hexapla and the Septuagint

Origen, the third-century Alexandrian scholar, compiled the Hexapla, a large comparison of the Hebrew text, a Greek transliteration, and several Greek translations. The full work has not survived, but portions are known from fragments and later quotations.[63]

The Greek Old Testament text found in Codices Vaticanus and Sinaiticus reflects this same Alexandrian tradition and shows the

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[62] Papyrus Rylands 458 (P.Ryl. 458) is generally accepted as the earliest extant manuscript of the Septuagint. C. H. Roberts, ed., *Two Biblical Papyri in the John Rylands Library, Manchester* (Manchester: Manchester University Press, 1936).

[63] Origen's massive six-column work is the first known attempt to produce a critical and comprehensive edition of the Old Testament, though no complete manuscript of it survives. The remaining fragments were famously collected by Frederick Field, *Origenis Hexaplorum quae supersunt*, 2 vols. (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1875).

influence of Origen's textual work ***(see the chapter "The Alexandrian Cluster (B, ℵ, A) in Context").*** Therefore, the earliest surviving examples of a nearly complete Greek Old Testament do not lead back to a single, unchanged translation from the third century B.C. Instead, they lead to the later Alexandrian textual corruptor, Origen.

This connects directly with the earlier discussion of Alexandria. The issue is not that the Old Testament was translated into Greek. The issue is the manner in which the Greek text was handled. In Alexandria, different readings and translations were brought together and altered, while the Hebrew text remained under the careful and conservative custody of the Jewish scribes.

The Great Uncials Are Later and Not Uniform

Vaticanus, Sinaiticus, and Alexandrinus are the earliest great codices to preserve most of the **Greek Old Testament**. They are not identical copies of one fixed text, however.

- They differ from one another in wording, order, contents, and corrections.
- They contain different collections of apocryphal or deuterocanonical books alongside the Old Testament.
- They date from the fourth and fifth centuries, roughly six or seven centuries after the traditional translation date.

Why the Hebrew Text Remains the Standard

- **Jewish custody**. God committed His oracles to the Jews, not to a pagan king or an Alexandrian library.
- **Canon**. The nearly complete Greek codices include books that were not part of the Hebrew canon and were never treated as Scripture by Jesus or the apostles.

- **Textual unity**. The surviving Greek witnesses (Vaticanus and Sinaiticus) do not present one uniform text. They differ in thousands of places. Therefore, if all of these differing witnesses are said to represent "the Septuagint," then what exactly is the Septuagint?

- **Method**. It is circular to use a later Greek codex to correct the Hebrew text and then cite that corrected reading as proof that the Hebrew is wrong.

The Greek translations differ from the Masoretic Text in wording, length, and arrangement. Some differences may reflect an ancient interpretation or another Hebrew form, but the existence of a difference does not give the Greek reading authority over the Hebrew text kept by the Jews.

Did Jesus and the Apostles Use Greek Translations?

The New Testament was written in Greek, and many Old Testament quotations resemble known Greek translations. That does not prove that Jesus and the apostles used one complete Alexandrian Greek Bible as their final authority.

- Many quotations agree closely with the traditional Hebrew wording.

- Some agree with known Greek forms.

- Others differ in form because the inspired writers translate, shorten, combine, explain, or apply the Old Testament passage.

When Jesus read in the synagogue at Nazareth, Luke describes a scroll of Isaiah. The passage does not identify a fourth-century Alexandrian codex. Christ also spoke of **Hebrew "jots" and**

"tittles" and described the Old Testament by its Hebrew divisions: the law of Moses, the prophets, and the psalms.[64]

Conclusion of the Old Testament Section

The evidence does not show that Greek translations were absent before Christ. It shows that the common picture of one complete, fixed, and universally received pre-Christian Septuagint goes beyond what the surviving evidence proves.

- God committed His Old Testament oracles to the Jews.
- The Masoretic Text represents the carefully preserved Hebrew tradition passed down in their custody.
- The Dead Sea Scrolls show the antiquity and stability of that Hebrew tradition.
- The earliest Greek evidence is fragmentary, while the nearly complete Greek codices are later, differ from one another, and reflect continued revision.
- New Testament quotations do not remove the authority of the Hebrew text or prove that the apostles followed one complete Alexandrian Greek Old Testament.

When the King James translators based the Old Testament on the Masoretic Hebrew text, they followed the Hebrew Bible carefully transmitted by the Jewish people. That is the line of custody Scripture itself identifies.

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[64] Craig A. Evans, *Jesus and His World: The Archaeological Evidence* (Louisville, KY: Westminster John Knox Press, 2012), 81.

PART III: THE NEW TESTAMENT

THE TEXT THE CHURCH ACTUALLY USED

When critics discuss New Testament manuscripts, they often focus on the so-called "oldest and best" Alexandrian codices: Vaticanus, Sinaiticus, and Alexandrinus. The main question is not only which surviving manuscript is oldest, but what text the churches actually received, read, preached, and copied.

Scripture itself provides the standard for how this works:

- **Acts 2:42 —** "*And they continued stedfastly in the apostles' doctrine…*"
- **2 Timothy 2:2 —** Paul charged Timothy to entrust the words he had heard to "*faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.*"
- **Colossians 4:16 —** Letters were circulated among the churches and read publicly.

From the beginning, the New Testament was a living text in the churches. Believers read it aloud, copied it, memorized it, preached it, and passed it on.

Scripture connects preservation with reception and proclamation. The Thessalonians received the apostolic message "*not as the word of men, but as it is in truth, the word of God*" (**1 Thess. 2:13**). Paul ordered his letters to be read in the churches (**Col. 4:16**; **1 Thess. 5:27**), and Jude spoke of "*the faith which was once delivered unto the saints*" (**Jude 3**). God's Word was placed in the life of the church.

The pattern is simple: the words were heard, received, read publicly, taught to faithful men, carried to other churches, and

passed to the next generation. This is the text the church actually used.

This helps explain why the Traditional or Majority Text is not always represented by the oldest surviving copies, though early evidence for its readings does exist. These manuscripts were used, recopied, and often worn out. The surviving Alexandrian codices were preserved under very different circumstances. The traditional line came to be called the Textus Receptus, the "Received Text," because it was the text received and used in the churches.

As noted earlier, Burgon pointed to the lectionaries as evidence that this text was read publicly in the churches of the East. He also showed how the Textus Receptus was widely employed throughout Europe for the first three centuries after the invention of printing and was more than 1,500 years old.[65]

That is the testimony of the church's public use of the text.

Just as the priests and Levites were entrusted with the Old Testament law, the New Testament Scriptures were placed in the care of the church. The "*royal priesthood*" (**1 Pet. 2:9**; **Rev. 1:6**) read, taught, copied, and passed them down. In the argument of this book, that received text is the Traditional or Byzantine line that later stood behind the Textus Receptus and the King James Bible.

The church did not make Scripture inspired by receiving it. Rather, its reception is part of the historical evidence of preservation. A text read in worship, quoted in preaching, translated for missions, and copied through generations has a

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[65]Burgon, Revision Revised, 11.

different history from a manuscript that disappeared from church use for centuries.

The chain can be followed through the churches: the apostolic writings were circulated; early translations carried their readings into other languages; lectionaries preserved what was read publicly; Christian writers quoted the text; Byzantine manuscripts multiplied it throughout the Greek-speaking world; and the printing press brought that traditional text into the Reformation as the Textus Receptus.

Who Did God Leave the Keeping of the Bible To? Edward Hills on Naturalism and Faith

Edward Hills was trained in New Testament textual criticism at Yale, Westminster, and Harvard. Yet he believed that the prevailing naturalistic method failed to account for inspiration and providential preservation. In The King James Version Defended, he contrasted that method with what he called the consistently Christian, or faith-based, approach to the text.

The Naturalistic Method

Hills defined the naturalistic method as one that treats the New Testament like any other ancient human book. He wrote:

> "This naturalistic textual criticism requires us to study the New Testament text in the same way in which we study the texts of secular books which have *not* been preserved by God's special providence."[66]

This method treats the New Testament text as though it were preserved no differently from any other ancient book. Hills believed that this starting point leaves the question of the text

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[66] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 320.

entirely to human reconstruction and gives no place to God's special providence.

He saw the same assumption in the principles of Westcott and Hort, whose Greek text became the foundation for later critical editions. They wrote:

> "For ourselves, we dare not introduce considerations which could not reasonably be applied to other ancient texts, supposing them to have documentary attestation of equal amount, variety, and antiquity."[67]

That statement shows their starting point: the New Testament was to be handled by the same rules as any other ancient writing, without allowing inspiration or providential preservation to shape the method.

Daniel Wallace expressed the same principle when he wrote:

> "I would question whether it is an epistemologically sound principle to allow one's presuppositions to dictate his text-critical methodology. This is neither honest to a historical investigation nor helpful to our evangelical heritage."[68]

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[67] Brooke Foss Westcott and Fenton John Anthony Hort, *The New Testament in the Original Greek*, vol. 2, Introduction and Appendix (London: Macmillan, 1881), 277.

[68] Daniel B. Wallace, "Challenges in New Testament Textual Criticism for the Twenty-First Century," Journal of the Evangelical Theological Society 52, no. 1 (March 2009): 79–100, 93.

He also stated,

> "A theological a priori has no place in textual criticism."[69]

According to this approach, theological convictions about preservation should not determine how the text is established. The decision is left to the methods and judgments of textual scholars.

Hills believed the result was continued revision and uncertainty. If the text must always be reconstructed by specialists, ordinary believers are left without a settled Bible they can confidently receive as the preserved Word of God.

The Faith-Based (Consistently Christian) Method

In contrast, Hills argued that Christians must approach the biblical text through faith in the God who both inspired and preserved it.

> "The consistently Christian method, interprets the materials of New Testament textual criticism in accordance with the doctrines of the divine inspiration and providential preservation of the Scriptures. The naturalistic method interprets these same materials in accordance with its own doctrine that the New Testament is nothing more than a human book."[70]

The difference, Hills explained, is the starting point. The naturalistic method begins with the surviving evidence alone; the Christian method begins with the God who inspired

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[69] Wallace, "Challenges," 86.

[70] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, vii–viii.

Scripture and promised to preserve it, then interprets the evidence within that faith.

The Priesthood of Believers and the Preservation of Scripture

Hills connected this faith-based approach with the priesthood of believers. In his view, God did not leave the keeping of His Word only to an academic class, but to the believing church. He wrote:

> "When Christ died upon the cross, the Old Testament priesthood was abolished. In the New Testament dispensation every believer is a priest under Christ the great High Priest. Hence the New Testament text has been preserved by the universal priesthood of believers, by faithful Christians in every walk of life."[71]

Hills believed this explains why the Traditional or Byzantine Text stands as the providentially preserved text. It was received, copied, read, and guarded throughout the life of the church. His point was not that scholarship has no value, but that scholarship must remain under the authority of Scripture and the faith of God's people.

Simply put, the New Testament was not left only to specialists with access to languages and manuscripts. It was entrusted to faithful believers and churches who read it, taught it, copied it, and passed it on.

From the Church's Received Text to the King James Bible

The same pattern continued from manuscript to print. The Byzantine text spread throughout the Greek-speaking churches; its readings appear in lectionaries, ancient versions, and early

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[71] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 144.

Christian quotations; and that broad traditional stream became the printed Textus Receptus during the Reformation. The name "Received Text" describes its historical place as the text received and used by the churches.

When the King James translators brought the Masoretic Hebrew Old Testament and the Received Greek New Testament into the English Bible tradition, that process reached its final received form for the English-speaking world. The King James Bible was read in homes, believed in churches, preached from pulpits, memorized, printed by the millions, carried through revivals, and used throughout the great English-speaking missionary movement.[72]

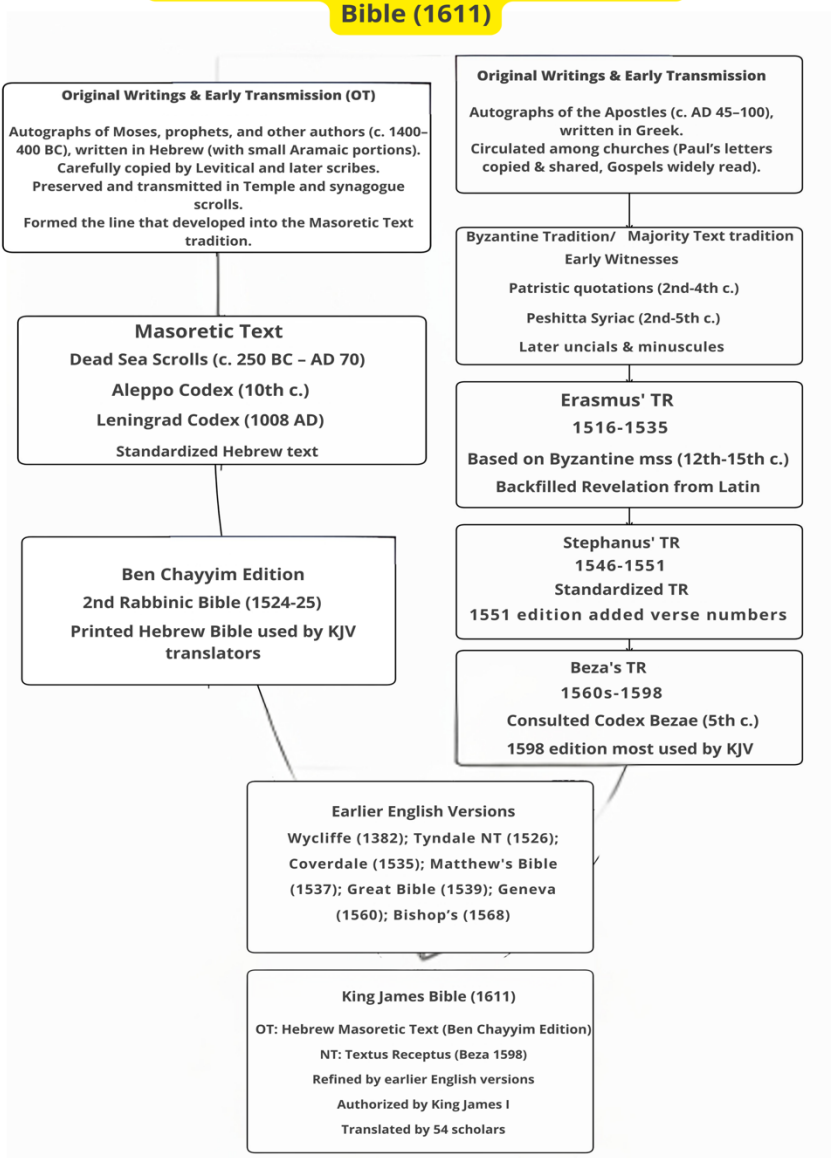
This fruit follows the biblical pattern. God's words are passed through faithful men who teach others also (**2 Tim. 2:2**); the church is *"the pillar and ground of the truth"* (**1 Tim. 3:15**); and faith comes by hearing the Word of God (**Rom. 10:17**). At the height of the English language and the missionary movement, the Bible received by English-speaking churches was the King James Bible.

Erasmus, Stephanus, and Beza were important parts of the process, but none of their individual editions became the final English authority. Within the position presented in this book, the final received text in English is the King James Bible, read, believed, preached, copied, carried, and confirmed in the life and mission of the church.

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[72] For the KJV's reception and public influence, see Gordon Campbell, Bible: The Story of the King James Version, 1611–2011 (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2010), and David Crystal, *Begat: The King James Bible and the English Language* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2010).

Transmission of Texts to the King James Bible (1611)



Old Testament: Masoretic Codices → Ben Chayyim (1524-25)

New Testament: Early Witnesses (Patristic, Syriac) → Byzantine Manuscripts → TR (Erasmus, Stephanus, Beza)

English Tradition: Tyndale → Geneva → Bishops' → merged into the Authorized Version (1611).

EVIDENCE: MANUSCRIPTS, VERSIONS, AND FATHERS

1. Manuscript Evidence

The numbers speak loudly:

- There are **5,700 catalogued Greek NT manuscripts** at the Institute for New Testament Textual Research.[73]
- The readings in these manuscripts reflect the Byzantine text-type used for the Textus Receptus and the KJV, **anywhere from 80 to 95 percent** of the time.[74] [75] [76]
- Fewer than **50 manuscripts** reflect the Alexandrian text type exclusively, and among those, only **three (B, ℵ, A)** truly form the backbone of the modern critical text.

The sheer weight of numbers indicates what the church used, copied, and passed down.

Zane Hodges (former **professor of New Testament at Dallas Theological Seminary**) and Dr. John Walvoord (former president of Dallas Theological Seminary) said this about the Majority Text:

> "The manuscript tradition of an ancient book will, under any but the most exceptional conditions, multiply in a

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[73] Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), "The Greek Manuscripts of the New Testament," New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room (NTVMR), University of Münster, accessed June 30, 2026, https://ntvmr.uni-muenster.de/.

[74] Wilbur N. Pickering, *The Identity of the New Testament Text* (Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1977), 155–56.

[75] D. A. Waite, *Defending the King James Bible* (Des Moines, IA: The Bible For Today Press, 2006), 41, 56.

[76] Hodges and Farstad, Greek New Testament According to the Majority Text, v–vi.

> reasonably regular fashion with the result that the copies nearest the autograph will normally have the largest number of descendants… Thus the Majority text, upon which the King James Version is based, has in reality the strongest claim possible to be regarded as an authentic representation of the original text."[77]

What they are saying is that the manuscripts that are most numerous will, by their very nature, resemble the original writings the most. This is the Majority Text, the base for the New Testament of the King James Bible.

This same idea was acknowledged by Fenton John Anthony Hort, one of the two originators of the first "modern version" of the Bible, using the Alexandrian manuscripts:

> "A theoretical presumption indeed remains that a majority of extant documents is more likely to represent a majority of ancestral documents at each stage of transmission than vice versa."[78]

2. Early Readings

The common claim of scholars is that the modern versions are based on "older and better manuscripts." While, as we have shown, this argument of antiquity does not ultimately matter, we also see that it is not in fact true. The early readings of the Byzantine Text abound.

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[77] Zane C. Hodges, "Modern Textual Criticism and the Majority Text: A Defense," *Bibliotheca Sacra* 125, no. 517 (January–March 1968): 1.

[78] Westcott and Hort, *New Testament in the Original Greek*, 2:45.

- **Peshitta Syriac (A.D. 100–150)** — aligns with the Byzantine tradition.[79]
- **Sinaitic Syriac** (**sys**) (**A.D. 300–400**).[80] [81]
- **Codex Argenteus (Gothic Version) (A.D. 350).**[82]
- **P66 (A.D. 100–200)** — aligns with the TR in more places than any Alexandrian MSS in mutually extant passages.[83] [84] [85] [86]

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[79] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 227.

[80] F. Crawford Burkitt, *Evangelion da-Mepharreshe: The Curetonian Version of the Four Gospels, with the Readings of the Sinai Palimpsest and the Early Syriac Patristic Evidence*, vol. 2 (Cambridge: University Press, 1904), 225.

[81] Harry A. Sturz, *The Byzantine Text-Type and New Testament Textual Criticism*, reprint ed. (Nashville: Energion, 2022), 55–56.

[82] Frederic G. Kenyon, *Handbook to the Textual Criticism of the New Testament*, 2nd ed. (London: Macmillan, 1912), 240.

[83] Bruce M. Metzger, "Lucian and the Lucianic Recension of the Greek Bible," *New Testament Studies* 8 (1962): 202–3.

[84] Bruce M. Metzger, Chapters in the History of New Testament Textual Criticism (Leiden: Brill, 1963), 38.

[85] J. Neville Birdsall, *The Bodmer Papyrus of the Gospel of John* (London: The Tyndale Press, 1960), 17.

[86] A. F. J. Klijn, *A Survey of the Researches into the Western Text of the Gospels and Acts, Part 2, 1949–1969* (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1969), as cited in Wilbur N. Pickering, *The Identity of the New Testament Text VI* (2024), 55.

- **P45 (A.D. 200)** — aligns with the TR in more places than any Alexandrian MSS in mutually extant passages.[87] [88] [89] [90]
- **P46 (A.D. 175–225**).[91] [92]
- **Old Latin (Itala, second century)** — reflects the Received Text.[93]
- **A (02) — Codex Alexandrinus: fifth century (c. A.D. 400–450)—predominantly Byzantine in the Gospels.**[94]
- **W (032) — Codex Washingtonianus (Freer Gospels): fourth century (c. A.D. 300–400).**[95]
- **Q (026) — Codex Guelferbytanus B: fifth century (c. A.D. 400–450).**[96]

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[87] Klijn, Survey of the Researches, as cited in Pickering, Identity of the New Testament Text VI, 55.

[88] G. Zuntz, *The Text of the Epistles: A Disquisition upon the Corpus Paulinum* (London: Oxford University Press, 1953), 55.

[89] Metzger, "Lucian and the Lucianic Recension," 202–3.

[90] "The Chester Beatty Papyri," Journal of Theological Studies 34 (October 1933): 363–68.

[91] Metzger, Chapters in the History of New Testament Textual Criticism, 38–39.

[92] Zuntz, Text of the Epistles, 55–56.

[93] Frederic G. Kenyon, *The Text of the Greek Bible* (London: Duckworth, 1937), 216–18.

[94] Aland and Aland, *Text of the New Testament*, 107–13, 159–60.

[95] Aland and Aland, Text of the New Testament, 107–13, 159–60.

[96] Aland and Aland, Text of the New Testament, 107–13, 159–60.

- **D (05) — Codex Bezae Cantabrigiensis: fifth century** (**c. A.D. 400–450**).[97] [98]

- ***Over 150 distinctly Byzantine readings*** *in the "oldest and best" Egyptian papyri.*[99]

- A study by Dr. Jack Moorman in his work Early Manuscripts, Church Fathers, and the Authorized Version shows the agreement of the "Great/Old Uncials" (א, A, C, D(05), and D(06)) with the TR vs. Vaticanus in passages where they differ. The results showed that the "oldest and best" agree with the Textus Receptus 7,909 times, whereas they agree with Vaticanus only 5,924 times.[100]

    - What does this mean? The Textus Receptus has a large amount of support in the so-called "oldest and best" manuscripts as compared to the base manuscript for all modern Bibles (Vaticanus).

These Byzantine readings circulated in living Christian communities, showing what believers on the ground actually read and preached. This also shows that the "older and better" claims are simply untrue.

3. Patristic Quotations

The church fathers quote the Byzantine/TR line extensively. ("Fathers" is not a term I like to use here, in view of Matthew

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[97] Aland and Aland, Text of the New Testament, 107–13, 159–60.

[98] Jack A. Moorman, *Early Manuscripts, Church Fathers, and the Authorized Version: With Manuscript Digests and Summaries* (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 2005), 45–51.

[99] Sturz, *Byzantine Text-Type*, 145–59.

[100] Moorman, *Early Manuscripts, Church Fathers, and the Authorized Version*, 45–51.

23:9, but I use it for clarity, since that is how they are referred to in history.)

- From **A.D. 69 (Polycarp, disciple of John)** through **A.D. 400**, over **2,630 quotations** reflect the TR.[101]

- Irenaeus (A.D. 130–200), disciple of Polycarp, quoted verses like **Mark 16:9–20** as Scripture, verses cut out of modern critical editions.[102]

- Cyprian (A.D. 200–258) referenced the Trinity of **1 John 5:7** ("*and these three are one*"), centuries before Vaticanus and Sinaiticus would omit it.[103]

Thus, the claim that these readings are "late additions" is demolished by the very voices of the earliest post-apostolic generations.

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[101] Frederic G. Kenyon, Handbook to the Textual Criticism of the New Testament (London: Macmillan, 1901), 375–76.

[102] Irenaeus explicitly quotes Mark 16:19 in his work *Against Heresies* 3.10.5, providing definitive second-century evidence for the longer ending of Mark.

[103] In his treatise *On the Unity of the Church*, Cyprian writes, "The Lord says, 'I and the Father are one'; and again it is written of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, 'And these three are one.'" Cyprian, *De Unitate Ecclesiae*, 6. This is considered by many to be the earliest clear reference to the Comma Johanneum.

THE ALEXANDRIAN CLUSTER (B, א, A) IN CONTEXT

Modern textual critics place great weight on three manuscripts: Codex Vaticanus (B, c. A.D. 325–350), Codex Sinaiticus (א, c. A.D. 330–360), and Codex Alexandrinus (A, c. A.D. 400–450). They are often called the "oldest and best." Yet each is connected with Egypt and the Alexandrian textual corruption discussed earlier.

Vaticanus (B)

Codex Vaticanus, designated B, is one of the two manuscripts most heavily relied upon in the modern critical text, along with Sinaiticus. Its readings have had a major influence on the Greek text behind the NIV, ESV, NASB, CSB, and other modern translations.

Vaticanus is generally dated to the **fourth century** (**around A.D. 325–350**).[104] Some scholars believe it may have been one of the fifty copies of Scripture that the **Roman emperor Constantine** ordered to be made for the churches of Constantinople, as recorded by the historian **Eusebius**.[105] A. T. Robertson was convinced this was the origin of Vaticanus:[106]

> "Constantine himself ordered fifty Greek Bibles from Eusebius, Bishop of Caesarea, for the churches in Constantinople. It is quite possible that א and B are two

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[104] Aland and Aland, Text of the New Testament, 106–9.

[105] Eusebius of Caesarea, *Life of Constantine* 4.36–37, in *Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, Second Series*, vol. 1, ed. Philip Schaff and Henry Wace (New York: Christian Literature Publishing, 1890), 544.

[106] A. T. Robertson, *An Introduction to the Textual Criticism of the New Testament* (Nashville: Sunday School Board of the Southern Baptist Convention, 1925), 80.

> of these fifty, though the actual copying was probably done in Egypt or by Egyptian scribes."

Its very origin story highlights the difference between a Bible handed down through the Spirit-led people of God and one produced under the influence of a pagan Roman emperor.

The manuscript itself bears the marks of corruption and incompleteness. It is **missing large portions** of the New Testament: everything from **Hebrews 9:14** onward, the Pastoral Epistles (1–2 Timothy, Titus), Philemon, and the book of Revelation. In addition to these omissions, Vaticanus includes **apocryphal** material alongside canonical Scripture, mixing the inspired Word of God with uninspired writings.

After its production, Vaticanus eventually came to rest in **Rome**, where it was placed in the **Vatican** Library. Remarkably, it sat there for centuries unused, until appearing in a catalog in 1481. Unlike the manuscripts copied and worn thin through centuries of church use, Vaticanus survived precisely because it was not trusted or used in the life of the churches. It was a shelf relic, not a living text among the people of God.

And yet, despite this history of neglect, modern scholarship now exalts Vaticanus as one of the "oldest and best" witnesses to the New Testament text. In reality, its survival tells a different story: it was preserved by disuse, not by providential transmission through the believing church. To rest the authority of modern Bibles on such a manuscript, rather than on the Received Text preserved and used in the churches for fifteen centuries, is to lean on a witness rejected by the very body of Christ.

Sinaiticus (א)

Codex Sinaiticus, designated א (Aleph), is the other principal manuscript behind the modern critical text. J. F. Fenlon wrote

about the origin of Sinaiticus in Alexandria, Egypt, connecting it back to Origen as well:

> "It seems to have been at one time at Caesarea; one of the correctors (probably of seventh century) adds this note at the end of Esdras: 'This codex was compared with a very ancient exemplar which had been corrected by the hand of the holy martyr Pamphilus [d. 309]; which exemplar contained at the end the subscription in his own hand: "Taken and corrected according to the Hexapla of Origen: Antonius compared it: I, Pamphilus, corrected it."' … The text of Codex Sinaiticus bears a very close resemblance to that of Codex Vaticanus…"[107]

Together, these two manuscripts form the backbone of the Nestle–Aland and UBS critical editions of the Greek New Testament, which in turn underlie nearly every modern Bible translation (NIV, ESV, NASB, CSB, etc.). In practice, Sinaiticus and Vaticanus are given priority over the thousands of manuscripts that agree with the Traditional Text, making them the "pillars" of the modern text-critical approach.

Sinaiticus is generally dated to the mid-**fourth century (c. A.D. 330–360)**[108], with many scholars suggesting it, too, may have been among the fifty Bibles ordered by Constantine and produced in Alexandria. It is written in Greek uncials on vellum and originally contained the entire Old and New Testaments, though much of the Old Testament has been lost. Unlike the manuscripts faithfully copied and worn out through centuries of

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[107] J. F. Fenlon, "Codex Sinaiticus," *The Catholic Encyclopedia* 4 (New York: Robert Appleton, 1908), 85–86.

[108] Aland and Aland, Text of the New Testament, 106–9.

church use, Sinaiticus survived because it was preserved in obscurity.

The discovery story itself underscores its questionable history. In the mid-nineteenth century, Constantin von Tischendorf famously found parts of the manuscript at St. Catherine's Monastery at Mount Sinai, some of which, according to his own report, were sitting in a wastebasket, destined to be burned. Other portions he retrieved later under circumstances still disputed. This means one of the primary witnesses for modern Bibles literally comes from a trash pile, rejected even by monks who were otherwise careful to preserve manuscripts.

The text of Sinaiticus reveals why it was discarded. It contains **thousands of corrections** made by different scribes over centuries, with some estimating more than **14,000 individual alterations**. In some places, Sinaiticus **contradicts itself within just a few verses**, and in others, it departs radically from the Traditional Text and from parallel passages. For example, in the Gospels it frequently shortens or alters verses, and in the New Testament as a whole it shows a tendency toward omissions, particularly in Christological passages.

In addition to the canonical Scriptures, Sinaiticus includes books not recognized as inspired: the *Epistle of Barnabas* and the *Shepherd of Hermas*. Their presence once again blurs the line between God's Word and uninspired writings.

And yet, despite its origin in neglect, its internal contradictions, and its long centuries of obscurity, Codex Sinaiticus is treated by modern scholarship as one of the "oldest and best" witnesses. In reality, its checkered history and heavily corrected text argue the opposite: it survived not by providence through the churches, but by disuse, rejection, and accident.

Alexandrinus (A)

Codex Alexandrinus, designated **A**, is usually dated to the early **fifth century (c. A.D. 400–440**)[109]. Unlike Vaticanus and Sinaiticus, it surfaced earlier in the West and was presented to King James I's successor, Charles I of England, in 1627. Today it resides in the British Library. While often cited by modern textual critics, Alexandrinus has always been considered less consistent and less "pure" than Vaticanus or Sinaiticus.

The manuscript was likely produced in Alexandria, Egypt, and, true to its origin, it shows a **mixture of text types** rather than a unified, reliable witness. In the Gospels, Alexandrinus leans toward the Byzantine text-type (closer to the Traditional Text), but in Acts and the Epistles it frequently follows Alexandrian readings, and in Revelation it exhibits a unique text all its own. This inconsistency makes it an unstable witness, sometimes supporting the Received Text, sometimes departing from it in favor of Alexandrian corruption.

Like the other "great uncials," Alexandrinus also contains the **Apocrypha** intermixed with canonical books, once again blurring the lines between inspired and uninspired writings. Its inclusion of noncanonical works is another reminder that these manuscripts were not safeguarded by the churches of God, but arose from the Alexandrian stream where human philosophy and textual alteration flourished.

While Vaticanus and Sinaiticus are the primary authorities leaned upon by modern editors, Alexandrinus is treated as a secondary witness, valuable when it agrees with their preferred readings, but inconsistent and less trusted overall. Yet despite its mixed character, modern translations will still occasionally

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[109] Aland and Aland, Text of the New Testament, 106–9.

follow Alexandrinus where it supports a critical variant against the Traditional Text.

In the end, Alexandrinus stands as another example of a manuscript preserved not by faithful usage in the churches, but by storage in obscure collections, reflecting the instability of the Alexandrian textual tradition.

Critics hail these codices as "old" and therefore superior. But age without use is no virtue. These manuscripts were preserved in good condition precisely because the churches rejected them. They were locked away or abandoned, not worn out in service.

Burgon again remarked:

> "It is in fact easier to find two consecutive verses in which B and א differ, than two consecutive verses in which they agree." [110]

The problem is not only that these manuscripts disagree with the text preserved and used by the churches; they also disagree with one another. **Codex Sinaiticus (א)** has layer upon layer of corrections made by different scribes over the centuries. In some places, whole sections were rewritten multiple times, showing confusion rather than stability. **Codex Vaticanus (B)** is marked by unusual omissions and even cancellations, and its copyists left notes in the margins warning readers about questionable spots, hardly the sign of a manuscript people fully trusted. And when Vaticanus and Sinaiticus do "agree," they just as often contradict one another a few lines later. Together they do not form a strong, consistent witness, but a shaky and shifting one. Their very inconsistency helps explain why these books were left

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[110] Burgon, Revision Revised, 12.

unused long enough to survive. That is not the mark of the "oldest and best"; it is the mark of instability.

Chapter Summary Visual

The contrast may be summarized in two streams:

The Majority/Byzantine Line (Antioch → TR → Reformation Bibles → KJV)

More than 5,000 Greek manuscripts, with the Byzantine text forming the large majority.

Supported by early versions such as Old Latin and Syriac.

Quoted extensively by early Christian writers such as Polycarp, Irenaeus, and Cyprian.

Carried into the Reformation Bibles and the King James Bible.

The Minority/Alexandrian Line (Alexandria → Vaticanus/Sinaiticus → Critical Text → Modern Versions)

A small group of manuscripts centered especially on Vaticanus, Sinaiticus, and Alexandrinus.

Often disagreeing with the Traditional Text ***and with one another***.

Preserved chiefly in libraries and institutions rather than through broad church use.

Forms the main basis of the modern critical text and modern Bible versions.

Conclusion of the New Testament Section

The central question is not merely, "Which surviving manuscript is oldest?" but, "Which text did the church actually receive and use?" The manuscript numbers, early versions, patristic quotations, and history of church use all point to the Traditional or Received Text rather than the Alexandrian cluster.

The New Testament text of the King James Bible is not an accident of history. It stands in the line received, copied, preached, and carried through the life of the church.

"Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away" (**Matt. 24:35**).

His words have not passed away.

FROM THE RECEIVED TEXT TO THE KING JAMES BIBLE

The preceding chapters have traced the Traditional Text and examined the Alexandrian manuscripts. The next step is to follow the received Hebrew and Greek texts into the English Bible and finally to the King James Bible. The printed Greek text supplied the New Testament foundation, while earlier English Bibles supplied much of the vocabulary, phrasing, and form.

The English Bible Prepared the Way

From a providential standpoint, several clear milestones show how the English Bible developed toward the KJV.

The Wycliffite Bible was the first full translation of the Bible into English. It was translated in manuscript form from the Old Latin, and some 250 surviving complete or partial manuscripts exist today.[111]

In 1526, Tyndale published the first printed complete English New Testament translated from Greek. This was followed by his 1530 translation of the Pentateuch, or the Five Books of Moses, from Hebrew into English. One detailed study examining eighteen sample sections indicated that Tyndale is responsible for approximately 84 percent of the words in the KJV New Testament, and about 76 percent of his words are still in the KJV Old Testament books that he translated.[112]

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[111] Anne Hudson, "The First Complete English Bible," *Tyndale Society Journal*, no. 2; Mary Dove, *The First English Bible: The Text and Context of the Wycliffite Versions* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2007), 281–306.

[112] Jon Nielson and Royal Skousen, "How Much of the King James Bible Is William Tyndale's? An Estimation Based on Sampling," *Reformation* 3, no. 1 (1998): 49–74, https://doi.org/10.1179/ref_1998_3_1_004.

Coverdale's Bible, published in 1535, was the first complete printed English Bible, and Matthew's Bible (1537) combined the work of Tyndale and Coverdale and added summaries and cross-references. The Great Bible, published in 1539, revised Matthew's Bible for use in public in England's churches and used brackets and smaller type to mark certain readings from the Latin Vulgate that were found neither in the Hebrew nor the Greek.[113]

The 1560 Geneva Bible took the English Bible to a yet more accessible level of study by being the first complete English Bible with numbered verses, marking each verse as a separate, indented paragraph, using readable roman print, and indicating in italics supplied words—that is, words added to convey the meaning in English although not represented by a separate Hebrew or Greek word. This Bible also contained detailed notes, cross-references, maps, and tables.[114] [115]

The Bishops' Bible, first published in 1568, was a revision of the Great Bible for church use, and its 1602 edition served as the initial text for the KJV. However, the KJV instructions required the translators to compare this Bible with Tyndale's, Matthew's, Coverdale's, the Great and Geneva Bibles and, further, with the Hebrew and Greek. Norton estimates that approximately 63

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[113] Ezra Horbury, "The Bible Abbreviated: Summaries in Early Modern English Bibles," *Harvard Theological Review* 112, no. 2 (2019): 235–60; J. F. Mozley, *Coverdale and His Bibles* (London: Lutterworth Press, 1953), 221.

[114] Kent P. Jackson, Frank F. Judd Jr., and David R. Seely, "Chapters, Verses, Punctuation, Spelling, and Italics," in *The King James Bible and the Restoration*, ed. Kent P. Jackson (Provo, UT: Religious Studies Center, Brigham Young University, 2011), 95–117.

[115] Bruce M. Metzger, "The Geneva Bible of 1560," *Theology Today* 17, no. 3 (October 1960): 339–52; Jackson, Judd, and Seely, "Chapters, Verses," 101–2, 109–10.

percent of the KJV differs from the Bishops' Bible.[116] This work was broken down among six teams of scholars at Westminster, Oxford, and Cambridge. Of these, we know the names of forty-seven translators.

The 1611 edition continued the use of chapter and verse numbers, indented verses, chapter summaries, and extensive cross-references of the previous versions. Since the body of this text was blackletter, roman print, rather than italics, was used to identify the supplied words. When later editions changed the text to roman, the supplied words were indicated in italics. The 1611 version also included 8,422 marginal notes, including 1,018 in the Apocrypha, which provided literal renderings, alternative translations, and textual information.[117]

These seven major English Bibles, Wycliffe, Tyndale, Coverdale, Matthew's, the Great Bible, the Geneva Bible, and the Bishops' Bible, prepared the way for the King James Bible. The KJV brought their best English wording together and refined it through careful comparison with the Hebrew and Greek. It was the eighth major English Bible in this progression. In Scripture, eight often marks a new beginning, and the KJV opened a new period in English Bible history as it was carried through the greatest era of English-speaking revival and missionary expansion.

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[116] "The Rules to Be Observed in the Translation of the Bible," in Alfred W. Pollard, ed., *Records of the English Bible* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1911), 53–55; David Norton, *A Textual History of the King James Bible* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2005), 8, 23–24.

[117] F. H. A. Scrivener, *The Authorized Edition of the English Bible (1611): Its Subsequent Reprints and Modern Representatives* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1884), 56, 69–71.

How the King James Translators Worked

The work was distributed among six companies located at Westminster, Cambridge, and Oxford. Although the early proposal referred to a larger number of appointed scholars, the surviving lists identify forty-seven translators. Their assignments covered the Old Testament, the Apocrypha, and the New Testament.[118]

The first translation rule directed them to use the Bishops' Bible as their starting English text and to alter it wherever the truth of the original required; copies of the 1602 edition were supplied for the work. Another rule directed them to compare the earlier translations of Tyndale, Matthew, Coverdale, the Great Bible, and the Geneva Bible whenever those versions agreed better with the original text.[119]

Their work proceeded through documented stages. Each translator first examined the assigned passage. The company then met to compare the work and agree upon its reading. Completed books were sent to the other companies for review. Unresolved disagreements could be considered at a final meeting of leading translators, and difficult passages could be referred to other learned men.

This was a careful and organized system of translation and review. Each portion was examined individually, discussed by a company, reviewed by the other companies, and settled through further consultation when needed. The strength of the work lies in this documented process of repeated comparison.

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[118] David Norton, *The King James Bible: A Short History from Tyndale to Today* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2011), 54–55.

[119] Pollard, *Records of the English Bible*, 53–55.

Why the Process Ends with the King James Bible

The King James Bible is not presented here as merely one good translation chosen from among many. As we have seen, there is a remarkable pattern of God's providential hand in the manuscript history leading up to the King James Bible, in the circumstances surrounding its translation, in the work itself, and in the reception of the translation.

1. The Masoretic Hebrew text preserved by those God entrusted the Old Testament with: **the Jews**.
2. The Received Greek Text arising from the Traditional or Byzantine stream **used and received by believers and churches.**
3. A formal, **word-for-word** method of translation.
4. The accumulated strength of the earlier English Bibles.
5. Repeated individual, company, and general review.
6. **Centuries of reception of the KJV** in English-speaking churches, homes, revivals, and missions.

No one of these marks stands alone. Together they explain why the process does not end with Erasmus, one particular TR edition, the Geneva Bible, or an endless series of new translations. The Hebrew and Greek foundations, the refinement of English wording, the translators' method, the review process, and the reception of the finished Bible meet in the King James Bible.

Within the faith-based view of this issue, the KJV is therefore the settled English result of God's preservation and purification of the words He had already given.

PART IV: OTHER ISSUES

TRANSLATION PRACTICES: DYNAMIC VS. FORMAL EQUIVALENCE: WHY TRANSLATION PHILOSOPHY MATTERS

Remember that English Bibles differ for two basic reasons. In many cases, as we have already seen, the difference comes from the underlying Hebrew or Greek reading being used. At other times, the underlying text may be mixed, but **a different translation method** produces wording that does not accurately reflect that text. In the worst cases, both the underlying text and the translation method are faulty, resulting in a translation that seriously distorts the words of God.

Modern translators, following the lead of **Eugene Nida** in the mid-twentieth century, adopted what is called *Dynamic Equivalence*[120] (sometimes "functional equivalence"). Rather than rendering the precise words of the Hebrew and Greek, this method seeks to communicate what translators believe is the "thought" behind the text, often rephrasing or reshaping verses to make them smoother for modern readers.[121]

By contrast, the King James Bible was produced under the principle of *Formal Equivalence* (often called *verbal equivalence*).[122] This approach insists on preserving the actual words and structures of the original languages, as nearly as possible, in the

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[120] Eugene A. Nida, *Toward a Science of Translating* (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1964), 159.

[121] Nida, *Toward a Science of Translating*, 166–68.

[122] "The Translators to the Reader" (1611 Preface to the KJV), in F. H. A. Scrivener, *The Authorized Edition of the English Bible (1611): Its Subsequent Reprints and Modern Representatives* (Cambridge: University Press, 1884), 265–311.

receptor language. The translators recognized that the Bible claims inspiration down to the very words (**Matthew 4:4**; **Proverbs 30:5**), not merely the general ideas.

The consequences of these two approaches are stark:

- **Formal/Verbal Equivalence (KJV):** Prioritizes accuracy to the inspired words, allowing the reader to study, interpret, and trust that the rendering reflects the original.
- **Dynamic Equivalence (NIV, NLT, etc.):** Prioritizes readability and cultural adaptation, but introduces the bias and theological assumptions of the translators themselves.

Dr. D. A. Waite summarized the danger well: when men depart from translating the **words of God** and begin paraphrasing ideas, man—not God—becomes the authority.

> "For translation that purports to be a translation of God's Words, to add these words is **absolutely diabolical**. It is adding to the Words of God."[123]

Waite characterizes the serpent's tactics in **Genesis 3** as a **dynamic-equivalence** paraphrase of God's words:

> "He used the DYNAMIC EQUIVALENCE method… That is, he made a loose paraphrase of what God's words were…"[124]

This philosophical shift explains why so many doctrinally vital verses are weakened or omitted in modern versions. It is not simply about different manuscripts; it is also about a

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[123] Waite, *Defending the King James Bible*, 151.

[124] Waite, *Defending the King James Bible*, 119.

fundamentally different **view of what the Bible is**: the very words of God, or merely a vehicle for conveying religious ideas.

Conclusion: The Hideous Dangers of Dynamic Equivalence

The Dynamic Equivalence method is Satanically influenced because of how it works. Consider this: even if the original manuscripts were pure and untainted, this method can corrupt the text ten times over by treating Scripture as "thought-for-thought" instead of word-for-word. When translators take the liberty to restate God's thoughts in their own words, they inevitably mix human reasoning with God's revelation. So, the problem isn't just which manuscripts are used, but also how those manuscripts are used. A faithful translator must not alter a single letter or word (**Matthew 5:18**); however, the Dynamic Equivalence translator is at liberty to change God's words to align with man's interpretations.

So, even if a translation starts with a good text, the "thought-for-thought" approach brings in a much more subtle and harmful corruption that hides behind readability and cultural relevance while undermining the authority of Scripture. It is, in essence, the serpent's time-honored tactic in a fresh linguistic guise: "Yea, hath God said?" When a person thinks they can make something better than what God said, the text stops being the Word of God and becomes the word of man.

DOCTRINAL ISSUES (WHY THE "SMALL" CHANGES AREN'T SMALL)

We often hear people say, "The differences between Bible versions don't change any doctrines." But when you slow down and actually compare them side by side, you find that these "small changes" add up to very big differences. In fact, some of the clearest teachings about Jesus, salvation, and the Christian life are blurred or weakened in modern versions. Let's walk through some key examples.

1 Timothy 3:16

KJV: *"God was manifest in the flesh."*

NIV: *"He was manifested in the flesh."*

In the KJV, Paul is boldly declaring that **God Himself** came down into human flesh. That's one of the strongest confirmations of Jesus' deity in the New Testament. The NIV and other modern Bibles switch it to "He," which is vague. Everyone is "manifested in the flesh." Only the KJV preserves the force of this verse, that Jesus is God made flesh.

Philippians 2:5–6

KJV: *"Let this mind be in you, which was also in Christ Jesus: Who, being in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God."*

ESV: *"Have this mind among yourselves, which is yours in Christ Jesus, who, though he was in the form of God, did not count equality with God a thing to be grasped."*

The difference is subtle but huge. The KJV says Jesus didn't have to grasp for equality with God; it was already His by nature. He was fully God. The ESV makes it sound like Jesus did not think

He was or could be equal to God. The KJV defends the truth that Jesus has always been equal with God.

John 1:18

KJV: *"the only begotten Son."*

ESV: *"the only God."*

The KJV preserves the unique Father and Son relationship. Modern versions' wording creates confusion: How can the "only God" be "at the Father's side" (as the ESV says) if they are the same Person? The KJV clearly teaches that the Son is distinct from the Father, yet fully God.

Romans 14:10

KJV: *"…for we shall all stand before the judgment seat of Christ."*

NASB: *"…for we will all stand before the judgment seat of God."*

The KJV highlights that **Jesus Christ** is the one who will judge all mankind, consistent with **John 5:22**, where the Father has committed judgment to the Son. Modern versions shift the focus back to "God," which is true, but less specific. It hides the explicit statement that Jesus is the final Judge.

1 Corinthians 10:9

KJV: *"Neither let us tempt Christ, as some of them also tempted."*

NASB: *"Nor are we to put the Lord to the test, as some of them."*

At first glance they look the same. But this is really important: Paul is identifying the God of the Old Testament whom Israel tempted in the wilderness as **Christ Himself**. That means Jesus is the God of the Old Testament, the LORD. This strong doctrinal connection disappears in most modern translations that don't keep the precise wording.

Luke 24:52

KJV: "*And they worshipped him, and returned to Jerusalem with great joy.*"

RSV: "*And they returned to Jerusalem with great joy.*"

The KJV confidently states the disciples worshipped the risen Jesus. Some modern versions question or bracket the wording or remove it altogether. Why downplay one of the clearest moments of the disciples bowing before their Lord?

Acts 20:28

KJV: "*…the church of God, which he hath purchased with his own blood.*"

ESV: "*…the church of God, which he obtained with the blood of his own.*"

The KJV makes the point blunt: it was **God's own blood**, Christ's blood, that bought the church. The ESV rephrases it so the link between God and the blood of Christ is less direct.

1 John 5:7–8

KJV: "*For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.*"

NIV: "*For there are three that testify.*"

The KJV includes the classic "heavenly witnesses" verse, which is one of the clearest verses on the doctrine of the Trinity in the Bible. Modern versions drop it completely or put it in the footnotes. This removes one of the strongest proof-texts for the Trinity in the whole Bible.

Luke 2:33

KJV: *"And Joseph and his mother marvelled at those things which were spoken of him."*

ESV: *"And his father and his mother marveled at what was said about him."*

The KJV avoids calling Joseph Jesus' father, which protects the doctrine of the virgin birth. The ESV uses "father," which could give the wrong impression.

Luke 2:22

KJV: *"…the days of **her** purification…"*

CSB: *"…the days of **their** purification…"*

The law of Moses only required the purification of the mother, not both parents. The KJV gets it right.

Matthew 1:25

KJV: *"…and knew her not till she had brought forth her firstborn son."*

ESV: "…but knew her not until she had given birth to a son."

The word "firstborn" matters. It tells us Mary had other children after Jesus, countering the Roman Catholic teaching of her perpetual virginity.

Daniel 3:25

KJV: *"…the form of the fourth is like the Son of God."*

NASB: *"…the appearance of the fourth is like a son of the gods."*

The KJV points to Christ as the fourth man in the fire. The NASB makes it sound like Nebuchadnezzar just saw a pagan deity.

Colossians 1:14

KJV: *"…redemption through his blood, even the forgiveness of sins."*

NIV: *"…redemption, the forgiveness of sins."*

Taking out "through his blood" removes the very means of redemption. Without the blood of Christ, there is no forgiveness.

Acts 8:37

KJV: *"…And Philip said, If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest. And he answered and said, I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God."*

CSB: Omitted, footnote only.

This verse contains the Ethiopian eunuch's confession of faith **before** baptism. Leaving it out removes a key testimony that salvation is by faith in Christ before baptism.

Acts 9:6

KJV: *"…Lord, what wilt thou have me to do?"*

ESV: Shorter; Paul's cry is missing.

The KJV records Paul's first words of surrender to the Lord. Without them, the dramatic conversion moment loses some of its impact.

Matthew 18:11

KJV: *"For the Son of man is come to save that which was lost."*

NASB: Verse omitted.

This is a clear purpose statement of why Jesus came: to save the lost. Why remove it?

John 6:47

KJV: *"…He that believeth on me hath everlasting life."*

NIV: *"…the one who believes has eternal life."*

Dropping "on me" weakens the focus. Faith isn't just a vague belief; it must be in Christ.

Isaiah 14:12 / Revelation 22:16

KJV Isa. 14:12: *"How art thou fallen from heaven, O Lucifer, son of the morning!"*

NIV Isa. 14:12: "How you have fallen *from heaven, morning star, son of the dawn!"*

KJV Rev. 22:16: *"…I Jesus… am the bright and morning star."*

NIV Rev. 22:16: *"…I, Jesus… am the bright morning star."*

By changing "Lucifer" to "morning star," modern versions end up giving the same title to both Satan (**Isaiah 14**) and Jesus (**Revelation 22**). That creates confusion and blurs the line between Christ and the devil.

Also, an interesting experiment to show this issue would be to ask a Christian who uses modern Bible versions, "Where does everything that you believe stem from?" They will likely tell you the Bible unreservedly. Then ask a follow-up, "Who is Lucifer?" They will likely tell you it was the Devil before he fell (almost anyone is familiar with this name). Then a final question, "Where did you learn that from?" They will frantically search their Bibles, only to discover to their amazement that the name does not even appear in their Bibles, unless… they have the King James Bible (the NKJV also includes the name). They hold a specific belief about a name of the Devil, but that name is not in their Bibles. This presents quite a predicament.

As a side note, who would want to remove that name from your Bible? And why? (Gen. 3)

Genesis 3:16

KJV: *"…thy desire shall be to thy husband, and he shall rule over thee."*

ESV: *"…your desire shall be contrary to your husband, but he shall rule over you."*

The KJV says the woman's desire would be toward her husband (which many understand as a desire for closeness or dependence). The ESV flips it, saying her desire would be "contrary" to him, introducing conflict. That's not a small shift; it is completely contradictory to the King James Bible reading.

Mark 9:29

KJV: *"…by prayer and fasting."*

CSB: *"…by prayer."*

Fasting is one of the disciplines Jesus taught. Dropping it weakens the verse's teaching on spiritual warfare and the need for fasting.

Matthew 17:21

KJV: *"Howbeit this kind goeth not out but by prayer and fasting."*

NIV: Omitted.

Again, fasting is gone.

Again, who would want to remove a key verse showing you a key step in "casting out devils"? And why? (**Gen. 3**)

Luke 11:2–4

KJV: "*Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth. Give us day by day our daily bread. And forgive us our sins; for we also forgive every one that is indebted to us. And lead us not into temptation; but deliver us from evil.*"

NASB: Shorter form, leaving out "*which art in heaven,*" "*thy will be done,*" and "*deliver us from evil.*"

Jesus gave us a model prayer. Why remove so much of it?

Mark 1:2

KJV: "*As it is written in the prophets…*"

ESV: "*As it is written in Isaiah the prophet…*"

Since Mark quotes both Isaiah and Malachi, the ESV makes it look like Mark misattributed the quote. The KJV avoids the problem with "prophets."

Psalm 12:6–7

KJV: "*…The words of the LORD are pure words… Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.*"

NIV: "*…You, LORD, will keep* ***the needy*** *safe and will protect* ***us*** *forever from the wicked.*"

The KJV says God is preserving **His words**. The NIV shifts it to "us" (the people). This turns a promise about God's words into a promise about protection of the people. Both are true in general, but only one matches the grammar here.

Matthew 9:13 / Mark 2:17

KJV: *"…I am not come to call the righteous, but sinners to* ***repentance****."*

CSB: *"…I came not to call the righteous, but sinners."*

Leaving out "repentance" changes the very purpose of Christ's call. Repentance is at the heart of the gospel message, and dropping it leaves only half the truth.

Romans 8:1

KJV: *"…There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus,* ***who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.****"*

ESV: *"…There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."*

The ESV cuts off the second half of the verse. The KJV keeps Paul's full thought: yes, no condemnation in Christ, but also a reminder that those in Him will walk by the Spirit, not the flesh.

Matthew 6:13 — The Lord's Prayer Ending

KJV: *"…For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen."*

NASB: Leaves this out; footnote only.

The ending and main thrust of the Lord's Prayer, which teach us a key pattern for our prayer lives, are taken out in modern versions.

Mark 10:24

KJV: *"…Children, how hard is it for them that trust in riches to enter into the kingdom of God!"*

NIV: *"…how hard it is* ***to enter the kingdom of God****!"*

The KJV makes it clear: the problem is trusting in riches. The NIV just says it's hard for anyone to enter God's kingdom. Very different.

John 7:8

KJV: "*…I go not up* ***yet*** *unto this feast…"*

ESV: "*…I am not going up to this feast…"*

In the KJV, Jesus says He is not going up "yet," which matches what happens a few verses later when He does go. The ESV makes it sound like He lied, since He says He's not going at all, then does.

Luke 4:18

KJV: "*…he hath sent me to heal the brokenhearted, to preach deliverance to the captives, and recovering of sight to the blind, to set at liberty them that are bruised."*

CSB: "*…He has sent me to proclaim release to the captives and recovery of sight to the blind, to set free the oppressed."*

The phrase "heal the brokenhearted" is dropped. That's one of Jesus' most famous descriptions of His ministry, and it's missing.

Luke 9:56

KJV: "*…For the Son of man is not come to destroy men's lives, but to save them."*

NASB: Shortened: "*…they went on to another village."*

An entire statement of Christ's saving purpose disappears.

John 3:16

KJV: "*…his only begotten Son…"*

NIV: *"…his one and only Son…"*

Removing "begotten" (which shows Christ's unique eternal relationship with the Father) weakens the verse's theology. Jesus isn't God's "only" son; Adam is called a son of God, and believers are sons of God. But He is the only **begotten** Son.

Matthew 20:20

KJV: *"…the mother of Zebedee's children with her sons, worshipping him…"*

ESV: *"…the mother of the sons of Zebedee came up to him with her sons…"* (*"worshipping him"* omitted).

The KJV shows the disciples' family worshipping Jesus. The ESV leaves it out, lessening a worship moment.

Acts 2:30

KJV: *"…he would raise up Christ to sit on his throne."*

CSB: *"…he would* ***raise up one of his descendants*** *to sit on his throne."*

The KJV points directly to Christ. The CSB dilutes the clarity of Peter's sermon by making it sound more generic.

Acts 3:13

KJV: *"…the God of our fathers, hath glorified his Son Jesus…"*

NASB: *"…has glorified his servant Jesus…"*

The KJV says **Son**, pointing to Christ's unique status. The NASB says **servant**, which is true in a sense, but is much weaker.

Mark 9:44, 46

KJV: *"Where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched."* (repeated in vv. 44, 46, 48)

NIV: These lines are omitted in vv. 44 and 46, kept only in v. 48.

Jesus repeated it three times for emphasis. Modern versions reduce it to once, softening one of the Bible's most graphic warnings about hell.

Revelation 1:11

KJV: *"…I am Alpha and Omega, the first and the last: and, What thou seest, write in a book…"*

ESV: *"…Write what you see in a book…"*

The strong self-identification of Christ as Alpha and Omega is cut.

Jude 1:25

KJV: *"…to the only wise God our Saviour…"*

ESV: *"…to the only God…"*

KJV explicitly ties God to being our **Saviour**. The ESV removes the direct reference.

Micah 5:2

KJV: *"But thou, Beth-lehem Ephratah… out of thee shall he come forth unto me that is to be ruler in Israel; whose goings forth have been from of old,* ***from everlasting.****"*

NIV: *"whose origins are from of old,* ***from ancient times.****"*

The KJV clearly calls Christ eternal; His "goings forth" are from **everlasting**. That points straight to His deity, showing He

existed before time and will always exist. No ending and no beginning.

The **NIV** says "from ancient times," which makes it sound like He has a long history, but not necessarily eternal. That could apply to a created being.

2 Samuel 21:19

KJV: "*…Elhanan… slew the brother of Goliath…*"

ESV: "*…Elhanan… killed Goliath the Gittite…*"

If the modern versions' rendering is taken at face value, it directly contradicts **1 Samuel 17**, where David kills Goliath. The **KJV** translators preserved this correctly by including the Hebrew "the brother of Goliath" (compare 1 Chron. 20:5, which clarifies this). Modern Bibles have David killing Goliath in **1 Samuel 17**, and then Elhanan killing Goliath in 2 Sam. 21:19. This is a plain contradiction.

1 Corinthians 9:27

KJV: "*But I keep under my body, and bring it into subjection…*"

NIV: "*No, I strike a blow to my body and make it my slave.*"

In this verse, the NIV talks about self-harm and making your body into your slave. These are not biblical teachings that you would want anyone to take away from this passage. The KJV makes it clear that Paul is talking about self-control and bringing your body into your control. This is vastly different from the self-harm of the NIV.

Luke 24:51 (cf. Acts 1:1–2)

KJV: "*carried up into heaven…"*

RSV: *This verse ending is omitted in Nestle's Greek Text (text used for modern versions) and has been omitted in multiple editions of the RSV, NASB, and others.*

The issue of modern versions omitting or "footnoting" this part of the verse in **Luke 24:51** is found when it is compared with Luke's other writing in **Acts 1:1–2**. Here he tells Theophilus how he wrote to him before (referring to the Gospel of Luke) and told him all things "of all that Jesus began both to do and teach, *Until the day in which he was taken up."* Luke's own statement in **Acts 1:1–2** discounts any *"false copy"* of his original "*treatise"* (Gospel of Luke) that does not include the ending where Jesus is "*taken up."* Modern versions and the Greek text on which they are based create a contradiction in their *"bibles"* by omitting this.

Conclusion

These aren't just stylistic differences. They touch Jesus' deity, the Trinity, His virgin birth, His saving blood, salvation by faith, the fall of man, spiritual warfare, marriage, and the authority of God's Word itself. The King James Bible preserves the stronger and clearer readings. Modern versions often dull or remove them completely.

DOCTRINAL ISSUES IN NEW BIBLE VERSIONS

☆ Baptism Before or After Salvation? (Acts 8:37)

KJV- 36 And as they went on their way, they came unto a certain water: and the eunuch said, See, here is water; what doth hinder me to be baptized?
37 ¶ And Philip said, If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest. And he answered and said, I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God.
38 ¶ And he commanded the chariot to stand still: and they went down both into the water, both Philip and the eunuch; and he baptized him.

NIV- 36 As they traveled along the road, they came to some water and the eunuch said, "Look, here is water. What can stand in the way of my being baptized?"
37 (MISSING)
38 And he gave orders to stop the chariot. Then both Philip and the eunuch went down into the water and Philip baptized him.

☆ Was Jesus God? (Phil. 2:5-6)

KJV- Let this mind be in you, which was also in Christ Jesus: Who, being in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God:

ESV- Have this mind among yourselves, which is yours in Christ Jesus, who, though he was in the form of God, did not count equality with God a thing to be grasped

☆ Is the Wife supposed to be Against her Husband? (Gen. 3:16)

KJV- Unto the woman he said, I will greatly multiply thy sorrow and thy conception; in sorrow thou shalt bring forth children; and thy desire shall be to thy husband, and he shall rule over thee.

ESV- To the woman he said, "I will surely multiply your pain in childbearing; in pain you shall bring forth children. Your desire shall be contrary to your husband, but he shall rule over you.

☆ Who is Lucifer? (Isa.14:12)

KJV- How art thou fallen from heaven, O Lucifer, son of the morning! how art thou cut down to the ground, which didst weaken the nations!

ESV- "How you are fallen from heaven, O Day Star, son of Dawn! How you are cut down to the ground, you who laid the nations low!

****No other Bible version out there mentions the name "Lucifer" even once (Except for the NKJV) in their entire Bible. The NIV goes even further down a bad path by referring to the Devil and Jesus Christ by the same name "Morning Star".

NIV- "How you have fallen from heaven, morning star, son of the dawn! You have been cast down to the earth, you who once laid low the nations!

NIV in Revelation 22:16 - "I, Jesus, have sent my angel to give youfn this testimony for the churches. I am the Root and the Offspring of David, and the bright Morning Star.

☆ Is God a Trinity (1 John 5:7)

KJV- For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.

ESV- 7 For there are three that testify:
8 the Spirit and the water and the blood; and these three agree.

***NO MENTION OF THE TRINITY HERE AT ALL IN ANY NEW BIBLE VERSIONS

EASE OF READING

One of the most repeated objections to the King James Bible is not textual, doctrinal, or historical but practical: *"It's too hard to read."* In the age of "easy-to-understand" versions, the assumption is that seventeenth-century English must be inaccessible to modern readers. But when we step beyond assumption and examine the evidence, a very different conclusion emerges.

What the Numbers Actually Say

Readability is not a matter of personal opinion. Scholars use standardized formulas such as the **Flesch Reading Ease Score** and **Flesch–Kincaid Grade Level** to evaluate text difficulty. These measure average sentence length and syllables per word.

- The KJV consistently scores at or around an **eighth-grade reading level**. For example, **Genesis 1** scores 8.13 (eighth grade), **Romans 3:1–23** scores 5.63 (sixth grade), and **Romans 8** scores 7.72 (eighth grade).
- Peer-reviewed research by Emilio Matricciani (2023) on Matthew's Gospel translations placed the **KJV at approximately eight years of schooling for "easy" reading, compared with more than thirteen for the NASB and approximately six for the NIV**, squarely in the middle of the field.[125]

In other words: the KJV is not the hardest English Bible, and by some measures it is easier than many modern versions.

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[125] Emilio Matricciani, "Readability across Time and Languages: The Case of Matthew's Gospel Translations," *AppliedMath* 3, no. 2 (2023): 497–509.

Archaic Words: A Help, Not a Hindrance

The most common complaint is about words like *thee, thou, ye, thine*. Critics assume these are outdated formalities. In reality, they preserve a distinction between **singular** and **plural** that modern English has lost.

- *Thou/thee/thy* = singular.
- *Ye/you/your* = plural.

This provides clarity. When Jesus said in **Luke 22:31–32**, *"Satan hath desired to have **you** [all the disciples], but I have prayed for **thee** [Peter],"* the KJV makes the switch explicit.[126] Modern versions flatten both to *"you,"* obscuring the point.

Far from making the text less clear, the KJV often makes it **more precise**.

Designed for Oral Clarity

Literary historians emphasize that the King James Bible was **crafted for the ear** as much as for the eye. Its cadence, parallelism, and rhythm were designed to be read aloud in church.

- **Gordon Campbell (Oxford)** argues that the KJV's formal idiom is **not obscure but rhetorical**, intentionally suited for public proclamation.[127]

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[126] *Oxford English Dictionary*, s.v. "thou, pron.," *OED Online* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2023).

[127] Campbell, Bible, 170.

- **Leland Ryken (Wheaton)** defends the KJV's formal style as an aid to clarity, not an obstacle, insisting that its archaisms are minimal and its diction memorably concrete.[128]
- **David Norton (Cambridge)** notes that while the KJV preserves an elevated register, it has remained **functionally intelligible** for centuries.[129]

When read aloud, the KJV proves remarkably accessible, which explains its enduring role in worship and evangelism.

Readability ≠ Shallowness

Modern claims of "easier reading" often confuse **simplification** with **comprehension**. The Bible was never meant to read like a comic book. It was meant to challenge, to lodge in memory, and to be studied.

- **Psalm 119:130 —** "The entrance of thy words giveth light; it giveth understanding unto the simple."
- **Proverbs 2:4–5 —** understanding comes by searching "as for hid treasures."

The KJV does not obscure truth with jargon. Its plain Anglo-Saxon vocabulary (*sin, blood, law, grace*) is simple. Its cadence and dignity, however, call the reader to seriousness. This balance is one reason it has been memorized by children, preached by evangelists, and used by missionaries for centuries.

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[128] Leland Ryken, "Ten Fallacies about the King James Version," *Southern Baptist Journal of Theology* 15, no. 4 (2011): 11–14.

[129] Norton, *Textual History of the King James Bible*, 14–15.

Historical Reality: Ordinary People Read It

The claim that the KJV is "too hard" ignores history. For four centuries it was the **common man's Bible**: plowboys memorized it, mothers taught it, coal miners sang from it, and revivalists preached it across nations.

- **David Crystal (Oxford)** documents in *Begat: The King James Bible and the English Language* that hundreds of KJV phrases entered everyday English precisely because ordinary people grasped and repeated them.[130]
- The great missionary movements of Carey, Judson, and Taylor were carried forward not by "simplified" Bibles but by translations rooted in the KJV's textual line.

If it were truly unreadable, it could not have functioned as the people's Bible for so long.

Conclusion

When the evidence is weighed, the charge that the KJV is "too difficult" collapses.

1. **Objective studies** show the KJV's readability is at or below that of many modern versions.
2. Its so-called "archaic" forms often clarify meaning rather than obscure it; also it was designed for oral clarity, and scholars affirm its continued intelligibility.
3. History demonstrates that it functioned as the Bible of the people for 400 years.

The King James Bible is not harder; it is **sharper, clearer, and more enduring**. Its dignity does not hinder comprehension; it

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[130] Crystal, *Begat*.

elevates it. As **Psalm 19:7** says: *"The law of the LORD is perfect, converting the soul: the testimony of the LORD is sure, making wise the simple."*

MAJOR FAQS

SECTION I: GENERAL FAQS

When it comes to the King James Bible issue, certain objections appear again and again. Many of these are less about evidence and more about assumptions, but they deserve careful answers. Below are some of the most common questions, along with responses grounded in Scripture, history, and the record of scholarship.

Q1. "How can the King James Bible be the standard, when it's just one translation among many?"

This is often the first objection raised. But the question misses a key point: every generation must have a standard. Remember, the position this book presents is "faith-based." *It is not a blind faith; it begins with faith and finds the answers from there.*

- **Psalm 12:6–7** — God promised to preserve His words, not just their "general message."
- **Matthew 24:35** — Christ said His words would not pass away.
- **1 Peter 1:23, 25** — The Word of God "liveth and abideth for ever."

Somewhere in history, God must have preserved His Word in a form His people could use. The King James Bible became that standard in the English-speaking world for nearly three centuries. Missionaries, pastors, and ordinary believers measured all other translations by it. Even today, new versions constantly compare themselves against the KJV, not against each other.

Q2. "Didn't the translators themselves admit it wasn't perfect?"

It is true that the KJV translators, in their preface, acknowledged that even the "meanest [worst] translation" of the Bible could still be called the Word of God. But this humility does not undermine the providential perfection of their work.

God has often used men who did not fully grasp the scope of His plan. Jeremiah's scribes may not have realized they were producing Scripture (**Jer. 36**), but God declared it so. Similarly, the KJV translators were instruments in God's preservation work whether or not they foresaw its enduring role.

We also see from their notes in "The Translators to the Reader" that the translators were men who realized the weight of their task and had a "faith-based" view of it as well.

> "Truly, good Christian Reader, we never thought from the beginning that we should need to make a new translation, nor yet to make of a bad one a good one; but to make a good one better, or out of many good ones one principal good one, not justly to be excepted against; that hath been our endeavor, that our mark. To that purpose there were many chosen, that were greater in other men's eyes than in their own, and that sought the truth rather than their own praise … And in what sort did these assemble? In the trust of their own knowledge, or of their sharpness of wit, or deepness of judgment, as it were an arm of flesh? At no hand. They trusted in him that hath the key of *David,* opening, and no man shutting; they prayed to the Lord, the Father of our Lord, to the effect that *St. Augustine* did, *O let thy Scriptures be my pure delight; let me not be deceived in them, neither let me deceive by them.* In this confidence and with this devotion, did they assemble together; not too many,

lest one should trouble another; and yet many, lest many things haply might escape them."[131]

A Note about the KJV Translators' Methods

Roughly **fifty-four** scholars were appointed, organized into **six companies** at Westminster, Cambridge, and Oxford. Each company had a defined portion:

First Westminster (Gen–2 Kgs), First Cambridge (1 Chr–Song), First Oxford (Isa–Mal), **Second Cambridge** (Apocrypha), **Second Oxford** (Gospels–Acts–Rev), **Second Westminster** (Romans–Jude).[132]

They followed fifteen translation rules (issued by Bancroft)[133], including: use the **Bishops' Bible** as the base but correct it "where it deviates from the truth of the original," **retain ecclesiastical terms** (e.g., "church," not "congregation"), and **consult earlier English Bibles** (Tyndale, Coverdale, Matthew, Great Bible, Geneva) wherever they helped. The process ran in **stages**: first, each translator worked independently; then **company sessions** compared and reconciled; finally, a **general reviewing committee** (a small group drawn from all companies) harmonized the whole. **Marginal notes** were added sparingly, **not** to subvert authority but to acknowledge transparent alternatives in places of legitimate ambiguity. The end result is a Bible that is **textually careful** and **honest**, and whose English

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[131] Scrivener, Authorized Edition of the English Bible, 296–97.

[132] Ward Allen, *Translating for King James: Notes Made by a Translator of King James's Bible* (Nashville: Vanderbilt University Press, 1969), 28–35.

[133] These rules are historically documented and available in multiple sources. For a discussion, see Alister E. McGrath, *In the Beginning: The Story of the King James Bible and How It Changed a Nation, a Language, and a Culture* (New York: Anchor Books, 2002), 174–78.

favors **short, concrete Anglo-Saxon diction**, deliberately chosen to lodge in the ear and memory of ordinary hearers.

The Four-Stage Review That Yielded Fifteen Examinations

1. Every translator in a company first translated the same assigned chapters independently.
2. The company met to compare, debate, and agree on its text.
3. When a book was finished by one company, it was **sent to the other companies** for serious review.
4. Unresolved differences were **escalated to a general meeting** of senior revisers drawn from all companies, who produced the final harmonized text.

In practice, this yielded roughly **fifteen examinations** of each passage before press, far beyond the workflow of modern versions.

The Fifteen Rules That Governed the Whole Work (1604)

1. **Bishops' Bible as the base**, altered only where the truth of the originals required it.
2. **Proper names** to be kept as commonly used.
3. **Ecclesiastical terms** retained (e.g., "church," not "congregation").
4. Where a word has several senses, keep the one most used by the ancient fathers, fitting the place and the analogy of faith.
5. **Chapter divisions** not to be changed (or only minimally, if necessary).

6. **No doctrinal marginal notes**; margins only to explain Hebrew/Greek words that cannot be briefly expressed in the text.

7. **Cross-references** placed in the margins as helpful.

8. **Each man to translate the same chapters privately**; then meet, confer, and agree on what shall stand.

9. When a company finishes a book, **send it to the rest** to be considered seriously and judiciously.

10. If companies **differ**, send reasons and notes; if not resolved, **compound the difference at the general meeting** of chief persons at the end.

11. For **hard places**, write to any learned man in the realm for judgment.

12. **Bishops** to notify their clergy, urging the learned to send observations to the companies at Westminster, Cambridge, or Oxford.

13. **Directors** in each company: the Dean(s) (Westminster/Chester) and the King's Hebrew/Greek Professors in each university.

14. Earlier English versions to be **used wherever they agree better with the text** than the Bishops' (Tyndale, Matthew, Coverdale, Great Bible/Whitchurch, Geneva).

15. Besides the directors, **three or four ancient and grave divines** in each university (not otherwise employed) to act as **overseers** of the Hebrew and Greek, to secure careful observance of Rule 4.

THE SUPERIOR TRANSLATORS OF THE KJV

Lancelot Andrews



-During his 1-2 month vacations with his family, he would find a master of a language he did not know and learn the language before returning home
-He studied Oriental languages and Divinity at Cambridge
-He became the lecturer of Divinity at Cambridge
-At 24 he became the Master at Pembroke Hall
-He left the college to be the chaplain in ordinary to Queen Elizabeth, and then later he would become the Dean of Westminster
-Concerning his translation work, his work was the best among the others in his company
-He wrote all his personal devotions in Greek
-It was said of him that he was so skilled and versatile in languages that if he was present during the tower of Babel he could have served as interpreter general

John Bois



-At 5 yrs old he read through the Hebrew Bible
-At 6 yrs old he was able to write the Greek language in a "fair and elegant manner"
-At 15 yrs old he was enrolled at St. John's College in Cambridge, and at the halfway mark of his first year he was writing letters in Greek to his Masters
-While studying under one of his Masters, he had read through 12 Greek authors in verse and prose in the most difficult dialects and phrases that could be found
-It was common for him to go to the library at 4am and stay until 8pm
-At old age he still studied for 8 hours a day, reading and correcting ancient authors
-He would preach without notes because he wanted to be heard and understood by the most humble and ignorant hearers

Henry Savile



-He was educated at Brazen Nose College in Oxford, and then soon after travelled to France to perfect himself in literature
-His specialty was Greek and Math, and he would end up becoming the tutor of these subjects to Queen Elizabeth; his tutoring was so successful that her study habits were clearly seen into her old age
-He was the first person to completely translate the entire work of Chrysostom (8 huge folios); he translated many works into Latin and English
-He served as the Warden of Merton College, Provost of Eton College

***These are just a few of the 54 outstandingly qualified translators of the KJV

THE SUPERIOR TRANSLATION METHODS OF THE KJV

1. The basic text shall be that of the Bishop's Bible, with as little altered as the truth of the original will permit.
2. People's names, including those of the authors of Biblical books, shall be retained in the ordinary spelling as far as might be.
3. The old ecclesiastical words shall be retained (ex: "church").
4. Words of more than one meaning shall be used in the sense found in most of the ancient fathers, appropriate to the context and consistent with the analogy of the faith (In addition, to avoid any formalistic, stilted literary style, a variety of English words were used to render the same Hebrew or Greek word).
5. The chapter divisions shall follow those of the Bishop's Bible.
6. No marginal notes shall be added, except for the explanation of the Hebrew or Greek words which cannot be briefly and fitly expressed in the text.
7. Cross-references shall only relate to the relevant passages elsewhere in Scripture.
8. Translations and revisions were to be done first by individual then submitted to the whole company for scrutiny, criticism, and final approval.
9. As each section of Books are completed, they shall be submitted to the other companies, "to be considered of seriously and judiciously, for his Majesty is very careful in this point."
10. If any company, upon reviewing a Book, doubt or differ upon any place, they shall notify the original company. If their objection is declined, the matter shall be settled at a general meeting.
11. In cases of special obscurity the translators shall be entitled to request assistance form any learned man in the land.
12. Each bishop shall seek the judgment of those among his clergy who are "skillful in tongues" upon the work at hand.
13. The directors of each company shall be Deans of Westminster and Chester, and the Regius Professors of Oxford and Cambridge universities.
14. The following translations shall be used when they agree better with the text than the Bishop's Bible - Tyndale, Coverdale, Matthew, the Great Bible, and the Geneva Bible.
15. Three or four of the most ancient and grave divines, from either of the universities and not employed in the translating, shall be overseers of the work.

THE UNIQUENESS OF THE KJV

- It was authorized by a King (1 Peter 2:17; Ecc. 8:4)
- No Copyright (2 Tim. 2:9)
- Scientific (Lev. 15:13; Job 25:5 37:7; 38:19; Ps. 75:5; 119:70)
- Use of Italics (The only honest translation because it marks all connective language additions needed when making any translation.)
- Self Defining (Mt. 10:1-5; Gen. 8:1-5; 17:10-11; Judges 9:24, 56; 2 Samuel 12:3
- The time in history of its translation (A major, yet often dismissed, factor concerning the KJV is the timeinhistorywhenitwastranslated. Therearemanyschoolsof thought today that deeply effect our mindset concerning life's issues. These schools of thought affect us every day and cause different outcomes to take place in a plethora of circumstances and situations. For example: Atheism, Rationalism and Deism effect the decisions our government and business leaders make concerning a whole host of issues (abortion, homosexuality, prayer in schools, domestic laws, availability of anti-biblical products, etc.). At the time of the writing of the King James Bible none of these things were established arenas of thinking. French Atheism was not in vogue, German Rationalists did not exist, therefore had no influence on anyones thinking. English Deism was not around so no one thought that God was "dead" or absent from his creation. Thus men could produce a Bible that without objection, a Bible that could be believed by the common man!
- The preeminence it gives to the Lord Jesus Christ: Verses kept intact- Jo. 1:18; Lk. 2:33; 1 Ti. 3:16; Acts 4:27; 8:37; 1 Jo. 5:7 (to name a few)
- Signs and Maps (The use of key words and phrases and other built-in study tools)-
  - -That Day/The Day of the Lord-
  - -Those Days -
  - -Serpent; Beast; Dragon -
  - -Sword -
  - -Selah -
  - -Third Day / Three Days -
  - -The use of Numerology -
  - -The law of First Mention -
  - -The use of Repetition -
  - -Self-defining / Built-in Dictionary



- The geographic location from whence it came- England is the standard for world time and direction
- The fruit it has borne-
  - Greatest time in world missions
  - More folks get saved under its preaching; more sustained growth is measured
  - The fear it creates
  - The enemies it has made and the controversy always surrounding it (like none other)
  - Its popularity

Q3. "Isn't the language too archaic for modern readers?"

This has already been addressed at length in the previous chapter. The evidence shows the KJV is written at an eighth-grade level on average, often easier than modern versions. Its so-called "archaic" pronouns actually add precision, and its rhythm aids comprehension.

Regarding the language of the KJV compared with that of modern versions, Dr. Edward Hills had the following to say:

> "In the fourth place, modern-speech Bibles are unhistorical and irreverent. The Bible is not a modern, human book. It is not as new as the morning newspaper, and no translation should suggest this. If the Bible were this new, it would not be the Bible. On the contrary, the Bible is an ancient, divine Book, which nevertheless is always new because in it God reveals Himself. Hence the language of the Bible should be venerable as well as intelligible, and the King James Version fulfills these two requirements better than any other Bible in English. Hence it is the King James Version which converts sinners soundly and makes of them diligent Bible students. In the fifth place, modern-speech Bibles are unscholarly. The language of the Bible has always savored of the things of heaven rather than the things of earth. It has always been biblical rather than contemporary and colloquial."[134]

He also stated,

> "In regard to Bible versions many contemporary Christians are behaving like spoiled and rebellious

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[134] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 170.

> children. They want a Bible version that pleases them no matter whether it pleases God or not. 'We want a Bible version in our own idiom,' they clamor. 'We want a Bible that talks to us in the same way in which we talk to our friends over the telephone. We want an informal God, no better educated than ourselves, with a limited vocabulary and a taste for modern slang.' And having thus registered their preference, they go their several ways. Some of them unite with the modernists in using the R.S.V. or the N.E.B. Others deem the N.A.S.V. or the N.I.V. more 'evangelical.' Still others opt for the T.E.V. or the *Living Bible.* But God is bigger than you are, dear friend, and the Bible version which you must use is not a matter for you to decide according to your whims and prejudices. It has already been decided for you by the workings of God's special providence…"[135]

The Bible is not written in the language of "modern man," and it is also not written in old Elizabethan language[136]. It is written in the language and speech of God Himself, the very words of God.

Far from being inaccessible, history proves it was the Bible of plowboys, sailors, and mothers teaching their children.

Q4. "What about the errors in the KJV? Doesn't it contradict itself?"

Critics often point to numerical differences (e.g., Ahaziah's age in **2 Kings 8:26** vs. **2 Chronicles 22:2**; Jehoiachin's age in **2 Kings 24:8** vs. **2 Chronicles 36:9**). These supposed "errors" have reasonable explanations:

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[135] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 191–92.

[136] H. W. Robinson, *The Bible in Its Ancient and English Versions* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1954), 37.

- In ancient monarchies, sons often began to reign under their fathers before taking full kingship. Thus different numbers can refer to different phases of reign.
- **Numbers 25:9** lists 24,000 deaths; **1 Corinthians 10:8** says 23,000. The difference is easily explained: 23,000 in a single day, 24,000 total.

These are not contradictions but only "apparent" contradictions. They do not hold up once further investigation is done.

Q5. "Didn't the original 1611 KJV include the Apocrypha?"

Yes, the 1611 edition contained a section labeled "The Books Called Apocrypha," but crucially, they were not intermingled with the Old and New Testaments. They were set apart between Malachi and Matthew, and never treated as canonical.

By contrast, Alexandrian manuscripts such as Vaticanus and Sinaiticus do include the Apocrypha mixed in with Scripture. Origen's Hexapla did the same. The KJV translators followed the historic Protestant practice: including Apocrypha for historical reference but marking it as non-Scriptural.

This view of the Apocrypha was stated clearly in two separate confessions around the time of the KJV translation:

> "The books commonly called Apocrypha, not being of divine inspiration, are no part of the canon of the Scripture, and therefore are of no authority."[137]
>
> "The Books commonly called Apocrypha not being of Divine inspiration, are no part of the Canon (or rule) of

[137] Westminster Assembly, *The Westminster Confession of Faith* (1647), 1.3.

the Scripture, and therefore are of no authority to the Church of God."[138]

Q6. "Haven't there been many revisions? Which KJV is perfect?"

This objection plays on confusion between revisions and editions.

- The differences between the 1611 and modern KJV are mostly spelling and typography (e.g., sonne → son, musick → music, the "long s" that looked like "f").
- A few printing errors were corrected (e.g., the infamous "Wicked Bible" of 1631 that accidentally omitted "not" from "Thou shalt not commit adultery").
- No doctrinal or substantive changes were made.

Thus, when critics claim "thousands of changes," they inflate minor printing updates. The KJV today is the same Bible as 1611, with spelling modernized.

Q7. "Isn't it divisive to insist on the KJV? Shouldn't we focus on unity and love?"

Unity must be built on truth. If the Bible is our foundation, then the question of which Bible is not "minor." The apostle Paul warned that false teachers would "corrupt the word of God" (**2 Cor. 2:17**). To dismiss the issue as irrelevant is to dismiss the very source of doctrine, reproof, correction, and instruction (**2 Tim. 3:16**).

The KJV debate only feels divisive because it forces us to ask: Has God kept His promise to preserve His words? If He has,

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[138] *The Second London Baptist Confession of Faith* (1689), 1.3.

then there must be a standard text. If He has not, then all unity is built on shifting sand.

Q8. "What about people in other languages? Did God only preserve His Word in English?"

This question mixes together **two different issues:**

1. God's preserved/purified/perfect word that we can find and hold
2. Reliable translations

First, God's preserved/purified/perfect word. God promised to keep His words pure forever (**Psalm 12:6–7**). That promise applies to the Hebrew Old Testament and the Greek New Testament, faithfully preserved in the Masoretic Text and the Textus Receptus, all the way through to the English KJV. This is the promised word we can hold today, 100 percent perfect.

Second: reliable translations. When translators **faithfully** use and translate from those preserved/pure texts from Antioch, the Jewish Masoretic Text, or the KJV, people around the world can read the true Word of God in their own tongue. These Bibles are not corrupt; they give God's Word accurately and faithfully. They are reliable translations, not corruptions.

These translations may also be described as "***perfect***" in the biblical sense of the word. Remember the definition of *perfect* from the glossary:

> "From the Latin *perficere*, meaning 'complete.' The biblical definition follows the same meaning: complete, entire, and lacking nothing needed (e.g., **Job 1:1, 8**; 2:3; **2 Tim. 3:17**)."

In other words, a faithful translation does not have to be identical in wording to the King James Bible in order to be

complete and sufficient for the people who read it. If it faithfully represents the preserved Word of God in their own language, it gives them what they need to know and obey God's Word.

But Why English?

That touches on another topic for another book, but consider this: English has become the universal language of the modern world. It is the language of commerce, technology, diplomacy, and missions. More missionaries carry English Bibles than any other. English is the language of the end times. English possesses an extraordinarily large vocabulary and has been described by scholars as having the largest vocabulary among the major languages of the world.[139] One language scholar states simply, "English has the largest vocabulary of any language."[140] This extensive vocabulary allows such a remarkable ability to express fine distinctions in meaning, description, and nuance. It makes sense, then, that God would bring His purified Word into the language that would be universal.

Here's the bottom line:

- In many languages today, we have **reliable, accurate, uncorrupted Bibles** when they are translated from the preserved Hebrew and Greek texts and the KJV.
- But in English, God has given us the **purified Bible**, His words refined and perfected in the King James Bible.

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[139] Peter Hu, "Adapting English into Chinese," *English Today* 20, no. 2 (April 2004): 34, https://doi.org/10.1017/S0266078404002068.

[140] James B. Carter, "English Spelling Reform," *Prometheus* 24, no. 1 (March 2006): 83, https://doi.org/10.1080/08109020600563952.

This isn't "English-only salvation." It is simply recognizing that God made a promise to preserve His words and to purify them, and that promise found its final home in the English KJV.

Also, consider that just as God used the New Testament priesthood of the believers to confirm the preserved text throughout church history (leading to the TR and Majority Text), He also did the same thing with the King James Bible.

Many other English translations existed before the King James, and there were also other translations into other languages. Despite this, the King James Bible was more widely received by the church as a whole than any other translation effort. It was confirmed by the people of God, through the Spirit of God indwelling His people.

The King James Bible was taken around the world, was used to help others learn English, and became a basis for modern missions on a scale the world had never seen. It was "Authorized" by the people of God for hundreds of years as the standard Bible. This reception of the King James Bible is another great evidence for God's hand on it. Its reception exceeded that of earlier English translations and other-language translations produced at the time or since.

Q9. "Aren't today's scholars better equipped than those in 1611?"

The KJV translators were among the most skilled linguists ever assembled. Many spoke 8–15 languages fluently. They had access to all the major manuscripts in existence at the time, including those still used today. They worked in teams, cross-checking one another's work in ways modern committees rarely match.

Modern technology has given us searchable databases, but truth is not found in computers; it is found in the words God preserved. The translators of 1611 were not hindered by lack of technology; they were aided by unparalleled scholarship and divine providence.

Q10. "If the KJV is perfect, why not call it inspired?"

We do not say the KJV was newly inspired in 1611. We say it is preserved and purified providentially by God. Just as God told Jeremiah to rewrite His words after Jehoiakim destroyed the original scroll (**Jer. 36**), even adding "many like words," so God has preserved and purified His Word through history. Inspiration is the initial giving; preservation is the keeping; purification is the providential refining and settling.

The KJV is the fruit of God's promise to keep His words pure for every generation (**Ps. 12:6–7**).

Q11. "Why does the KJV say 'Easter' in Acts 12:4? Isn't that a mistake?"

Not at all. This is actually one of those places where the King James translators showed real discernment. The Greek word *pascha* can mean "Passover," but it can also mean the larger festival season that followed. Verse 3 has already told us "then were the days of unleavened bread," which means the Jewish Passover had already happened. If you try to force "Passover" into verse 4, it makes no sense; Herod would be planning Peter's execution *after* a feast that was already over. This places a flat-out contradiction into modern versions that use "Passover" here instead of Easter.

On top of that, remember who we're dealing with: **Herod was a pagan king.** He wasn't a God-fearing Jew who cared about honoring Passover. He would have no reason to arrange his

schedule around a Jewish holy day. What he *would* have cared about was avoiding trouble with the crowds during a major festival period. At that time, the spring festival season was commonly called "Easter" in English. That word referred to the broader pagan holiday season that overlapped with the Jewish calendar.

The King James translators used "Easter" here to show exactly that: Herod wasn't waiting for a Jewish feast to end, but for the whole pagan festival season to pass before bringing Peter out. That way he could avoid a riot and still look like he was acting decisively.

So rather than being an error, "Easter" in **Acts 12:4** is the **precise word choice**. It reflects both the context (the Jewish Passover had already passed) and the character of Herod (an "Edomite" by ancestry but a pagan ruler by practice who would think in terms of pagan holidays, not Jewish ones). Modern versions that change it to "Passover" actually create a contradiction and miss the historical situation Luke is describing.

Q12. "Why does the KJV use italicized words?"

When you see *italicized* words in the KJV, the translators aren't sneaking in doctrine; they're being upfront with you. Biblical Hebrew and Greek often leave out little words that English requires for a smooth, grammatical sentence (think of the linking verb "is," a supplied subject, or a helper like "there is/are"). To make the English read naturally **without** changing the meaning, the KJV team supplied those necessary words and then **flagged them in italics** so you can see exactly what was added for clear English.

Keep these three points in mind:

- **What italics do mean:** a word has been **supplied** in English because the sense is implied in the original languages.
- **What italics do not mean:** they are **not** signals of doubt, error, or guesswork. The translators are simply showing their work.
- **Other Bibles do this too:** every translation supplies words to make the English translation make sense. *Most modern versions just don't mark them.*

SECTION II: TECHNICAL FAQS

Q13. "Did Erasmus 'add' the Johannine Comma (1 John 5:7–8) to please critics? Isn't it late?"

The claim: Erasmus supposedly gave in to pressure and inserted "in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one," even though the reading was late.

The record with dates: the Greek manuscript support is late, but the reading was known much earlier in Latin writing, Scripture quotation, and church use.

Greek Manuscript Evidence

- GA 629 (Ottobonianus), A.D. 1362–1363: the earliest dated Greek manuscript with a Comma form in the main text.
- GA 61 (Montfortianus), c. A.D. 1495–1521: contains a Comma form in the biblical text.
- GA 918, c. A.D. 1573–1578: contains a Comma form in the biblical text.
- GA 2473 (A.D. 1634) and GA 2318 (eighteenth century) also contain main-text forms. Five other Greek manuscripts contain later marginal forms.

Early Witnesses Before A.D. 550

Early supporting witnesses include:

- Tertullian, c. A.D. 210, Against Praxeas 25: related three-one language joining the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.
- Cyprian, c. A.D. 250, *On the Unity of the Church* 6: introduces the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit wording with "it is written" and concludes, "And these three are one."[141]
- *Expositio Fidei*, A.D. 367–400: an explicit Father, Word, and Spirit three-one form.
- Priscillian, c. A.D. 380, Liber Apologeticus 1.4: an explicit full Latin heavenly-witness formula.[142]
- Codex Speculum, fifth century: contains the Comma in a collection of Latin Scripture quotations.
- *Contra Varimadum*, c. A.D. 450: contains an explicit heavenly-witness form.
- The confession of the African bishops at Carthage under Huneric, A.D. 484: contains an explicit heavenly-witness form.[143]

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[141] In his treatise *On the Unity of the Church*, Cyprian writes, "The Lord says, 'I and the Father are one'; and again it is written of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, 'And these three are one.'" Cyprian, De Unitate Ecclesiae, 6. This is considered by many to be the earliest clear reference to the Comma Johanneum.

[142] Priscillian, Liber Apologeticus 1.4, in *The Works of Priscillian of Avila*, trans. Marco Conti (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2010), 36.

[143] Victor of Vita, *Historia Persecutionis Africanae Provinciae* [History of the Persecution of the African Province], 3.11, in *Victor Vitensis: Historia Persecutionis*, ed. and trans. John Moorhead (Liverpool: Liverpool

- Fulgentius of Ruspe, c. A.D. 527: supports the reading in Contra Arianos, Contra Fabianum, and De Trinitate ad Felicem.

Cassiodorus is also an early-sixth-century supporting witness, though his work is broadly dated A.D. 501–600 and cannot be placed securely before A.D. 550.

Printed Editions and Erasmus

- The Complutensian Polyglot printed the Comma in its Greek New Testament in 1514, before Erasmus's third edition appeared.
- Erasmus's first two editions omitted the Comma. His third edition of 1522 included it, and it continued through Stephanus and Beza into the Received Text.

Henk Jan de Jonge showed that there is no evidence Erasmus promised to insert the Comma if shown a Greek manuscript. That story developed later.[144] [145]

Q14. "Is the Longer Ending of Mark (16:9–20) a later addition?"

The claim: Critics argue that Mark's Gospel originally ended at 16:8 and that verses 9–20 were a later church addition.

The record with dates: **Mark 16:9–20** is the reading in approximately 1,653 Greek manuscripts and more than 1,000

University Press, 1992), 78–79. (Council of Carthage, A.D. 484, citing the Comma).

[144] Henk Jan de Jonge, "Erasmus and the Comma Johanneum," *Ephemerides Theologicae Lovanienses* 56 (1980): 381–89. De Jonge demonstrates the story is a legend that originated with Edward Gibbon and was later repeated uncritically.

[145] Metzger and Ehrman, *Text of the New Testament*, 101–2 (for the basic Greek manuscript listing: GA 629, GA 61, and GA 918).

Greek lectionaries. The principal Greek manuscripts ending at 16:8 are **Sinaiticus, Vaticanus**, and minuscule 304.

Greek Manuscript Evidence Before A.D. 550

- Codex Alexandrinus (A), fifth century: contains the longer ending.
- Codex Ephraemi Rescriptus (C), fifth century: contains the longer ending.
- Codex Bezae (D), fifth century: contains the longer ending.
- Codex Washingtonianus (W), fourth or fifth century: contains the longer ending.

Supporting Literary and Patristic Witnesses Before A.D. 550

- *Epistula Apostolorum*, before A.D. 150: reflects awareness of the longer ending.
- Justin Martyr, second century: uses language connected with **Mark 16:20**.
- Tatian and the Diatessaron, c. A.D. 170: include material from **Mark 16:9–20**.
- Irenaeus, c. A.D. 180, *Against Heresies* 3.10.5: directly quotes **Mark 16:19** near the conclusion of Mark's Gospel.[146]
- Asterius, fourth century: gives a close quotation connected with **Mark 16:17**.

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[146] Irenaeus, Against Heresies 3.10.5, in *Ante-Nicene Fathers*, vol. 1, ed. Alexander Roberts and James Donaldson (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 1994), 426.

- Ephrem Syrus, c. A.D. 360: uses **Mark 16:15** in connection with Tatian's Diatessaron.
- *Apostolic Constitutions*, A.D. 367–400: directly uses material from **Mark 16:9** and 16:15–19.
- Macarius Magnes, A.D. 367–433: directly uses **Mark 16:9, 15**, 17, and 18.
- Ambrose, A.D. 374–397: uses resurrection and commission material from the longer ending.
- Epiphanius, c. A.D. 377: directly quotes **Mark 16:19**.
- Augustine, c. A.D. 400: receives and discusses the longer ending.
- Jerome, A.D. 401–433: uses the passage in Epistle 120.3.
- Philostorgius, fifth century: gives a close quotation connected with **Mark 16:17**.
- Nestorius, fifth century: uses material connected with **Mark 16:20**.
- Cyril of Alexandria, fifth century: uses material connected with **Mark 16:20**.

Early Versions Before A.D. 550

- Old Latin, second to fourth centuries: contains the longer ending.
- Vulgate, c. A.D. 400: contains the longer ending.
- Syriac Peshitta and the surviving Curetonian Syriac: preserve the longer ending or its final verses.
- Gothic version, fourth century: contains the longer ending.

The longer ending was therefore known in the second century, transmitted in major fifth-century Greek codices, and received across the Greek, Latin, Syriac, and Gothic traditions. For a full-length defense, see John Burgon's The Last Twelve Verses of the Gospel according to S. Mark.[147]

Q15. "Why does the KJV have Acts 8:37 (the eunuch's confession) when many modern versions omit it?"

The claim: **Acts 8:37**, with Philip's requirement of faith and the eunuch's confession that Jesus Christ is the Son of God, is absent from many early Greek manuscripts, so modern versions omit it or place it in a footnote.

The earliest surviving Greek witness with the verse is Codex Laudianus (E), broadly dated c. A.D. 550–650, so no surviving Greek support can be placed securely before A.D. 550. The confession is nevertheless witnessed earlier in Christian quotations and the Latin tradition.[148]

Supporting Witnesses Before A.D. 550

- Irenaeus, c. A.D. 180, Against Heresies 3.12.8: records the confession, "I believe Jesus Christ to be the Son of God."
- Irenaeus, c. A.D. 180, Against Heresies 4.23.2: gives an additional allusion to the confession tradition.

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[147] John William Burgon, *The Last Twelve Verses of the Gospel according to S. Mark* Vindicated against Recent Critical Objectors and Established (Oxford: James Parker and Co., 1871).

[148] Codex Laudianus (E, sixth century), in Metzger, The *Text of the New Testament*, 75.

- Cyprian, c. A.D. 250: quotes the baptismal condition, "If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest."[149]
- Pacian of Barcelona, c. A.D. 370: uses the eunuch's confession tradition.
- Ambrose, c. A.D. 380: uses the eunuch's confession tradition.
- Augustine, c. A.D. 400: uses the eunuch's confession tradition.
- The Old Latin tradition contains the verse, and the Vulgate preserves it in the Latin biblical stream.

Conclusion

Acts 8:37 was therefore known in substance by A.D. 180 and was present in the Latin church long before Erasmus. Its early history does not depend on a medieval Greek manuscript.

The Greek manuscript support is later and varied, but the confession itself is ancient. The Received Text and the King James Bible preserve a reading already known in early Christian teaching and baptismal practice.

Q16. "Didn't Erasmus insert commentary or back-translate into Revelation? Doesn't that prove corruption in the Textus Receptus and the KJV?"

Manuscript and Historical Evidence

When Erasmus prepared his first Greek New Testament in 1516, his only Greek manuscript of Revelation, Codex 1r, lacked the

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[149] Cyprian, De Unitate Ecclesiae 12, in *Cyprian of Carthage: The Unity of the Catholic Church*, trans. Maurice Bévenot (London: Geoffrey Chapman, 1971), 69.

final leaf. He supplied **Revelation 22:16–21** by translating from the Latin biblical tradition. Critics cite this as proof of corruption, but the evidence shows otherwise: the Latin wording preserved a genuine reading that was not available in his incomplete Greek copy.[150] [151] [152]

- Erasmus did not add personal commentary. He supplied biblical text already found in the Latin tradition.
- Some of his reconstructed expressions have parallels in later-known Greek manuscripts, though not every exact form does.
- At **Revelation 22:19**, no surviving Greek manuscript reads the exact Received Text form βιβλου (*"book"*). Minuscule 61 and a corrector of 2067 have the related form βιβλίου, while Latin witnesses preserve *"book of life"* much earlier.

Witnesses Dated Before or Around A.D. 550

Supporting and competing witnesses include:

- Acts of Saturninus, A.D. 300–499: supports "book of life."
- Ambrose of Milan, A.D. 339–397: supports "book of life."
- Bachiarius, late fourth century: supports "book of life."
- Tyconius, A.D. 380–385: supports "tree of life."

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[150] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 260.

[151] Jan Krans, "Erasmus and the Text of Revelation 22:19," *TC: A Journal of Biblical Textual Criticism* 15 (2010): 1–17.

[152] This historical event is well-documented in histories of the New Testament text. See S. P. Tregelles, *An Account of the Printed Text of the Greek New Testament* (London: Samuel Bagster and Sons, 1854), 20–23.

- Primasius of Hadrumetum, c. A.D. 540–560: supports "book of life."
- Apringius of Beja, c. A.D. 540–560: supports "tree of life."

Sinaiticus and Alexandrinus, fourth and fifth centuries, read "tree of life." The earliest "book of life" support is therefore Latin rather than an exact surviving Greek manuscript.

The Faith-Based Purification Perspective

From the faith-based position of this book, Erasmus's use of the Latin tradition is not treated as permission to invent Scripture. It is understood as one way God used more than one line of transmission to preserve the received reading.

- God allowed Erasmus's Greek manuscript to end before the close of Revelation.
- Erasmus supplied the missing verses from a biblical Latin text already used in the church.
- The reading then passed through the Received Text and into the King James Bible.

The evidence should be stated plainly: the exact Greek word βίβλου is first found in Erasmus's printed text, while earlier Latin witnesses support "book of life" and later Greek manuscripts preserve related "book" forms. Within this book's position, that combined history is understood as providential preservation.

God's Word did not depend on the survival of one final Greek leaf. The reading was carried through the church's textual history and received in the King James Bible.

For further study and additional evidence concerning disputed KJV readings, including manuscripts, ancient translations, and early Christian writers, visit my website ***OldestAndBest.com.***

Q17. "What did Erasmus and the King James translators know about Codex Vaticanus?"

Part 1. Did Erasmus ever see or use Codex Vaticanus?

Erasmus never handled Codex Vaticanus himself, but he was not ignorant of it. During the heat of the controversy over **1 John 5:7–8**, the famous *Comma Johanneum*, he wrote to friends in Rome asking whether that verse appeared in the Vatican manuscript. The Vatican librarian, **Paulus Bombasius**, answered him in a letter dated June 18, 1521. In that reply, Bombasius copied out the verses from **1 John 4–5** straight from Vaticanus, and the passage confirmed that the words defending the Trinity were not present in that manuscript.[153]

More than a decade later, in **1533**, the Spanish scholar **Juan Ginés de Sepúlveda** wrote Erasmus from Rome and sent him a lengthy report of variant readings drawn from the Vatican codex. The letter supposedly contained hundreds of places where Vaticanus differed from Erasmus's printed Greek text.[154] Even apart from correspondence, Erasmus shows in his own **Annotations** that he knew Vaticanus existed and that he sometimes checked its readings. A good example appears in his notes on **Acts 27:16**, where he refers directly to "*the Vatican*

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[153] Tregelles, *Account of the Printed Text of the Greek New Testament*, 22.

[154] Frederic G. Kenyon, *Our Bible and the Ancient Manuscripts: Being a History of the Text and Its Translations*, 4th ed. (London: Eyre and Spottiswoode, 1895), 133.

manuscript" and records its reading of *Cauda* instead of the more familiar *Clauda*.[155]

So while Erasmus never possessed a full copy of Vaticanus, the evidence is clear: he knew of the manuscript, he requested and received its readings, and in at least one place he cited it by name in his own published notes.

Part 2. Did Erasmus deliberately reject the readings of Vaticanus?

Erasmus often knew about Vaticanus readings, but he almost always left them aside. He had only a few manuscripts in Basel at his disposal when he produced his editions, and those manuscripts belonged to the Byzantine tradition. When Vaticanus disagreed with the bulk of evidence he could see, Erasmus considered it untrustworthy. In fact, he even complained that Vaticanus seemed to have been influenced too heavily by the Latin tradition, which made it suspicious to him.[156]

The note on **Acts 27:16** illustrates his approach. He faithfully reports that Vaticanus reads *Cauda*, but he did not change his printed text. The same pattern appears elsewhere. Even when he was shown a long list of differences in 1533, he did not alter the foundation of his text. It wasn't ignorance, and it wasn't laziness; it was a conscious judgment call. Erasmus believed the manuscripts in his hands represented the text of the New

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[155] Desiderius Erasmus, *Erasmus' Annotations on the New Testament: Acts–Romans–I and II Corinthians*, ed. Anne Reeve and M. A. Screech (Leiden: Brill, 1990), 931.

[156] F. H. A. Scrivener, *A Plain Introduction to the Criticism of the New Testament*, vol. 1, 4th ed. (London: George Bell and Sons, 1894), 119–20.

Testament more accurately than a single manuscript in Rome, no matter how ancient it might have been.

In the end, his editions became the backbone of what was later called the **Textus Receptus**. That text, in turn, was the foundation that guided the English translators in 1611.

Part 3. Did the King James translators have access to Vaticanus or Sinaiticus?

The short answer is yes and no. **Codex Sinaiticus** was not discovered until the 1800s by Tischendorf, so it had no influence on the King James Bible at all.

Codex Vaticanus is a more complicated story. Direct access to the manuscript itself was extremely limited in the early seventeenth century, and no team in England had the ability to sit down with the actual codex in the Vatican Library. However, the translators did encounter Vaticanus in two important ways.

First, they worked with the best printed Greek editions of their day, especially those of Beza. Beza's editions occasionally mention variant readings taken from older manuscripts, including Vaticanus, even when he refused to put them into the text. Through Beza's notes, the English translators would have been aware that Vaticanus sometimes supported different readings from those in the Textus Receptus.

Second, and even more directly, the Old Testament translators used the **Sixtine Septuagint of 1587**. This was the official Roman Catholic edition of the Greek Old Testament, and it was based almost entirely on Codex Vaticanus.[157] We know from the notes of **John Bois**, one of the KJV translators, that he worked carefully

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[157] Swete, *Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek*, 116–17, 172–74.

through this printed LXX while revising the Apocrypha.[158] That means, at least on the Old Testament side, the King James translators held a Vaticanus-based text in their hands and made use of it during their work.

So, while the translators did not sit with Codex Vaticanus open on the table, they were not strangers to it either. They knew its readings through the printed editions they relied upon, and in the Old Testament they worked directly from a published text drawn straight from Vaticanus. Their decision to rest on the Hebrew text in the Old Testament and the Received Text in the New Testament was not because they had never heard of Vaticanus, but because they believed the texts they chose represented the Bible more faithfully and more securely than the alternatives.

Q18. "Is the King James Bible (KJV) copyrighted?"

This is one of the most common questions about the King James Bible, and it's important to answer it precisely. The short answer is no: the original 1611 **King James Version** is **not under modern copyright protection** in most of the world, but there are a few **historical and legal nuances** that explain why some printed editions still show a copyright notice.

The Original 1611 Text Is in the Public Domain

The text of the KJV completed in **1611 under King James I** was published more than four centuries ago. All copyright terms have long expired, and therefore the original text, the words

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[158] Nicholas J. S. Hardy, "Revising the King James Apocrypha: John Bois, Isaac Casaubon, and the Case of 1 Esdras," in *Labourers in the Vineyard of the Lord: Erudition and the Making of the King James Version of the Bible*, ed. Mordechai Feingold, Thomas E. Levere, and Nancy Siraisi (Leiden: Brill, 2018), 266–327.

themselves, are in the public domain worldwide, except in a few limited cases related to royal charters in the United Kingdom. Anyone can freely print, publish, quote, or distribute the KJV text without paying royalties or obtaining permission.

The "Crown Copyright" in the United Kingdom

In England, Scotland, and Wales, a unique historical arrangement known as **Crown Copyright** (or more precisely, the **Royal Letters Patent**) still governs the *authorized publication* of the King James Bible. When the KJV was first produced, it was printed "by His Majesty's special command." The exclusive right to print the Bible in the United Kingdom was granted by royal charter to specific presses, most notably **Cambridge University Press**, **Oxford University Press**, and **Collins (HarperCollins UK)**.

That royal privilege remains in force even today. The **British Crown** technically still holds control over who may print the KJV for sale *within the United Kingdom* (under the supervision of the **Queen's Printer** or **King's Printer**). However, this is a *legal privilege*, not a creative copyright. It does **not** extend to the text itself, and it does **not** apply outside the UK and certain Commonwealth territories.

Modern Printings and Layout Copyrights

While the words of the KJV are public domain, modern publishers sometimes hold copyright on **their specific editions**, such as:

- Typesetting, formatting, and design (font, layout, pagination)
- Study notes, cross-references, headings, concordances, and introductions

- Spelling modernization or minor editorial standardizations

For example, the **Cambridge Paragraph Bible (1873, ed. F. H. Scrivener)** is public domain, but a modern reprint of it by Cambridge University Press may be copyright-protected because of the page design and supplementary materials. Similarly, digital formats like those used by Bible apps may carry a copyright on the electronic data file, not on the Scripture itself.

What This Means Practically

- **You may freely quote, reproduce, and publish the KJV text** in print or digital form, so long as you are using a public-domain edition and not copying a publisher's proprietary formatting or notes.
- **Within the United Kingdom**, only the authorized publishers may legally print entire KJV Bibles for sale under the Crown Letters Patent.
- **Outside the UK**, the King James Bible is entirely in the **public domain**, and no permissions or royalties are required.

CONCLUSION: THE WORD OF GOD ENDURETH FOREVER

Every controversy in church history ultimately returns to the question of authority. *By what standard do we measure truth?* In our generation, the battle over Bible versions is no different. On the surface it appears to be a debate about manuscripts, translations, and readability. But beneath all of that lies the fundamental issue: *Has God kept His promise to preserve His words?*

From the very beginning, the serpent's question has been the same: *"Yea, hath God said?"* (**Gen. 3:1**). The war on words did not begin in Alexandria, nor in the Reformation, nor in the nineteenth century; it began in Eden. And every time Satan raises that question, he seeks to drive a wedge between the believer and the Book upon which his faith rests.

A Faith That Begins with Scripture

Our faith is not founded on textual criticism, nor on the shifting sands of academic consensus. It is founded on the words of God.

- *"The words of the LORD are pure words… Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever"* (**Ps. 12:6–7**).
- *"Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away"* (**Matt. 24:35**).
- *"The word of the Lord endureth for ever"* (**1 Pet. 1:25**).

If these promises mean anything, they mean that the inspired words have not vanished. They remain, preserved, purified, and available for the people of God today.

The Two Lines in History

History confirms what Scripture declares: there are two streams of Bibles.

- The **line of Antioch**: the Received Text, the Masoretic Hebrew, the Byzantine Greek, quoted by the fathers, carried by the churches, preached in revival, and used by missionaries.

- The **line of Alexandria**: the speculative texts of Origen, the eclectic philosophies of the schools, manuscripts kept unused in libraries, riddled with contradictions and omissions.

The fruit of each line tells the story. Antioch's Bibles brought reformation, evangelism, and doctrinal clarity. Alexandria's manuscripts brought confusion, rationalism, and endless revision. By their fruits ye shall know them.

Doctrine at Stake

Time and again, the Alexandrian line diminishes Christ's deity, His blood, His virgin birth, His uniqueness as Saviour. Even when doctrine survives elsewhere, the cumulative pattern erodes faith by subtraction. The Bible does not simply need to teach a doctrine somewhere; it needs to preserve *every word* God gave (**Matt. 4:4**).

The Myths Removed

- *Readability?* Proven false. The King James Bible averages an eighth-grade reading level, often lower than modern versions, with cadence designed for public clarity.

- *The Apocrypha?* The KJV set it apart as history, never as Scripture—unlike Vaticanus and Sinaiticus, which mingled it into the canon.

- *Revisions?* Only spelling and printing corrections. The text is the same today as it was in 1611.

- *Erasmus's so-called blunders?* Where critics claim he "added" to Revelation or "inserted" the Comma, history in fact shows preservation and purification, by faith. The church already used those readings, and later manuscript discoveries confirmed them.

Every major objection collapses under scrutiny.

God's Providence in English

The King James Bible is not inspired anew; it consists of inspired words that were preserved and purified. As God preserved His words through the Levites (**Rom. 3:2**), and as He multiplied and purified His Word through centuries of use, He has given us in English a Bible that carries forward the Masoretic Old Testament and the Received New Testament.

It is no accident that for nearly three centuries it was the one Bible God used to spark revival, plant churches, send missionaries, and shape the modern world. Other versions rise and fall in popularity, but the King James remains because the hand of God is upon it.

A Call to Confidence

The issue is not preference. It is faith. Either God preserved His words, or He did not. Either He purified them, or He abandoned them. Either we have a sure foundation, or we are left to the shifting theories of scholars.

The King James Bible stands as a testimony that God kept His promises. Its text is not the work of chance or mere scholarship; it is the fruit of God's guiding hand through history. It is the Bible that bears the marks of inspiration, preservation,

purification, and power. With the principles laid out in the Bible itself, we are not left to guess; by faith, we can find that perfect Word of God today.

And so we say with David:

> *"Thy word is true from the beginning: and every one of thy righteous judgments endureth for ever"* (**Ps. 119:160**).

Here, then, we rest: not on man's shifting opinions, but on the unchanging words of the living God.

We are not called to be textual critics but **Bible believers**. We believe not in the theories of men, but in the promise of God to preserve and purify His Word for every generation.

The Story's End

The young man in the pew began his journey confused and unsettled. He had heard the preaching of his pastor's conviction but then discovered the chilling disclaimer, "*in the originals.*" His heart ached: how could he build his life on a book he was told was no longer here?

But as his journey unfolded, he began to search the Scriptures themselves. There he found promise after promise: "*The words of the LORD are pure words… Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever*" (**Ps. 12:6–7**). "*For ever, O LORD, thy word is settled in heaven*" (**Ps. 119:89**). "*Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away*" (**Matt. 24:35**). The Bible did not only speak of inspiration in the past; it declared preservation and purification in the present. God tied His own character to His words, magnifying His Word above His name (**Ps. 138:2**). The young man realized the Bible itself teaches that God's words still live, still endure, still remain pure.

The next question naturally followed: if God promised to preserve His words, *where* could they be found? History answered. He traced the line of faithful transmission through Antioch, the missionary hub of the early church, through the Byzantine manuscripts copied and used by believers for centuries, through the Masoretic tradition of the Old Testament, through the Received Text of the New Testament, and finally into the English of the King James Bible. He saw the contrast with Alexandria, where philosophy and textual tampering bred doubt and omissions. By their fruits he discerned the difference. By applying, in faith, the principles from the Word of God itself, he found the book he could trust.

His journey brought him to peace. The Bible in his lap was neither missing essential parts nor a puzzle only scholars could reconstruct. It was the purified, preserved Word of God. What began in confusion ended in clarity; what began in doubt ("Yea, hath God said?") ended in faith.

The young man could now say with confidence: *"This is the Word of God. Every word, every promise, every truth, kept by God Himself. I can live by it, raise my family by it, and trust my eternity to it."*

The journey ends where it must, with the believer living by faith ("the just shall live by faith"), able to please God ("without faith it is impossible to please him…"), resting in the living, preserved Word of the living God—to have and to hold.

"The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: but the word of our God shall stand for ever." (**Isa. 40:8**)

ADDENDUM: OTHER DOCTRINALLY SIGNIFICANT CHANGES IN MODERN VERSIONS VS THE KJV

Why This Addendum Is Included

The earlier chapter, "Doctrinal Issues: Why the 'Small' Changes Aren't Small," presented several clear examples of differences between the King James Bible and modern versions. The purpose of this addendum is to provide a broader reference list.

It is sometimes said that no doctrine is affected by the differences between Bible versions, but that statement avoids the real issue. A doctrine may continue to be taught somewhere else while a particular verse's testimony to that doctrine is weakened, shortened, questioned, or removed. God did not merely promise to preserve enough verses for every major doctrine to survive somewhere. Man is to live *"by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God"* (**Matt. 4:4**).

The Person and Work of Jesus Christ

Matthew 25:13

KJV:
"Watch therefore, for ye know neither the day nor the hour wherein the Son of man cometh."

NIV:
"Therefore keep watch, because you do not know the day or the hour."

Matthew 27:34

KJV:
"They gave him vinegar to drink mingled with gall: and when he had tasted thereof, he would not drink."

ESV:
"*They offered him wine to drink, mixed with gall…"*

Matthew 27:35

KJV:
"And they crucified him, and parted his garments, casting lots: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, They parted my garments among them, and upon my vesture did they cast lots."

ESV:
"And when they had crucified him, they divided his garments among them by casting lots."

Mark 6:11

KJV:
"And whosoever shall not receive you, nor hear you, when ye depart thence, shake off the dust under your feet for a testimony against them. Verily I say unto you, It shall be more tolerable for Sodom and Gomorrha in the day of judgment, than for that city."

NIV:
The sentence concerning Sodom and Gomorrah and the day of judgment is omitted.

Mark 13:14

KJV:
"But when ye shall see the abomination of desolation, spoken of by Daniel the prophet, standing where it ought not…"

NIV:
"When you see 'the abomination that causes desolation' standing where it does not belong…"

Mark 15:28

KJV:
"And the scripture was fulfilled, which saith, And he was numbered with the transgressors."

NIV:
Verse omitted from the main text.

Mark 16:9–20

KJV:
Verses 9–20 appear as the continuous conclusion of the Gospel of Mark.

ESV:
The passage is omitted with a note stating that some of the earliest manuscripts do not include **Mark 16:9–20.**

Luke 4:4

KJV:
"*And Jesus answered him, saying, It is written, That man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God*."

NIV:
"*Man shall not live on bread alone*."

Luke 4:8

KJV:
"*And Jesus answered and said unto him, Get thee behind me, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve*."

NASB:
The words "*Get thee behind me, Satan*" are omitted.

John 3:13

KJV:
"*And no man hath ascended up to heaven, but he that came down from heaven, even the Son of man which is in heaven*."

ESV:
The words "*which is in heaven*" are omitted.

John 7:53–8:11

KJV:
The account of the woman taken in adultery appears as part of the continuous text.

ESV:
The passage is separated from the surrounding text with a note questioning its inclusion.

John 9:35

KJV:
"Jesus heard that they had cast him out; and when he had found him, he said unto him, Dost thou believe on the Son of God?"

ESV:
"*Do you believe in the Son of Man*?"

Entire Verses Omitted

Acts 28:29

KJV:
"And when he had said these words, the Jews departed, and had great reasoning among themselves."

NIV:
Verse omitted from the main text.

Romans 16:24

KJV:
"*The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen*."

NIV:
Verse omitted from the main text.

Christ's Sacrifice and Salvation

1 Corinthians 5:7

KJV:
"*Purge out therefore the old leaven, that ye may be a new lump, as ye are unleavened. For even Christ our passover is sacrificed for us.*"

ESV:
"*For Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed*."

1 Corinthians 11:24

KJV:
"*And when he had given thanks, he brake it, and said, Take, eat: this is my body, which is broken for you: this do in remembrance of me.*"

NASB:
"*This is My body, which is for you…*"

Galatians 3:17

KJV:
"*And this I say, that the covenant, that was confirmed before of God in Christ, the law, which was four hundred and thirty years after, cannot disannul…*"

ESV:
The words "*in Christ*" are omitted.

Galatians 4:7

KJV:
"Wherefore thou art no more a servant, but a son; and if a son, then an heir of God through Christ."

CSB:
"So you are no longer a slave but a son, and if a son, then God has made you an heir."

Ephesians 3:9

KJV:
"*And to make all men see what is the fellowship of the mystery, which from the beginning of the world hath been hid in God, who created all things by Jesus Christ."*

ESV:
"*…God, who created all things.*"

Colossians 1:2

KJV:
"*To the saints and faithful brethren in Christ which are at Colosse: Grace be unto you, and peace, from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.*"

ESV:
"*Grace to you and peace from God our Father.*"

Hebrews 1:3

KJV:
"*…when he had by himself purged our sins, sat down on the right hand of the Majesty on high.*"

ESV:
"*After making purification for sins, he sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high."*

1 Peter 2:2

KJV:
"*As newborn babes, desire the sincere milk of the word, that ye may grow thereby.*"

NIV:
"*…so that by it you may grow up in your salvation.*"

1 Peter 4:1

KJV:
"*Forasmuch then as Christ hath suffered for us in the flesh, arm yourselves likewise with the same mind…*"

ESV:
"*Since therefore Christ suffered in the flesh, arm yourselves with the same way of thinking…*"

1 John 4:3

KJV:
"*And every spirit that confesseth not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is not of God…*"

ESV:
"*…every spirit that does not confess Jesus is not from God…*"

Prophecy and the Last Things

2 Peter 3:10

KJV:
"*But the day of the Lord will come as a thief in the night; in the which the heavens shall pass away with a great noise, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat, the earth also and the works that are therein shall be burned up.*"

NIV:
"*…the earth and everything done in it will be laid bare.*"

Old Testament Differences

Psalm 8:5

KJV:
"*For thou hast made him a little lower than the angels, and hast crowned him with glory and honour.*"

NASB:
"*Yet You have made him a little lower than God…*"

Additional Differences in Revelation

Revelation 2:15

KJV:
"*So hast thou also them that hold the doctrine of the Nicolaitans, which thing I hate.*"

NASB:
"*So you too, have some who in the same way hold to the teaching of the Nicolaitans.*"

Revelation 21:24

KJV:
"*And the nations of them which are saved shall walk in the light of it: and the kings of the earth do bring their glory and honour into it.*"

CSB:
"*The nations will walk by its light…*"

Revelation 22:14

KJV:
"*Blessed are they that do his commandments, that they may have right to the tree of life, and may enter in through the gates into the city.*"

ESV:
"*Blessed are those who wash their robes…*"

Revelation 22:19

KJV:
"*And if any man shall take away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God shall take away his part out of the book of life, and out of the holy city, and from the things which are written in this book.*"

NASB:
"…God will take away his part from the tree of life and from the holy city…"

Conclusion of the Addendum

Again and again, the King James Bible preserves:

- The full titles of Jesus Christ
- Direct statements of His deity
- References to His blood
- The substitutionary direction of His sacrifice
- Calls to repentance
- Instructions concerning prayer and fasting
- Fulfillment formulas connecting prophecy with history

- Explicit statements concerning judgment, hell, and eternity
- Complete narrative explanations
- The believer's duty to obey the words of God

The argument is not that a modern-version reader can learn nothing about these doctrines. Many modern versions teach them in other passages. The issue is that these exact words and passages belong where God placed them.

If God inspired every word, then every word matters.

If God promised to preserve His words, then their removal cannot be dismissed as inconsequential.

PROMISES OF SCRIPTURE

Psalm 12:6–7 — *The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.*

Psalm 78:1–8 — *Give ear, O my people, to my law: incline your ears to the words of my mouth. I will open my mouth in a parable: I will utter dark sayings of old: Which we have heard and known, and our fathers have told us. We will not hide them from their children, shewing to the generation to come the praises of the LORD, and his strength, and his wonderful works that he hath done. For he established a testimony in Jacob, and appointed a law in Israel, which he commanded our fathers, that they should make them known to their children: That the generation to come might know them, even the children which should be born; who should arise and declare them to their children: That they might set their hope in God, and not forget the works of God, but keep his commandments: And might not be as their fathers, a stubborn and rebellious generation; a generation that set not their heart aright, and whose spirit was not stedfast with God.*

Psalm 105:8 — *He hath remembered his covenant for ever, the word which he commanded to a thousand generations.*

Psalm 119:89 — *For ever, O LORD, thy word is settled in heaven.*

Psalm 119:111 — *Thy testimonies have I taken as an heritage for ever: for they are the rejoicing of my heart.*

Psalm 119:152 — *Concerning thy testimonies, I have known of old that thou hast founded them for ever.*

Psalm 119:160 — *Thy word is true from the beginning: and every one of thy righteous judgments endureth for ever.*

Proverbs 22:20–21 — *Have not I written to thee excellent things in counsels and knowledge, That I might make thee know the certainty of*

the words of truth; that thou mightest answer the words of truth to them that send unto thee?

Matthew 5:17–18 — *Think not that I am come to destroy the law, or the prophets: I am not come to destroy, but to fulfil. For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled.*

John 10:34–36 — *Jesus answered them, Is it not written in your law, I said, Ye are gods? If he called them gods, unto whom the word of God came, and the scripture cannot be broken; Say ye of him, whom the Father hath sanctified, and sent into the world, Thou blasphemest; because I said, I am the Son of God?*

Psalm 82:1–6 — *God standeth in the congregation of the mighty; he judgeth among the gods. How long will ye judge unjustly, and accept the persons of the wicked? Selah. Defend the poor and fatherless: do justice to the afflicted and needy. Deliver the poor and needy: rid them out of the hand of the wicked. They know not, neither will they understand; they walk on in darkness: all the foundations of the earth are out of course. I have said, Ye are gods; and all of you are children of the most High.*

1 Peter 1:23–25 — *Being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which liveth and abideth for ever. For all flesh is as grass, and all the glory of man as the flower of grass. The grass withereth, and the flower thereof falleth away: But the word of the Lord endureth for ever. And this is the word which by the gospel is preached unto you.*

John 12:48 with Revelation 20:11–13 — *He that rejecteth me, and receiveth not my words, hath one that judgeth him: the word that I have spoken, the same shall judge him in the last day. And I saw a great white throne, and him that sat on it, from whose face the earth and the heaven fled away; and there was found no place for them. And I saw the dead, small and great, stand before God; and the books were*

opened: and another book was opened, which is the book of life: and the dead were judged out of those things which were written in the books, according to their works. And the sea gave up the dead which were in it; and death and hell delivered up the dead which were in them: and they were judged every man according to their works.

Psalm 102:12 — *But thou, O LORD, shalt endure for ever; and thy remembrance unto all generations.*

Isaiah 59:21 — *As for me, this is my covenant with them, saith the LORD; My spirit that is upon thee, and my words which I have put in thy mouth, shall not depart out of thy mouth, nor out of the mouth of thy seed, nor out of the mouth of thy seed's seed, saith the LORD, from henceforth and for ever.*

Psalm 105:5 with John 17:17 — *Remember his marvellous works that he hath done; his wonders, and the judgments of his mouth; Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth.*

Luke 21:33 — *Heaven and earth shall pass away: but my words shall not pass away.*

Luke 16:16–17 — *The law and the prophets were until John: since that time the kingdom of God is preached, and every man presseth into it. And it is easier for heaven and earth to pass, than one tittle of the law to fail.*

Isaiah 40:8 — *The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: but the word of our God shall stand for ever.*

Psalm 33:11 — *The counsel of the LORD standeth for ever, the thoughts of his heart to all generations.*

Psalm 117 — *O praise the LORD, all ye nations: praise him, all ye people. For his merciful kindness is great toward us: and the truth of the LORD endureth for ever. Praise ye the LORD.*

Deuteronomy 7:9 — *Know therefore that the LORD thy God, he is God, the faithful God, which keepeth covenant and mercy with them that love him and keep his commandments to a thousand generations;*

Psalm 135:13 with 138:2 — *Thy name, O LORD, endureth for ever; and thy memorial, O LORD, throughout all generations. I will worship toward thy holy temple, and praise thy name for thy lovingkindness and for thy truth: for thou hast magnified thy word above all thy name.*

1 Chronicles 16:14–15 — *He is the LORD our God; his judgments are in all the earth. Be ye mindful always of his covenant; the word which he commanded to a thousand generations;*

Proverbs 4:1–11 — *Hear, ye children, the instruction of a father, and attend to know understanding. For I give you good doctrine, forsake ye not my law. For I was my father's son, tender and only beloved in the sight of my mother. He taught me also, and said unto me, Let thine heart retain my words: keep my commandments, and live. Get wisdom, get understanding: forget it not; neither decline from the words of my mouth. Forsake her not, and she shall preserve thee: love her, and she shall keep thee. Wisdom is the principal thing; therefore get wisdom: and with all thy getting get understanding. Exalt her, and she shall promote thee: she shall bring thee to honour, when thou dost embrace her. She shall give to thine head an ornament of grace: a crown of glory shall she deliver to thee. Hear, O my son, and receive my sayings; and the years of thy life shall be many. I have taught thee in the way of wisdom; I have led thee in right paths.*

Psalm 19:7–11 — *The law of the LORD is perfect, converting the soul: the testimony of the LORD is sure, making wise the simple. The statutes of the LORD are right, rejoicing the heart: the commandment of the LORD is pure, enlightening the eyes. The fear of the LORD is clean, enduring for ever: the judgments of the LORD are true and righteous altogether. More to be desired are they than gold, yea, than much fine gold: sweeter also than honey and the honeycomb. Moreover*

by them is thy servant warned: and in keeping of them there is great reward.

Psalm 18:30 — *As for God, his way is perfect: the word of the LORD is tried: he is a buckler to all those that trust in him.*

Proverbs 30:5–6 — *Every word of God is pure: he is a shield unto them that put their trust in him. Add thou not unto his words, lest he reprove thee, and thou be found a liar.*

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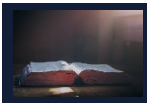
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